

KILLER INSTINCT GUIDE

MASTER CHARACTER INDEX

CHARACTER	KI CLASSIC	KI2 / GOLD	KI (2013)
			SYSTEM
Jago	OPEN	OPEN	OPEN
T.J. Combo	OPEN	OPEN	OPEN
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Chief Thunder	OPEN	COMING	OPEN
Spinal	OPEN	OPEN	OPEN
B. Orchid	OPEN	COMING	OPEN
Cinder	OPEN	COMING	OPEN
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Riptor	OPEN	COMING	OPEN
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For OPEN beside the game you want - no scrolling through character sections.

KILLER INSTINCT GUIDE

MASTER CHARACTER INDEX - CONTINUED

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KILLER INSTINCT CLASSIC — JAGO

Arcade reference • QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Endokuken: D, DF, F + Punch

Tiger Fury: F, D, DF + Punch

Wind Kick: DF, D, DB + Kick

Laser Sword: DF, D, DB + FP

CLASSIC COMBO FLOW

OPENER → AUTO-DOUBLE → LINKER → AUTO-DOUBLE → ENDER

An Auto-Double is a **single button press** after a valid opener or linker. The game then supplies the extra hits. In KI1, Auto-Doubles can add two or three attacks depending on the situation.

JAGO — AUTO-DOUBLE BUTTONS

Universal jump-in pairing used by Classic KI:

QP opener → **QK** Auto-Double

QK opener → **QP** Auto-Double

MP opener → **FK** Auto-Double

FK opener → **MP** Auto-Double

FP opener → **MK** Auto-Double

MK opener → **FP** Auto-Double

Jago-specific note: Laser Sword can store/access both punch and kick Auto-Double possibilities; Wind Kick and jump-in routes have more restricted normal Auto-Double choices unless a stored Auto-Double is active.

PRACTICAL COMPLETE ROUTES

Jump-in route

Jump MK → **QP Auto-Double** → MP Wind Kick Linker → **QK Auto-Double** → FK Wind Kick Ender

Pressure / linker route

F+FK → MK Wind Kick Linker → **QK Auto-Double** → FP Tiger Fury Ender

Fierce Wind Kick route

FK Wind Kick Opener → **MP Auto-Double** → FP Tiger Fury Ender

The bold button is the input that was previously missing from the guide. You press it after the opener/linker connects; you do not manually input every hit of an Auto-Double.

LINKER & ENDER QUICK REFERENCE

Linkers: Wind Kick and Laser Sword routes.

Enders: Endokuken • Tiger Fury • Wind Kick • route-specific launcher/sweep finishes.

JAGO — COMBO BREAKER & SHADOW MOVES

Core Classic mechanics kept separate from ordinary combo construction.

COMBO BREAKER

Time Jago's breaker input during the opponent's Auto-Double. Classic KI's breaker relationships are tied to the attack/button being doubled, so learning to recognize the Auto-Double animations is part of defense.

POST-BREAKER SHADOW MOVES

Red Endokuken: charge/negative-edge Endokuken input
Shadow Wind Kick: charge/negative-edge Wind Kick input
Shadow Tiger Fury: charge/negative-edge Tiger Fury input

In Classic KI these enhanced moves are associated with the post-Combo-Breaker state. They are not the meter-based Shadow system used by KI 2013.

STORED AUTO-DOUBLE

Classic KI contains a more advanced **Stored Auto-Double (SAD)** behavior. If certain openers/linkers are used without immediately taking their Auto-Double, the game can retain that Auto-Double rule and apply it to a later opener. Jago's Laser Sword is particularly important because it can allow Auto-Double options that Wind Kick or a jump-in would not normally have.

For normal play, ignore SAD until the standard Opener → Auto-Double → Linker → Auto-Double → Ender sequence is automatic.

JAGO — FINISHERS

Quick-reference finishing section.

ULTRA COMBO

DF, D, DB + QK

Use as the finishing portion of a qualifying combo while the opponent is in Danger.

ULTIMATE

B, F, F + QP

Close-range Ultimate / sword-stab finish in the Classic command set.

HUMILIATION

F, DF, D, DB, B + QK

Performed under the normal Humiliation match requirement.

NO MERCY / DANGER MOVES

Jago has two character finishers in Classic. Keep the required spacing in mind; the close-range and distant finishers are not interchangeable.

SNES

SNES-specific commands or behavior will be identified only where the console version differs from the arcade reference. N64 does not apply to KI1; Nintendo 64 material belongs with KI2 / Killer Instinct Gold.

JAGO — ADVANCED: MANUALS

Manuals are learned after the automatic combo structure.

WHAT IS A MANUAL?

A Manual is a normal attack timed deliberately inside a combo rather than the game supplying an Auto-Double. Classic manual sequences commonly use a **Fierce** → **Medium** pattern.

MANUAL PAIRS

FP → **MP**

FK → **MK**

These can be used after appropriate openers/linkers, and can also begin close-range manual combo structures.

EXAMPLE MANUAL ROUTES

Standing FP → **MK** → **MP Wind Kick** → **QP Auto-Double** → **FP Ender**

Crouching FP → **MP** → **FP Laser Sword** → **FK ender/juggle route**

Jump FP → **F+FK** → **MP Wind Kick** → **QP Auto-Double** → **FK** → **MP Manual** → **Ender**

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Opener → Auto-Double → Ender
2. Opener → Auto-Double → Linker → Auto-Double → Ender
3. Add one Fierce → Medium Manual pair
4. Mix Auto-Doubles and Manuals
5. Learn Stored Auto-Double behavior last.

KILLER INSTINCT CLASSIC — T.J. COMBO

Arcade reference • charge character • QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Spinfist: Charge B, F + QP
Rollercoaster: Charge B, F + MP
Powerline: Charge B, F + FP
Flying Knee / Skullcrusher: Charge B, F + QK or FK
T.J. Tremor: Charge B, F + MK
Speed Bag / Punching Bag: tap QP repeatedly
Uppercut: hold FP, then release

CLASSIC COMBO FLOW

OPENER → AUTO-DOUBLE → LINKER → AUTO-DOUBLE → ENDER

T.J. is built around charge buffering. Hold Back while another animation is playing whenever possible so the next B→F special is ready without stopping the combo.

OPENERS

Spinfist: Charge B, F + QP
Rollercoaster: Charge B, F + MP
Skullcrusher: Charge B, F + FK
T.J. Tremor: Charge B, F + MK

AUTO-DOUBLE BUTTONS

QP ↔ QK
MP ↔ FK
FP ↔ MK

After a valid opener or linker, press the paired button once. The game supplies the Auto-Double hits. Example: a **MP**-strength opening pairs with **FK**; a **FK**-strength opening pairs with **MP**.

LINKERS

Spinfist: Charge B, F + QP
Rollercoaster: Charge B, F + MP

ENDERS

Spinfist: Charge B, F + QP
Turn Through: Charge B, F + QK
Powerline: Charge B, F + FP
T.J. Tremor: Charge B, F + MK
Special Ender: Charge B, F + FK after the first four enders

PRACTICAL COMPLETE ROUTE

Rollercoaster Opener → FK Auto-Double → Spinfist Linker → QK Auto-Double → Powerline Ender

The key execution skill is charging Back during the Auto-Double so the next linker/ender is already buffered.

T.J. COMBO — COMBO BREAKER & SHADOW MOVES

Classic defensive and post-breaker tools.

COMBO BREAKER

Charge B, F + Kick, timed against the opponent's Auto-Double. Learn the opponent's Auto-Double animations rather than guessing from combo length.

POST-BREAKER SHADOW MOVES

Super Spinfist: enhanced post-breaker Spinfist

Super Rollercoaster: enhanced post-breaker Rollercoaster

Super Powerline: enhanced post-breaker Powerline

Super Tremor: HCB + MK (air) — punches the ground with blue flame, causing knockdown/stun nearby

CHARGE BUFFERING

T.J.'s advanced execution is largely about hiding the Back charge. Begin charging during jump-ins, Auto-Doubles, knockdowns and other animations. Release Forward + the required attack only when the next special must occur.

STORED / EXTENDED ROUTING

Arcade T.J. has extended Rollercoaster and juggle behavior that can produce substantially longer routes than the straightforward SNES version. Treat this as advanced arcade material; first make the normal opener → Auto-Double → linker → Auto-Double → ender structure automatic.

T.J. COMBO — FINISHERS

Quick-reference finishing section.

ULTRA COMBO

Charge F, B + FP — perform during a qualifying combo while the opponent is in Danger.

ULTIMATE

Hold QK, F, B, release QK — perform during a qualifying combo.

0-COMBO ULTIMATE

F, DF, D, DB, B, F + FK — T.J. produces a sub-machine gun finisher.

HUMILIATION

D, D, D + QP — requires T.J. to still be on his first life bar.

NO MERCY 1

B, B, F, F + MP — close range. T.J. strikes the opponent and finishes by snapping the neck.

NO MERCY 2

HCF + FK — close range. Heavy backfist sends the opponent flying into the screen.

VERSION NOTES

SNES: the core charge specials and finishers remain, but the home version does not reproduce every arcade juggle/buffer extension. In particular, modern arcade lab work documents extra Rollercoaster/air-ender behavior that cannot be duplicated identically on SNES.

N64: not applicable to KI Classic; N64 belongs with KI2 / Killer Instinct Gold.

T.J. COMBO — ADVANCED: MANUALS

Learn the charge-based automatic combo structure first, then insert manually timed normals.

MANUAL PRINCIPLE

A Manual is a deliberately timed normal after an opener or linker instead of accepting the automatic follow-up. With T.J., the difficulty is doubled: you must time the normal while preserving enough Back charge for the next special.

PRACTICE PAIRS

Fierce → **Medium** is the Classic manual relationship to practice first: FP → MP and FK → MK. Begin with a single manual pair after a familiar opener before attempting long Rollercoaster routes.

MANUAL PRACTICE ROUTE

Rollercoaster Opener → **timed Fierce/Medium Manual** → **Spinfist Linker** → **QK Auto-Double** → **Powerline Ender**

Hold Back as early as the manual timing allows. If the next special fails to come out, the problem is usually lost charge rather than the combo concept.

ADVANCED ARCADE GOAL

Once ordinary manuals are reliable, practice buffering repeated Rollercoaster sequences and air follow-ups. Arcade T.J. can extend far beyond the basic teaching route; the SNES version has different limits, so those arcade-only extensions should not be used as the console benchmark.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Charge specials individually
2. Opener → Auto-Double → Ender
3. Add Spinfist or Rollercoaster linker
4. Hide Back charge during Auto-Doubles
5. Add one Manual
6. Learn extended arcade Rollercoaster/juggle routing

KILLER INSTINCT CLASSIC — GLACIUS

Arcade reference • charge/linker character • QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Ice Lance / Arm Blade: F, DF, D, DB + QP
Cold Shoulder: Charge B, F + Punch
Reverse Cold Shoulder: Charge F, B + MP
Shockwave: D, DF, F + Punch
Liquidize: D, DF, F + QK
Liquidize Uppercut: D, DF, F + MK or FK
Arm Pummel: tap QP repeatedly

CLASSIC COMBO FLOW

OPENER → SPECIFIC AUTO-DOUBLE → LINKER → SPECIFIC AUTO-DOUBLE → ENDER → optional JUGGLE

Glacius is unusual because his grounded starters have their own documented Auto-Double choices. Do not apply the universal jump-in pairing blindly to his grounded Shoulder/Puddle starters.

GROUND OPENERS & AUTO-DOUBLES

Medium Liquidize Uppercut → QK or FK
Quick Cold Shoulder → MP or FK
Medium Cold Shoulder → MP or FP
Fierce Cold Shoulder → QP or MP

JUMP-IN AUTO-DOUBLE PAIRS

QP → QK • QK → QP
MP → FK • FK → MP
MK → FP • FP → MK

LINKER / BRIDGE

Reverse Cold Shoulder: Charge F, B + MP
After it connects: **QP, MP, or FK** Auto-Double — or go directly to an Ender.

PRACTICAL COMPLETE ROUTE

Fierce Cold Shoulder → MP Auto-Double → hold F → B+MP Reverse Cold Shoulder → FK Auto-Double → FP Shockwave Ender

This is the Classic Glacius pattern: keep holding Forward during the first Auto-Double so the Reverse Cold Shoulder linker is already charged.

GLACIUS — ENDERS, BREAKER & SHADOW MOVES

Finish the combo cleanly, then add the juggle only when the ender allows it.

ENDERS

Ice Lance: F, DF, D, DB + QP — can lead to juggle

Fierce Shockwave: D, DF, F + FP — multi-hit rising finish; can lead to juggle

Medium Liquidize Uppercut: D, DF, F + MK — cannot be juggled

Fierce Liquidize Uppercut: D, DF, F + FK — multi-hit finish; can lead to juggle

JUGGLE

After a juggle-capable ender, time **Fierce Liquidize Uppercut** as the opponent falls. A successful Combo Breaker upgrades this into a triple uppercut juggle and Classic sources document repeating it up to three times while the post-breaker power is active.

COMBO BREAKER

Charge B, F + the appropriate Punch. Classic strength relationship: **Quick breaks Medium • Medium breaks Fierce • Fierce breaks Quick.** Glacius' breaker needs a Back charge, so begin holding it before the break window whenever possible.

POST-BREAKER SHADOW / TURBO MOVES

Fast Shockwave: Hold QP → D, DF, F → release QP

Shadow Liquidize Uppercut: Hold FK → D, DF, F → release FK

The fast Shockwave is Glacius' principal documented out-of-combo Turbo/Shadow projectile after a breaker; the enhanced uppercut appears in Classic move references as his other post-breaker release move.

RECOVERY / INTERRUPT TOOLS

Recovery: Liquidize or Liquidize Uppercut as Glacius rises.

Interrupt: during Fierce Liquidize Uppercut, input D,DF,F+MK to appear behind with the Medium version; during Medium, input D,DF,F+FK for the knockdown version.

GLACIUS — FINISHERS

Classic arcade finishing reference.

ULTRA COMBO

Charge B, F + FP — replace the normal Ender while the opponent is flashing red / in Danger.

ULTIMATE — ACID PUDDLE

F, DF, D, DB, B + QP — perform as the combo finisher while the opponent is in Danger.

NO MERCY 1 — ICE PICK

B, DB, D, DF, F + MP — close / about one-character distance. Glacius forms an ice spike and freezes the opponent.

NO MERCY 2 — BLOB ENGULF

F, DF, D, DB, B + MK — arcade finisher. Glacius becomes a mass of liquid and engulfs the opponent.

NO MERCY 3 — ACID PUDDLE

B, B, B + FK — Glacius melts beneath the opponent and absorbs them.

HUMILIATION

F, F, B + QK — requires Glacius to retain his first life bar.

VERSION NOTES

SNES: the SNES version retains Ice Pick and Acid Puddle, Ultra, Ultimate and Humiliation. Contemporary Classic documentation specifically notes that the **Blob Engulf / Body Bag No Mercy is absent from SNES**. This is why the arcade guide shows three No Mercies while common SNES lists show two.

N64: not applicable to KI1. Glacius returns in KI2 / Killer Instinct Gold, where his move system changes substantially.

GLACIUS — ADVANCED: MANUALS & ROUTES

Advanced play begins after the grounded Auto-Double tables and Reverse Cold Shoulder charge are automatic.

MANUAL PRINCIPLE

A Manual is a deliberately timed normal rather than an automatic follow-up. For Glacius, manuals are especially useful because his grounded starter rules differ from the universal jump-in Auto-Second pairs, and his linker can preserve Stored Auto-Double behavior.

STORED AUTO-DOUBLE

Glacius' Reverse Cold Shoulder linker can preserve Auto-Double options into later pieces of a combo. Classic SNES lab documentation specifically notes that his linker supports jump-punch → punch and jump-kick → kick Stored Auto-Double structures. Learn this only after the listed grounded Auto-Double choices are reliable.

13-HIT CLASSIC ROUTE

Fierce Cold Shoulder → MP Auto-Double → Reverse Cold Shoulder (Charge F, B+MP) → FK Auto-Double → FP Shockwave Ender

Classic Glacius documentation lists this structure as a 13-hit Killer combo before any optional falling-opponent juggle.

13-HIT PUDDLE ROUTE

Medium Liquidize Uppercut → QK Auto-Double → Reverse Cold Shoulder → FK Auto-Double → Ice Lance Ender

This route demonstrates why Glacius' character-specific ground Auto-Doubles matter: Medium Puddle Uppercut legitimately feeds QK.

MANUAL PRACTICE

1. Fierce Cold Shoulder → MP Auto-Double → Ender
2. Add Reverse Cold Shoulder while holding Forward through the Auto-Double
3. Add FK after the linker
4. Replace one automatic normal with a deliberately timed normal
5. Add Fierce Liquidize Uppercut juggle after a compatible ender
6. Explore Stored Auto-Double routes last

KILLER INSTINCT CLASSIC — CHIEF THUNDER

Arcade reference • axe pressure / anti-projectile spin / Phoenix control • QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Flying Mohawk: QCB + QP/MP; HCB + FP
Spinning Chop: Charge B, F + QP/MP/FP — anti-projectile
Reverse Spinning Chop: Charge F, B + MP — anti-projectile
Tomahawk Dive: QCB + FP — air
Phoenix Throw: QCF + QK/MK/FK — controllable projectile
Fast Phoenix: Hold MK, QCF, release MK

CLASSIC COMBO FLOW

OPENER → SPECIFIC AUTO-DOUBLE → LINKER → SPECIFIC AUTO-DOUBLE → ENDER → optional JUGGLE

Thunder's combo engine mixes charge moves with quarter-circle specials. His Spinning Chop family supplies strong openers and the reverse-control MP version is an important connector.

OPENERS / AUTO-DOUBLES

Fierce Spinning Chop → F+MP Auto-Double option
Medium Spinning Chop → MK Auto-Double option
Quick / Medium / Fierce Spinning Chop → B/F+FK Auto-Double option
Fierce Flying Mohawk → F/B+QK air Auto-Double option

LINKERS / CONNECTORS

Reverse Spinning Chop: Charge F, B + MP — 3-hit connector and the core long-combo bridge.
Flying Mohawk: QCB + QP can connect after an overhead Fierce route.
Normals: Thunder also has documented 2- and 3-hit connector normals after specific Spinning Chop strengths.

PRACTICAL COMPLETE ROUTE

Fierce Spinning Chop → F+MP Auto-Double → Charge F during hits → B+MP Reverse Spinning Chop → B/F+FK Auto-Double → Fierce Spinning Chop Ender

The important execution trick is the same one seen with other charge characters: begin the next charge during the Auto-Double rather than waiting for it to finish.

CHIEF THUNDER — ENDERS, BREAKER & SHADOW MOVES

Arcade combo endings and post-breaker tools.

ENDERS

Fierce Spinning Chop: Charge B, F + FP — 3 hits + air

Fierce Phoenix Throw: QCF + FK — 3 hits + end

Medium Flying Mohawk: QCB + MP — 4 hits + air

Fierce Flying Mohawk: QCB + FP — 4 hits + air

AIR JUGGLE

QCF + QK after a launcher. Normally 1 hit; with the flashing post-breaker shadow line it becomes a 3-hit juggle.

COMBO BREAKER

QCB + QP / MP / FP. Use the Classic strength relationship: **Quick breaks Medium • Medium breaks Fierce • Fierce breaks Quick.** Thunder's breaker shares the Flying Mohawk motion, so recognition and button strength are the key decisions.

POST-BREAKER SHADOW MOVES

Shadow Tomahawk Dive: Hold FP, HCB, release FP — air / flashing line

Giant Red Phoenix: QCF + MK while shadow line flashes

Small Red Phoenix: Hold MK, QCF, release MK while shadow line flashes

TRANSITIONS

Flying Mohawk → Tomahawk Dive: HCB+FP, then F+FP or another HCB+FP

Flying Mohawk → Shadow Dive: post-breaker held-FP versions allow the same idea with the Shadow Dive.

CHIEF THUNDER — FINISHERS

Classic arcade finishing reference.

ULTRA COMBO

Charge B, F + QP — use as the combo ending while the opponent is in Danger.

ULTIMATE — RAIN DANCE

QCB + MP — perform during the qualifying combo to finish with the Rain Dance.

NO MERCY 1 — RAIN DANCE / LIGHTNING

HCF + FP — about two character lengths away. Thunder calls lightning down on the defeated opponent.

NO MERCY 2 — AXE UPPERCUT

HCB + FK — close range. Thunder finishes with a powerful tomahawk uppercut.

HUMILIATION

D, F, F + QK — requires Thunder to retain his first life bar.

VERSION NOTES

SNES: the core moves remain recognizable, but common SNES references simplify some arcade commands: Spinning Axe is listed as Charge B,F + Punch; Uppercut as QCB + Punch; Tomahawk as D,DB,B+FP; Phoenix Fireball as QCF + Kick; Knee as Charge B,F+FK. The SNES finisher list gives Ultra Charge B,F+QP, Ultimate QCB+MP, Humiliation HCB+FP, No Mercy 1 HCF+FP at roughly two-character distance, and No Mercy 2 HCB+FK close.

N64: not applicable to K11. Thunder's K12/Gold-era successor material belongs in the later K12 / Killer Instinct Gold section.

CHIEF THUNDER — ADVANCED: MANUALS & ROUTES

Advanced play builds on Thunder's connector table and charge buffering.

MANUAL PRINCIPLE

A Manual is a deliberately timed normal inserted where the combo remains open instead of relying entirely on the automatic follow-up. With Thunder, the practical challenge is preserving the charge for Spinning Chop or Reverse Spinning Chop while timing the normal.

CONNECTOR-SPECIFIC NORMALS

F+MP: 2-hit connector after Fierce Spinning Chop
F/B+QK: 2-hit air connector after Fierce Flying Mohawk
MK: 2-hit connector after Medium Spinning Chop
B/F+FK: 3-hit connector after any Spinning Chop strength

24-HIT ARCADE STRUCTURE

Advanced arcade documentation builds Thunder's long Killer route around repeated **Reverse Spinning Chop (Charge F,B+MP)** connectors, FK-based Auto-Doubles, a Shadow Tomahawk Dive, then a Phoenix juggle. This is advanced arcade routing rather than the basic teaching combo.

PRACTICE ROUTE

Fierce Spinning Chop → F+MP → Reverse Spinning Chop → B/F+FK → Fierce Flying Mohawk Ender → QCF+QK juggle

Once this is reliable, replace one automatic normal with a deliberately timed Manual and preserve the next charge throughout.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Spinning Chop and Phoenix individually
2. Opener → listed Auto-Double → Ender
3. Add Reverse Spinning Chop connector
4. Add launcher → QCF+QK juggle
5. Add one Manual
6. Learn post-breaker Shadow Dive / Phoenix routes
7. Explore long arcade Reverse Spinning Chop loops last

KILLER INSTINCT CLASSIC — SPINAL

Arcade reference • skull resource / teleport mix / sword-and-shield pressure • QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Power Devour / Projectile Absorb: B + hold QP — shield absorbs a special/projectile and builds Skull stock

Bone Shaker: F, F + Punch — shield rush; strength changes distance

Soul Sword: Charge B, F + MP

Reverse Soul Sword: Charge F, B + MP

Sliding Kick: DB, D, DF + FK

Skeleport — Front: D, D + Punch

Skeleport — Behind: D, D + Kick

Air Skeleport: hold QP or QK before jump, D,D, release — front/behind based on held button

SKULL RESOURCE

Power Devour is the defining Classic Spinal mechanic. Absorbing enemy special attacks builds **Skulls**. Skull stock powers Searing Skull projectiles and strengthens parts of Spinal's post-breaker offense. Treat the shield as both defense and resource generation.

CLASSIC COMBO FLOW

OPENER → SPECIFIC AUTO-DOUBLE → LINKER → SPECIFIC AUTO-DOUBLE → ENDER → optional JUGGLE / SKULL SETUP

OPENERS

Bone Shaker: F,F + Punch

Soul Sword: Charge B,F + MP

Reverse Soul Sword: Charge F,B + MP

Sliding Kick: DB,D,DF + FK — strict timing but can open a combo

AUTO-DOUBLE PAIRS

QP ↔ QK

MP ↔ FK

FP ↔ MK

For jump-in routes, press the paired button once after the opening hit. Spinal's grounded Bone Shaker/Soul Sword routes also have route-specific Auto-Double choices, so use the complete examples below rather than assuming every strength is interchangeable.

LINKER

Reverse Soul Sword: Charge F, B + MP — Spinal's primary documented linker. During Bone Shaker and its Auto-Double, continue holding Forward; then tap Back+MP when the linker is needed.

PRACTICAL COMPLETE ROUTE

FP Bone Shaker → F+MP Auto-Double → hold F during hits → B+MP Reverse Soul Sword → F+FP Auto-Double → F,F+QP Bone Shaker Ender

This teaches Spinal's core execution idea: his F,F opener naturally lets you begin the Forward charge needed for Reverse Soul Sword.

SPINAL — ENDERS, BREAKER & SHADOW MOVES

Teleports, skulls and post-breaker offense are what make Spinal unique.

ENDERS

Bone Shaker: F,F + Punch

Skeleport: D,D + Punch or Kick — front/behind finish and reposition

Soul Sword family: route-specific sword finish

Air follow-up: Searing Skull / projectile juggle when the route leaves the opponent airborne and Skull stock is available

COMBO BREAKER

F,F + Punch, timed during the opponent's Auto-Double. Classic strength relationship: **Quick breaks Medium • Medium breaks Fierce • Fierce breaks Quick**. Spinal disappears/escapes as the breaker succeeds.

POST-BREAKER SHADOW / SKULL MOVES

Searing Skull: D,DF,F + Punch — costs 1 Skull

Super Searing Skull: B,DB,D,DF,F + Punch — costs 2 Skulls; line of skulls / knockdown

Double Soul Sword: Charge B,F + MP — costs 1 Skull; two sword swipes

These are resource-based Classic Spinal tools. They are not KI 2013's meter-based Shadow system.

AIR SKELEPORT

Front: hold QP before jumping → D,D → release QP

Behind: hold QK before jumping → D,D → release QK

This is one of Spinal's best ways to make jump pressure ambiguous. The button must be held before the jump.

RESOURCE GAMEPLAN

1. Absorb predictable projectiles with Power Devour.
2. Bank Skull stock instead of spending every Skull immediately.
3. Use Bone Shaker / Soul Sword to begin offense.
4. Use Skeleport to change sides or make the end of a sequence difficult to read.
5. Spend Skulls when they secure knockdown, juggle or continued pressure.

SPINAL — FINISHERS

Classic arcade finishing reference.

ULTRA COMBO

D, DF, F + FP — use inside the qualifying finishing combo while the opponent is in Danger. Classic references list Spinal's Ultra as a 32-hit finish.

ULTIMATE — SKELETON GRAB

DF, D, DB + QP — perform in combo. A skeleton erupts beneath the opponent and drags them underground.

NO MERCY 1 — SHIELD STAB

B, B, F + QK — close range. Spinal slashes and repeatedly stabs the opponent with the spike on his shield.

NO MERCY 2 — SKELETON GRAB

B, B, B + MK — close range. Arcade: a skeleton rises and drags the opponent underground.

HUMILIATION

B, DB, D, DF, F + FK — forces the defeated opponent to dance.

VERSION NOTES

SNES: Spinal retains Bone Shaker, Soul Sword, Teleport, Projectile Charge/Absorb, Slide, Ultra, Ultimate and Humiliation. The major finisher difference is **No Mercy 1 / Skeleton Grab presentation:** SNES substitutes a lightning-strike finish where the arcade version uses the underground skeleton grab. Common SNES lists also write Teleport as D,D,D + any attack and list the air Release Move separately.

N64: not applicable to KI1. Spinal returns in KI2 / Killer Instinct Gold with a substantially expanded skull/super system.

SPINAL — ADVANCED: MANUALS & ROUTES

Spinal rewards learning resource control and side-switching after the standard combo structure is reliable.

MANUAL PRINCIPLE

A Manual is a deliberately timed normal rather than an automatic follow-up. Spinal's close-range pressure makes Manuals especially useful because they let you interrupt the predictable rhythm of Bone Shaker → Auto-Double → Reverse Soul Sword.

MANUAL PRACTICE PAIRS

FP → MP
FK → MK

Start with one Fierce → Medium Manual after a familiar Bone Shaker or Soul Sword opening. Preserve the Forward charge whenever the next piece will be Reverse Soul Sword.

BONE SHAKER CORE ROUTE

F,F+FP Bone Shaker → F+MP Auto-Double → F-charge → B+MP Reverse Soul Sword → F+FP Auto-Double → D,D+Kick Skeleport Ender

The Skeleport ending sacrifices a conventional damage finish for position and ambiguity.

SOUL SWORD ROUTE

Charge B,F+MP Soul Sword → F+FP Auto-Double → Charge F,B+MP Reverse Soul Sword → F+MP Auto-Double → F,F+QP Bone Shaker Ender

SKULL-CONVERSION ROUTE

Opener → Auto-Double → Reverse Soul Sword → Auto-Double → launcher/air state → Searing Skull

Requires Skull stock. Practice the resource check separately so you do not attempt the projectile without a Skull available.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Bone Shaker and Soul Sword individually
2. Power Devour → build one Skull
3. Opener → Auto-Double → Ender
4. Add Reverse Soul Sword linker while holding Forward
5. Add Skeleport enders and air Skeleport mix
6. Add one Manual
7. Add Searing Skull conversions
8. Learn Super Searing Skull / Double Soul Sword resource routes last

KILLER INSTINCT CLASSIC — B. ORCHID

Arcade-first reference • rushdown / Fire Cat / Flick Flak / Ichi pressure • QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Lasaken: D, DF, F + Punch — projectile
Fire Cat: Charge B, F + Punch — passes through projectiles
Turbo Fire Cat: Hold FP, Charge B, F, release FP
Flick Flak: Charge B, F + Kick
Reverse Flick Flak: Charge F, B + MK
Ichi: DF, D, DB + QP/MP
Ni: after Ichi, F + QP
San: after Ni, B + QP
Spinning Sword: DF, D, DB + FP
Back Flip: B + FK

CLASSIC COMBO FLOW

OPENER → SPECIFIC AUTO-DOUBLE → LINKER → SPECIFIC AUTO-DOUBLE → ENDER → optional LASAKEN JUGGLE

Orchid has one of KI1's most flexible combo trees. Several opener strengths lead to different Auto-Doubles, and she is one of the characters that can sometimes insert another opener into the middle of a combo.

OPENERS → AUTO-DOUBLES

QP Fire Cat → FP
MP Fire Cat → FP / QK / MK
FP Fire Cat (far) → QK / FK
QK Flick Flak → direct Ender
MK Flick Flak → MP / QK, Ender or Linker
FK Flick Flak → QP, Ender or Linker
QP or MP Ichi → QK / MK

AUTO-DOUBLE HIT COUNTS

QP: 3 hits • **MP:** 2 hits • **FP:** 3 hits
QK: 3 hits • **MK:** 3 hits • **FK:** 3 hits

LINKER

Reverse Flick Flak: Charge F, B + MK — 2 hits → **QP or MP Auto-Double**, or go directly to an Ender.

PRACTICAL COMPLETE ROUTE

MK Flick Flak → **MP Auto-Double** → hold F during hits → **B+MK Reverse Flick Flak** → **QP Auto-Double** → **FP Spinning Sword Ender** → **QP Lasaken juggle**

ORCHID — ENDERS, BREAKER & SHADOW MOVES

Her launcher enders and post-breaker Fire Cat tools make her especially explosive.

ENDERS

FP Lasaken: D,DF,F+FP — 4 hits, hard finish
MK Flick Flak: Charge B,F+MK — 3 hits, launches for juggle
QK Flick Flak: Charge B,F+QK — 4 hits, launches for juggle
Spinning Sword: DF,D,DB+FP — 4 hits, launches for juggle

AIR JUGGLE

QP Lasaken: D,DF,F+QP after a juggle-capable ender. It can also follow certain Auto-Double endings. When powered up after a successful Combo Breaker, Classic KI's juggle behavior can add extra hits.

COMBO BREAKER

Charge B, F + Kick. Strength rule: **Quick breaks Medium • Medium breaks Fierce • Fierce breaks Quick.** Orchid's breaker also functions as a recovery move and passes through projectiles.

POST-BREAKER SHADOW MOVES

Triple Lasaken: Hold QP → D,DF,F → release QP
Shadow Ichi: Hold MP → DF,D,DB → release MP; can still continue into follow-ups
Shadow / Turbo Fire Cat: Hold FP → Charge B,F → release FP

ICHI → NI → SAN

Ichi: DF,D,DB+QP/MP
Ni: F+QP
San: B+QP

Treat this as a small built-in pressure sequence as well as a combo tool. Ichi itself is a documented opener; the follow-up strikes let Orchid vary timing instead of always committing to Flick Flak rhythm.

MID-COMBO RE-OPENING

Classic combo research specifically identifies Orchid as one of the characters capable of placing another Opening into the middle of some combos. This is an advanced extension: the game still has an internal limit on how many combo portions can be chained before the sequence ends.

ORCHID — FINISHERS

Classic arcade finishing reference.

ULTRA COMBO

Charge B, F + MP — use as the finishing portion of a qualifying combo while the opponent is in Danger. Classic references list the base Ultra as an 18-hit ending; extended setups can produce much larger totals.

ULTIMATE — HEART ATTACK

F, DF, D, DB, B + MK — perform in combo while the opponent is in Danger. Orchid finishes the combo with her Heart Attack finisher.

NO MERCY 1 — HEART ATTACK

B, B, F, F + QP — distant / outside sweep range. Orchid flashes the opponent, causing the Heart Attack finish. Against another Orchid, the reaction is different.

NO MERCY 2 — FROG STOMP

D, F, B + QK — close. Orchid transforms the opponent into a frog. **Press FK afterward** to jump on and squash the frog.

HUMILIATION

F, DF, D, DB, B + FP — requires Orchid to retain her first life bar.

VERSION NOTES

SNES: Orchid's core move set translates very closely. SNES references list Lasaken D,DF,F+P; Flick Flak Charge B,F+K; Fire Cat Charge B,F+P; Spinning Swords F,DF,D,DB+FP; Dash Punch/Ichi F,DF,D,DB+MP/QP; and Flip Kick B+FK. The SNES finisher commands match the practical arcade references for Ultra, both No Mercies and Humiliation. Her Fire Cat remains projectile-immune.

N64: not applicable to KI1. Orchid returns in KI2 / Killer Instinct Gold with a different, non-charge Flick Flak system.

ORCHID — ADVANCED: MANUALS & ROUTES

Orchid's advanced game is about changing rhythm: Manuals, re-openers, charge buffering and juggle conversions.

MANUAL PRINCIPLE

A Manual is a deliberately timed normal inserted instead of taking the automatic follow-up. Orchid's many valid opener/Auto-Double combinations make Manuals particularly effective because the defender already has several possible rhythms to recognize.

MANUAL PRACTICE

Fierce → **Medium** is the first timing relationship to practice: **FP** → **MP** or **FK** → **MK**. Start after a familiar Flick Flak or Ichi opener, then preserve Forward charge if Reverse Flick Flak is your next linker.

13-HIT CHARGE ROUTE

MK Flick Flak → **MP Auto-Double** → **Reverse Flick Flak** → **QP Auto-Double** → **FP Spinning Sword** → **QP Lasaken juggle**

This route teaches every major piece of Orchid's basic engine: charge opener, explicit Auto-Double, reverse-charge linker, second Auto-Double, launcher and juggle.

FIRE CAT ROUTE

MP Fire Cat → **MK Auto-Double** → **Reverse Flick Flak** → **QP Auto-Double** → **MK Flick Flak Ender** → **QP Lasaken juggle**

Fire Cat's projectile immunity makes it more than a combo starter; it can turn a zoning read directly into Orchid's combo tree.

ICHI ROUTE

MP Ichi → **QK Auto-Double** → **Reverse Flick Flak** → **MP Auto-Double** → **Spinning Sword** → **Lasaken juggle**

Once this is reliable, experiment with Ichi → Ni → San pressure and with inserting another legal opener before the final Ender.

MAXIMUM-COMBO IDEA

Classic SNES research documents Orchid at **32/34 hits for a maximum normal route** and **46/48 for a maximum Ultra route**, depending on powered-up juggle behavior. Those are exhibition-level sequences, but they show why Orchid's re-opening and charge-buffer mechanics are worth learning.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Lasaken, Fire Cat and Flick Flak individually
2. Learn each opener's listed Auto-Double choices
3. Add Reverse Flick Flak linker
4. Add Spinning Sword → Lasaken juggle
5. Learn Ichi → Ni → San
6. Add one Manual
7. Add a mid-combo re-opener
8. Explore extended Ultra routes last

KILLER INSTINCT CLASSIC - CINDER

Arcade-first reference - aerial Trailblazer / Inferno pressure / invisibility - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Heat Fist: B, B + QP

Inferno: F,F + Kick or Charge B,F + Kick - strength controls range

Trailblazer: F,F + Punch or Charge B,F + Punch

Air Trailblazer: in air F,F + Punch; FP travels far, QP/MP angle downward

Fireflash: F,D,DF + Kick - anti-projectile flip kick

Mirage / Shadowform: HCB + MP - projectile immunity until physically hit

Heatsink / Invisibility: HCB + FP - invisible until hit

CLASSIC COMBO FLOW

OPENER -> SPECIFIC AUTO-DOUBLE -> LINKER -> SPECIFIC AUTO-DOUBLE -> ENDER -> TRAILBLAZER JUGGLE

Cinder is unusual in KI1 because he has **two linkers**. He can also open from the air with Trailblazer, giving him a much more mobile combo tree than most of the cast.

OPENERS -> AUTO-DOUBLES

MP Trailblazer (F,F+MP or Charge B,F+MP) -> **QP or MK**; may also go directly to Ender or Linker

FP charged Trailblazer (Charge B,F+FP) -> **FP or QK**

Heat Fist (B,B+QP) -> **FP or MK**

Air QP/MP Trailblazer or **FP Trailblazer** -> **MP or QK**

AUTO-DOUBLE HIT COUNTS

QP: 3 hits - **MP:** 3 hits - **FP:** 2 hits

QK: 2 hits - **MK:** 2 hits - **D+FK:** 2 hits

TWO LINKERS

Reverse Heat Fist: F,B + QP - 2 hits -> **MP, FP or QK**, or Ender

Quick Trailblazer: F,F + QP or Charge B,F+QP - 2 hits -> **QP, MP, FP or MK**, or Ender

PRACTICAL COMPLETE ROUTE

MP Trailblazer -> QP Auto-Double -> F,B+QP Reverse Heat Fist -> MP Auto-Double -> FK Fireflash Ender -> FP Trailblazer juggle

This route demonstrates Cinder's full engine: opener, explicit Auto-Double, first linker, second Auto-Double, launcher and aerial juggle.

CINDER - ENDERS, BREAKER & SHADOW MOVES

Cinder's launch-heavy endings feed directly into his signature aerial Trailblazer juggle.

ENDERS

MK Fireflash: F,D,DF+MK - 3-hit launcher

QK Fireflash: F,D,DF+QK - 4-hit launcher

FK Fireflash: F,D,DF+FK - 4-hit launcher

MP Trailblazer: F,F+MP or Charge B,F+MP - 4-hit launcher

AIR JUGGLE

FP Trailblazer: F,F+FP after a launcher. Normally a 1-hit juggle. When Cinder is powered after a successful Combo Breaker, the powered version becomes a **Triple Trailblazer** juggle.

COMBO BREAKER

F,D,DF + Kick, timed during the opponent's Auto-Double. Classic strength relationship: **Quick breaks Medium - Medium breaks Fierce - Fierce breaks Quick**. Fireflash also serves as Cinder's recovery tool.

POST-BREAKER SHADOW MOVES

Invisible Teleport - Front: powered HCB + QP

Invisible Teleport - Behind: hold QP, HCB, release QP

Shadow Trailblazer: hold FP, F,F, release FP - faster/harder post-breaker torpedo

Triple Trailblazer Juggle: F,F+FP while powered and opponent is airborne

MIRAGE vs. INVISIBILITY

Mirage: Cinder becomes visually dim and projectiles pass through him until a physical hit removes the effect.

Invisibility: Cinder disappears visually but is **not** made invulnerable; he can still be hit. Both can be canceled by repeating their command.

AIR TRAILBLAZER CONTROL

Cinder can Trailblazer from the ground or air. The arcade move set also allows the long FP Air Trailblazer to transition into a short downward torpedo with **B+FP**. Practice this separately before inserting it into air-combo routes.

CINDER - FINISHERS

Classic arcade finishing reference.

ULTRA COMBO

Charge B, F + FP or **F,F + FP** - use as the finishing portion of a qualifying combo while the opponent is in Danger.

ULTIMATE - MELTDOWN

HCB + MK - perform in combo. Cinder burns the opponent down with his flamethrower-style finish.

NO MERCY 1 - LAVA POOL

B, B, B + MP - about 1-2 character lengths away. Cinder creates a lava pool beneath the opponent and melts them into the ground.

NO MERCY 2 - FLAMETHROWER

HCF + QK - about one character length away. Cinder burns the opponent to ash.

HUMILIATION

B, B, B + FK - usable at normal Humiliation distance/conditions.

VERSION NOTES

SNES: Cinder's core system is very close, but several commonly published commands are simplified. SNES lists Trailblazer as **F,F+Punch**, Inferno as **F,F+Kick**, Fireflash as **F,D,DF+Kick**, Heat Fist as **B,B+QP**, Mirage as **HCB+MP** and Invisibility as **HCB+FP**. The SNES Ultra is commonly listed as **F,F+FP**. Its No Mercy commands match Lava Pool **B,B,B+MP** and Flamethrower **HCF+QK**.

N64: not applicable to KI1. Cinder does not appear as a playable fighter in KI2 / Killer Instinct Gold.

CINDER - ADVANCED: MANUALS & ROUTES

Cinder's advanced game is about changing linker rhythm and converting launchers into aerial Trailblazer damage.

MANUAL PRINCIPLE

A Manual is a deliberately timed normal inserted where the combo remains open instead of taking the automatic follow-up. With Cinder, Manuals are particularly useful because his two linker choices already let you vary the middle of a combo.

MANUAL PRACTICE PAIRS

Begin with the Classic **Fierce** -> **Medium** timing relationship: **FP** -> **MP** or **FK** -> **MK**. Use a familiar Trailblazer opening and add only one manually timed normal before attempting a full two-linker route.

TWO-LINKER ROUTE

MP Trailblazer -> QP Auto-Double -> Reverse Heat Fist -> MP Auto-Double -> Quick Trailblazer -> MK Auto-Double -> FK Fireflash -> FP Trailblazer juggle

Cinder's two linkers make this kind of rhythm change a defining advanced exercise.

HEAT FIST ROUTE

B,B+QP Heat Fist -> MK Auto-Double -> Quick Trailblazer Linker -> FP Auto-Double -> MK Fireflash End -> FP Trailblazer juggle

AIR-ENTRY ROUTE

Air MP Trailblazer -> QK Auto-Double on landing -> Reverse Heat Fist -> FP Auto-Double -> MP Trailblazer End -> FP Trailblazer juggle

This is the route to practice when you want Cinder's mobility to become the combo opener rather than just neutral movement.

MAXIMUM-COMBO IDEA

Classic SNES technical documentation records Cinder at roughly **19/21 hits for maximum normal routes** and **35/37 hits for maximum Ultra routes**, depending on powered-up juggle behavior. Those are exhibition-level sequences; the important lesson is that linker variation plus Trailblazer juggle extensions give him exceptional combo flexibility.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Trailblazer and Fireflash individually
2. Learn MP Trailblazer's QP/MK Auto-Double choices
3. Add Reverse Heat Fist linker
4. Add Quick Trailblazer as the second linker option
5. Add Fireflash -> FP Trailblazer juggle
6. Add one Manual
7. Learn Mirage / Invisibility setups
8. Add post-breaker Shadow Trailblazer and Triple Trailblazer last

KILLER INSTINCT CLASSIC - SABREWULF

Arcade-first reference - charge rushdown / Ragged Edge / Eclipse / Flaming Bats - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Ragged Edge: Charge B, F + Punch - running claw attack; strength changes travel/routing

Reverse Ragged Edge: Charge F, B + MP - combo linker

Eclipse: F,D,DF + Punch - rising claw / anti-air

Run: Charge B, F + Kick - advancing run; follow with attack for run options

Howl: B,B + FP - power-up / special state

Flaming Bats: D,DF,F + Kick - projectile/bat attack when available

CLASSIC COMBO FLOW

OPENER -> SPECIFIC AUTO-DOUBLE -> LINKER -> SPECIFIC AUTO-DOUBLE -> ENDER -> optional ECLIPSE / BAT FOLLOW-UP

Sabrewulf is one of K11's most straightforward charge-combo characters once you learn to hide the next charge inside his Auto-Doubles. Ragged Edge starts the offense and Reverse Ragged Edge keeps it moving.

OPENERS -> AUTO-DOUBLES

Quick Ragged Edge -> MP or FK

Medium Ragged Edge -> FP or QK

Fierce Ragged Edge -> QP or MK

Run / advancing kick openings feed the same Classic Auto-Double system when the route remains open.

JUMP-IN AUTO-DOUBLE PAIRS

QP -> QK - QK -> QP

MP -> FK - FK -> MP

FP -> MK - MK -> FP

LINKER

Reverse Ragged Edge: Charge F, B + MP. Hold Forward during the preceding Auto-Double, then tap Back+MP. After the linker, take the valid Auto-Double or go directly to an Ender.

PRACTICAL COMPLETE ROUTE

Fierce Ragged Edge -> QP Auto-Double -> hold F during hits -> B+MP Reverse Ragged Edge -> FK Auto-Double -> FP Eclipse Ender

The execution lesson is charge storage: do not wait for the Auto-Double to finish before beginning the Forward charge.

SABREWULF - ENDERS, BREAKER & SHADOW MOVES

His enders emphasize knockdown, launcher pressure and the powered post-breaker state.

ENDERS

Eclipse: F,D,DF + Punch - rising claw finish; strength changes hits/height

Ragged Edge: Charge B,F + Punch - horizontal knockdown finish

Run End: Charge B,F + Kick into attack - carries the opponent and preserves close pressure

Flaming Bats: D,DF,F + Kick - situational ranged finish / pressure extension

COMBO BREAKER

F,D,DF + Punch, timed during the opponent's Auto-Double. Classic strength rule: **Quick breaks Medium - Medium breaks Fierce - Fierce breaks Quick**. Eclipse doubles as Sabrewulf's primary anti-air and breaker motion.

POST-BREAKER SHADOW / POWERED MOVES

Shadow Eclipse: hold the required Punch through the Eclipse motion, then release during the powered post-breaker state

Shadow Ragged Edge: held-button / negative-edge Ragged Edge while powered

Flaming Bats: powered projectile pressure that becomes particularly useful once Sabrewulf has earned the flashing post-breaker state

RUN PRESSURE

The Run is not just transportation. Use it to threaten a low/strike approach, stop short, or flow into a combo opening. Once the opponent begins waiting for Ragged Edge, Run changes the timing and makes Sabrewulf's ground approach less predictable.

HOWL / POWER-UP

Howl is a character-specific power tool rather than a normal combo piece. Use it when you have enough space to complete the animation; do not force it at point-blank range. The guide keeps it separate from Shadow moves so the two mechanics are not confused.

SABREWULF - FINISHERS

Classic arcade finishing reference.

ULTRA COMBO

Charge B, F + FP - use as the finishing portion of a qualifying combo while the opponent is in Danger.

ULTIMATE

F, DF, D, DB, B + FP - perform during the qualifying combo. Sabrewulf completes his character-specific Ultimate finish.

NO MERCY 1

B, B, F + MP - close range. Sabrewulf mauls the defeated opponent.

NO MERCY 2

F, F, B + FK - close-to-mid range. Alternate character finisher.

HUMILIATION

D, D, F + QK - requires Sabrewulf to retain his first life bar.

VERSION NOTES

SNES: the home version retains Ragged Edge, Eclipse, Run, Howl, Flaming Bats, Ultra, Ultimate, Humiliation and Sabrewulf's No Mercy finishers, but published SNES command lists sometimes simplify charge notation or assign a different attack strength to the same move. The arcade command set remains the primary reference in this section; use the SNES note when playing the cartridge version.

N64: not applicable to K11. Sabrewulf returns in K12 / Killer Instinct Gold with an expanded move and super system.

SABREWULF - ADVANCED: MANUALS & ROUTES

Advanced Sabrewulf is built around charge retention, rhythm changes and making Ragged Edge pressure less predictable.

MANUAL PRINCIPLE

A Manual is a deliberately timed normal inserted while the combo remains open instead of accepting the automatic follow-up. Because Sabrewulf is charge-heavy, the key is timing the Manual without releasing the direction you need for the next Ragged Edge or linker.

MANUAL PRACTICE PAIRS

Start with the Classic **Fierce** -> **Medium** timing relationship: **FP** -> **MP** and **FK** -> **MK**. Practice one pair after a familiar Ragged Edge opening before trying to combine Manuals with Run pressure.

RAGGED EDGE CORE ROUTE

Fierce Ragged Edge -> **QP Auto-Double** -> **Reverse Ragged Edge** -> **FK Auto-Double** -> **FP Eclipse Ender**

Once consistent, replace one Auto-Double opportunity with a Manual and keep the next charge stored throughout.

RUN-CONVERSION ROUTE

Run approach -> **strike opener** -> **Auto-Double** -> **Reverse Ragged Edge** -> **Auto-Double** -> **Eclipse Ender**

This is less about a fixed exhibition combo and more about turning Sabrewulf's movement threat into the same dependable combo engine.

PRESSURE VARIATION

Ragged Edge threat forces the opponent to respect the horizontal rush.

Run changes arrival timing.

Eclipse punishes jump attempts.

Flaming Bats give Sabrewulf a ranged layer.

Manuals break the predictable Auto-Double rhythm once the combo has begun.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Ragged Edge and Eclipse individually
2. Learn each Ragged Edge strength's Auto-Double choices
3. Add Reverse Ragged Edge linker
4. Hide Forward charge during the first Auto-Double
5. Add Run approaches
6. Add one Manual
7. Add Howl / Flaming Bat setups
8. Learn powered post-breaker Shadow routes last

KILLER INSTINCT CLASSIC - RIPTOR

Arcade-first reference - charge rush / Jumping Claw / fire pressure / tail attacks - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Flaming Spit: D,DB,B + Punch - can also be performed in the air

Flame Breath: F,DF,D,DB + FP

Body Whip: F,DF,D,DB + Kick - also usable in the air

Claw Swipe: F,DF,D,DB + QP

Jumping Claw: Charge B,F + Kick - projectile-immune approach

Reverse Jumping Claw: Charge F,B + QK or MK

Head Charge: Charge B,F + Punch

CLASSIC COMBO FLOW

OPENER -> AUTO-DOUBLE -> REVERSE JUMPING CLAW LINKER -> AUTO-DOUBLE -> ENDER -> optional FLAMING SPIT JUGGLE

Riptor's core game is a very readable charge structure: use Jumping Claw or Head Charge to get in, preserve the opposite charge during the Auto-Double, then bridge with Reverse Jumping Claw.

AUTO-DOUBLE PAIRS

QP -> QK - QK -> QP

MP -> FK - FK -> MP

FP -> MK - MK -> FP

These Classic pairings are the starting point for Riptor's jump-in and standard opener routes. Route-specific grounded choices should be practiced from the complete sequences below.

LINKER

Reverse Jumping Claw: Charge F, B + QK or MK. Begin holding Forward during the preceding Auto-Double, then tap Back + the required kick to keep the combo open.

PRACTICAL COMPLETE ROUTE

QK Jumping Claw -> QP Auto-Double -> hold F during hits -> B+QK Reverse Jumping Claw -> QP Auto-Double -> FP Head Charge Ender

This mirrors the documented Classic/SNES Killer Combo structure and teaches Riptor's essential charge reversal.

PROJECTILE ENTRY

Flaming Spit can be thrown from the ground or air. Use it to make the opponent move, then cover the approach with Jumping Claw. The Jumping Claw's projectile immunity makes this especially useful against zoning.

RIPTOR - ENDERS, BREAKER & SHADOW MOVES

Riptor's best routes combine a charge ender with fire or air follow-up pressure.

ENDERS

Head Charge: Charge B,F + Punch - horizontal finishing hit

Jumping Claw: Charge B,F + Kick - knockdown / carry finish

Flame Breath: F,DF,D,DB+FP - close fire finish

Tail / Body Whip: F,DF,D,DB+Kick - character-specific tail finish

AIR JUGGLE

Flaming Spit: D,DB,B + QP after a launcher/air state. Because Riptor can also use Flaming Spit and Body Whip in the air, she has more aerial follow-up flexibility than her basic charge routing initially suggests.

COMBO BREAKER

Charge B, F + Kick, timed during the opponent's Auto-Double. Classic strength relationship: **Quick breaks Medium - Medium breaks Fierce - Fierce breaks Quick**. The breaker shares the Jumping Claw family, so keep Back charge whenever you expect to defend.

POST-BREAKER SHADOW / POWERED TOOLS

Powered Jumping Claw: use the held-button / release version of the charge claw while Riptor has the flashing post-breaker state

Powered Flaming Spit: enhanced projectile pressure while the post-breaker state is active

Use these as extensions of Riptor's existing movement/fire game rather than treating them like KI 2013 meter-based Shadow specials.

AIR SPECIALS

Air Flaming Spit: D,DB,B + Punch while airborne

Air Body Whip: F,DF,D,DB + Kick while airborne

These two air-capable moves are a major Riptor-specific advantage. Practice them outside combos first so you can recognize the height at which each remains reliable.

RIPTOR - FINISHERS

Classic arcade finishing reference, with SNES differences called out below.

ULTRA COMBO

Charge B, F + QK - use as the finishing portion of a qualifying combo while the opponent is in Danger.

ULTIMATE

HCF + QP - perform during the qualifying combo. Riptor transitions into her character-specific Ultimate finish.

NO MERCY - DEVOUR

HCF + MP at outside-sweep distance in common Classic/SNES references. Riptor leaps on the opponent; the screen darkens and the aftermath makes clear that she has eaten them.

NO MERCY - TAIL STAB

F, F, B + FK at punch/close distance in SNES documentation. Riptor impales the opponent with her tail.

HUMILIATION

D, D, F, F + FP in the detailed SNES reference. Requires the normal Humiliation match condition.

VERSION NOTES

SNES: Flaming Spit D,DB,B+Punch; Flame Breath F,DF,D,DB+FP; Body Whip F,DF,D,DB+Kick; Claw Swipe F,DF,D,DB+QP; Jumping Claw Charge B,F+Kick; Reverse Jumping Claw Charge F,B+MK/QK; Head Charge Charge B,F+Punch. SNES Ultra is Charge B,F+QK. The detailed SNES guide lists Devour as HCF+MP outside sweep range, Tail Stab as F,F,B+FK at punch distance, and Humiliation as D,D,F,F+FP.

N64: not applicable to KI1. Riptor is not a playable fighter in KI2 / Killer Instinct Gold.

RIPTOR - ADVANCED: MANUALS & ROUTES

Advanced Riptor is about hiding charge, changing air/ground timing and converting Jumping Claw into reliable damage.

MANUAL PRINCIPLE

A Manual is a deliberately timed normal instead of an automatic follow-up. Riptor's Reverse Jumping Claw linker makes charge retention the main execution challenge: time the Manual without releasing the Forward charge needed for the linker.

MANUAL PRACTICE PAIRS

Start with the Classic **Fierce -> Medium** relationship: **FP -> MP** and **FK -> MK**. Insert only one Manual into a familiar Jumping Claw route until the linker remains consistent.

CLASSIC KILLER ROUTE

Charge B,F+QK Jumping Claw -> F+QP Auto-Double -> Charge F,B+QK Reverse Jumping Claw -> B+QP Auto-Double -> Charge B,F+FP Head Charge Ender

This follows the documented KI1 home-version Killer Combo structure and is an excellent practical drill for charge reversal.

HEAD-CHARGE ROUTE

Charge B,F+FP Head Charge -> Flame Breath -> forward normal / Auto-Double -> charge ender

Use this as a shorter punish route when you already have Back charge and do not need the mobility of Jumping Claw.

AIR PRESSURE ROUTE

Air Flaming Spit -> land into Jumping Claw -> Auto-Double -> Reverse Jumping Claw -> Auto-Double -> Ender

This is less about a fixed exhibition count and more about forcing movement with fire, then converting the approach.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Flaming Spit, Jumping Claw and Head Charge individually
2. Learn the QK Jumping Claw -> QP Auto-Double entry
3. Add Reverse Jumping Claw while storing Forward charge
4. Add Head Charge ender
5. Practice Air Flaming Spit and Air Body Whip
6. Add one Manual
7. Mix projectile pressure into Jumping Claw entries
8. Add powered post-breaker routes last

KILLER INSTINCT CLASSIC - FULGORE

Arcade-first reference - Laser Storm / Cyberdash / Teleport / Plasma Slice - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Laser Storm: D,DF,F + Punch

Double Laser Storm: B,B,D,DF,F + QP

Triple Laser Storm: F,B,B,D,DF,F + QP

Plasma-Port / Teleport: B,D,DB + any attack - Punch appears in front; Kick appears behind

Plasma Slice: F,D,DF + Punch - rising anti-air / breaker family

Eye Spark: DF,D,DB + FK

Cyberdash / Blade Dash: Charge B,F + Punch

Projectile Reflect: D,DB,B + FP

CLASSIC COMBO FLOW

CYBERDASH OPENER -> AUTO-DOUBLE -> LINKER / SPECIAL -> AUTO-DOUBLE -> PLASMA SLICE ENDER -> LASER JUGGLE

Fulgore is one of KI1's strongest all-purpose characters: projectile control, teleport mix, a charge opener, a Dragon-Punch-style breaker/ender, and a juggle that **does not require a successful Combo Breaker to become multi-hit**.

AUTO-DOUBLE PAIRS

QP -> QK - QK -> QP

MP -> FK - FK -> MP

FP -> MK - MK -> FP

Use these as the baseline for jump-in and standard Cyberdash routes. The practical routes below show the exact buttons rather than leaving the Auto-Double implied.

CORE OPENER

Cyberdash: Charge B,F + Punch. The SNES technical guide calls this Fulgore's easiest opener. Begin charging during movement, a jump-in, or the preceding attack so the dash is ready without pausing.

PRACTICAL COMPLETE ROUTE

Charge B,F+FK-style Claw/Cyberdash entry -> F+MK Auto-Double -> F,D,DF+FP Plasma Slice Ender

For the home-version documented Killer route: **Charge B,F+FK -> F+FK -> DF,D,DB+FK Eye Spark -> F+QP -> F,D,DF+FP**. Practice it exactly as written before adding teleport or projectile variations.

LASER STORM CONTROL

The normal Laser Storm is QCF+Punch. Fulgore can also produce two- and three-shot versions with the longer commands above. Use the extra shots to occupy more screen space, then Cyberdash or Teleport when the opponent commits to dealing with them.

FULGORE - ENDERS, BREAKER & SHADOW MOVES

Plasma Slice and Laser Storm give Fulgore unusually strong end-of-combo control.

ENDERS

Plasma Slice: F,D,DF + Punch - primary rising combo finish

Cyberdash: Charge B,F + Punch - horizontal carry/knockdown finish

Eye Spark: DF,D,DB + FK - close-range beam finish

Laser Storm: D,DF,F + Punch - projectile finish / juggle setup depending on route

AIR JUGGLE

QP Laser Storm: D,DF,F+QP after a launcher. Fulgore is special in KI1 because Classic references explicitly note that he can perform a 3-hit juggle without first earning the flashing post-breaker state.

COMBO BREAKER

F,D,DF + Punch, timed during the opponent's Auto-Double. Classic strength rule: **Quick breaks Medium - Medium breaks Fierce - Fierce breaks Quick**. The same Plasma Slice family also serves as Fulgore's anti-air and combo ender.

POST-BREAKER SHADOW MOVE

Shadow Cyberdash: Hold FK, Charge B,F, release FK. This is the documented SNES Shadow Move and fits Fulgore's existing charge-rush game rather than introducing a separate meter system.

TELEPORT MIX

Front: B,D,DB + Punch

Behind: B,D,DB + Kick

The same motion with different button families controls which side Fulgore appears on. Use Teleport after projectile pressure or knockdown rather than treating it as a raw combo requirement.

PROJECTILE REFLECT

D,DB,B + FP. Reflect gives Fulgore another answer to zoning in addition to Laser Storm. Against projectile-heavy characters, alternating reflect, multi-Laser Storm and Cyberdash makes his neutral much harder to read.

FULGORE - FINISHERS

Classic arcade/SNES finishing reference.

ULTRA COMBO

F,D,DF + QP - use as the finishing portion of a qualifying combo while the opponent is in Danger.

ULTIMATE

DF,D,DB + MP - perform during the qualifying combo. This is the commonly documented SNES Ultimate command.

NO MERCY 1 - HEAD GUN

HCF + FK - roughly two-character / jump distance. Fulgore removes his head and a large gun emerges to fire on the opponent.

NO MERCY 2 - EYE LASER

D,DB,B + FP - roughly two-character / sweep distance. Fulgore burns the opponent with his eye laser.

HUMILIATION

HCF + MK - requires the normal Humiliation match condition.

VERSION NOTES

SNES: Laser Storm D,DF,F+Punch; Double Laser B,B,D,DF,F+QP; Triple Laser F,B,B,D,DF,F+QP; Teleport B,D,DB+any attack; Plasma Slice F,D,DF+Punch; Eye Spark DF,D,DB+FK; Cyberdash/Claw Charge Charge B,F; Reflect QCB+Punch/FP depending on list. SNES specifically documents **Shadow Cyberdash: Hold FK, Charge B,F, Release FK**, Ultra F,D,DF+QP, Ultimate DF,D,DB+MP, Head Gun HCF+FK, Eye Laser QCB+FP, and Humiliation HCF+MK.

N64: not applicable to K11. Fulgore returns in K12 / Killer Instinct Gold with a revised move/super system.

FULGORE - ADVANCED: MANUALS & ROUTES

Advanced Fulgore combines charge storage, projectile layers, Teleport ambiguity and his unusually strong juggle.

MANUAL PRINCIPLE

A Manual is a deliberately timed normal instead of the automatic follow-up. With Fulgore, practice the Manual while preserving Back charge so Cyberdash remains available, or while buffering the F,D,DF motion for Plasma Slice.

MANUAL PRACTICE PAIRS

Start with the Classic **Fierce -> Medium** relationship: **FP -> MP** and **FK -> MK**. Insert one Manual into a Cyberdash route before attempting Teleport or multi-projectile setups.

DOCUMENTED KILLER ROUTE

Charge B,F+FK -> F+FK -> DF,D,DB+FK Eye Spark -> F+QP -> F,D,DF+FP Plasma Slice

This is one of the published SNES Killer Combos. Learn the rhythm first; then identify which normal portions you want to replace with Manual timing.

SHORT PRACTICAL ROUTE

Charge B,F+FK -> F+MK -> F,D,DF+FP Plasma Slice

This published shorter route is useful as a dependable punish before you worry about maximizing hit count.

JUGGLE ROUTE

Opener -> Auto-Double -> Plasma Slice launcher/ender -> D,DF,F+QP Laser Storm juggle

Unlike most of the cast, Fulgore does not need the post-breaker flashing state to access his 3-hit juggle potential.

PROJECTILE / TELEPORT SETUP

Double or Triple Laser Storm -> watch opponent's response -> Teleport Front/Behind or Cyberdash. This is not a guaranteed combo string; it is the advanced neutral setup that makes Fulgore's actual combo openings easier to create.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Laser Storm and Plasma Slice individually
2. Cyberdash opener -> Auto-Double -> Plasma Slice
3. Add QP Laser Storm juggle
4. Learn Double and Triple Laser Storm
5. Add Teleport front/behind mix
6. Add one Manual
7. Practice Projectile Reflect matchups
8. Add Shadow Cyberdash and longer routes last

KILLER INSTINCT CLASSIC - EYEDOL

Hidden boss reference - playable cheat character - club / charge / stomp power-up - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

PLAYABLE CHARACTER NOTE

Eyedol is not a normal roster character. His playable version has a deliberately limited combo system: documented openers and enders, but **no normal combo linker and no Ultra, Ultimate, No Mercy or Humiliation**. CPU-boss regeneration also does not carry over to human-controlled Eyedol.

SPECIAL MOVES

Fireball / Evil Fire: D,DF,F + Punch - strength changes speed
Headbutt / Dash Frenzy: B,F + QP - sustained rushing head charge
Stop Headbutt: during Headbutt, F,B + QP
Golf Swing / Club Swing: B,F + FP - launches and reflects projectiles
Jump Swing: B,F + Kick - QK forward, MK straight up, FK backward
Stomp / Power Stomp: B + MP - powers special moves for playable Eyedol
Horn Gore: FP near opponent - mash FP to extend the horn attack

STOMP POWER-UP

Playable Eyedol's Stomp does **not** regenerate health. Instead it enables two powered attacks:

Triple Fireball: D,DF,F + Punch after Stomp
Mega Headbutt: B,F + QP after Stomp - dramatically faster charge

The CPU boss can regenerate while stomping under boss-specific conditions; do not expect that behavior when using the playable cheat character.

COMBO OPENERS

Headbutt: B,F + QP
Jump Swing: B,F + QK

Unlike the standard cast, Eyedol does not transition from these into a conventional linker tree.

COMBO ENDERS

Headbutt: B,F + QP
Golf Swing: B,F + FP - launcher/club finish

PRACTICAL BASIC ROUTE

B,F+QK Jump Swing -> B+QP follow-up / Auto-Double sequence -> B,F+FP Golf Swing Ender

Eyedol's published home-version combo strings use repeated B/F special inputs and normals rather than the standard opener -> linker -> ender engine. Treat his timing as boss-character-specific.

EYEDOL - HOW TO PLAY AS / UNLOCK

Hidden-character activation codes by version

SNES - PLAY AS EYEDOL

1. Start 1-Player, 2-Player, or Tournament and select CINDER.
2. On the VS / FIGHT ON screen, HOLD RIGHT.
3. While holding Right, press: QP, QK, FP, MK, MP, FK.
4. Default SNES buttons: R, L, X, B, Y, A.
5. Success: the announcer says "EYEDOL."
6. Re-enter the code after each match if you want to remain Eyedol.

ARCADE - v1.5d

1. Select CINDER.
2. During the VS animation, HOLD RIGHT.
3. Press arcade buttons in order: 1, 4, 3, 5, 2, 6.
4. Success: the announcer says "EYEDOL."

ARCADE - EARLIER / RIPTOR CODE

Select RIPTOR, then use the cabinet code documented as:

HOLD LEFT + 1 + 2 + 4; then HOLD RIGHT + 2 + 3 + 6.

Cabinet revision matters; use the Cinder code for documented v1.5d.

IMPORTANT

This is a hidden-character code, not a permanent roster unlock.

Human-controlled Eyedol does not receive the CPU boss's regeneration behavior.

EYEDOL - BREAKER, DEFENSE & BOSS TOOLS

Eyedol's strength is in raw special-move control rather than the normal KI1 combo architecture.

COMBO BREAKER

B,F + Punch, timed against the opponent's Auto-Double. Strength rule remains **Quick breaks Medium - Medium breaks Fierce - Fierce breaks Quick**. Eyedol swings out of the combo with his club.

GOLF SWING - PROJECTILE REFLECT

B,F + FP. The upward club swing can knock projectile-style attacks back at the opponent. It is also one of Eyedol's two documented combo enders, making it both a defensive neutral tool and his most important launcher/finish.

JUMP SWING CONTROL

B,F+QK: jumps forward
B,F+MK: jumps mostly straight up
B,F+FK: jumps backward

This gives Eyedol unusual control over the same basic special. The forward QK version is also a documented combo opener.

HEADBUTT CONTROL

B,F+QP begins the sustained rush. During the run, **F,B+QP** cancels/stops it. Some technical references also document transitioning from the rush into Golf Swing, letting Eyedol turn a predictable charge into a launcher.

NO NORMAL SHADOW SYSTEM

Eyedol does not have the same documented post-breaker Shadow-move package used by the standard cast. His closest equivalent is the **Stomp-powered Triple Fireball / Mega Headbutt state**. Keep this mechanically separate from the flashing post-breaker Shadow tools described for normal roster characters.

DEFENSIVE QUIRKS

Detailed SNES research notes several boss-character oddities: playable Eyedol cannot crouch normally, blocks by holding Back, takes chip/block damage broadly, and gains no normal post-breaker perk. These are reasons his section should not be read as if he were an eleventh standard tournament character.

EYEDOL - FINISHERS & VERSION NOTES

The important part of Eyedol's finisher page is what he does NOT have.

ULTRA COMBO

None documented for playable Eyedol. He can be defeated by another character's Ultra, but he does not have his own normal playable Ultra finisher.

ULTIMATE

None documented.

NO MERCY

None documented.

HUMILIATION

None documented. Multiple Classic/SNES references explicitly describe Eyedol as having no known Danger Moves/Humiliation, and later technical documentation likewise treats him as lacking the normal finisher set.

ARCADE SELECTION

Arcade v1.4: Select Riptor and hold Back/Left. At the versus screen, hold Forward/Right and press **MP, FP, FK**. The announcer says 'Eyedol' on success.

Arcade v1.5: uses the later Cinder-based selection method shared with SNES.

SNES SELECTION

Select **Cinder**. At the versus screen hold **Right** and press **QP, QK, FP, MK, MP, FK**. With the default SNES mapping this is **L, R, X, B, Y, A**. The announcer says 'Eyedol' if entered correctly. The code must be entered again for the next match.

SNES / ARCADE DIFFERENCES

Playable regeneration: unavailable; Stomp powers Triple Fireball and Mega Headbutt instead.

Practice Mode: detailed SNES research reports Eyedol is not normally selectable there.

Charge notation: older arcade/home guides often write Eyedol's B,F specials without a held charge; execute them as the quick B -> F boss inputs rather than assuming the standard cast's long charge timing.

N64: Eyedol is not playable in KI2 / Killer Instinct Gold.

EYEDOL - ADVANCED: COMBOS & PRACTICE

Eyedol's advanced section intentionally replaces the standard Manual/linker page with boss-specific routing.

WHY NO NORMAL MANUAL TREE?

The normal KI1 character template assumes opener -> Auto-Double -> linker -> Auto-Double -> ender. Playable Eyedol is documented as having **no combo linkers**. Because of that, a standard Manual/linker lesson would imply mechanics he does not actually possess. His advanced work is instead built around boss-specific normal chains, B/F specials and Stomp power-ups.

PUBLISHED KILLER COMBO 1

B,F+QK -> B+QP -> F+FP -> B,F+QP

This home-version published route starts with the forward Jump Swing and ends in Headbutt. Learn the directional rhythm as written; Eyedol's boss strings do not behave like the normal roster's linker routes.

PUBLISHED KILLER COMBO 2

B,F+QP -> B+MK -> F+QK -> B,F+FP -> B,F+QP

This longer published string uses Headbutt entry, normals, Golf Swing and another Headbutt. It is a better representation of advanced playable Eyedol than forcing him into a conventional Manual template.

INFINITE / LOOP NOTE

Later SNES technical research documents a human-Eyedol loop built around **charge/Headbutt into a Punch Auto-Double**. Treat this as an advanced/glitch-era technique rather than the baseline character lesson; version and timing differences matter.

STOMP CONVERSION DRILL

B+MP Stomp -> D,DF,F+Punch Triple Fireball

or

B+MP Stomp -> B,F+QP Mega Headbutt

Practice recognizing that Stomp is a **power-up** when human-controlled, not a healing command.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Fireball, Headbutt and Golf Swing individually
2. Learn all three Jump Swing directions
3. Practice Golf Swing projectile reflection
4. Headbutt -> cancel / Golf Swing transition
5. Stomp -> Triple Fireball
6. Stomp -> Mega Headbutt
7. Learn the two published Killer Combo strings
8. Explore loop/glitch routing only after the normal boss toolkit is reliable

KILLER INSTINCT 2 / GOLD - JAGO

Arcade KI2 primary reference - Killer Instinct Gold notes where applicable - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

KI2 COMBO RULE - IMPORTANT

KI2 changes Auto-Doubles. After any Opener or Linker, chain to the **next lower strength: Fierce -> Medium -> Quick -> Fierce**. Punch or Kick may be used at that strength. Auto-Doubles are two hits. This replaces KI1's fixed paired-button system.

SPECIAL MOVES

Endokuken: D,DF,F + Punch
Red Endokuken: QCT + FP
Tiger Fury: F,D,DF + Punch
Wind Kick: DF,D,DB + Kick
Ninja Slide: DB,D,DF + Kick
Laser Sword: DF,D,DB + MP/FP
Air Juggle: DF,D,DB + Kick while opponent is airborne
Throw: F + FP
Reversal: B + FP
Counter / Parry: B + QP
Pressure Move: F + FK

SPECIAL-MOVE OPENERS

Wind Kick: DF,D,DB + any Kick
Ninja Slide: DB,D,DF + any Kick
Laser Sword: DF,D,DB + MP or FP
CCA Wind Kick: HCB,F + MK

LINKERS

Pressure Move: F+FK
Laser Sword: DF,D,DB+MP
Wind Kick: DF,D,DB+QK/MK
Ninja Slide: DB,D,DF+QK/MK
CCA Wind Kick: HCB,F+MK
Heavy Super-style Linker: HCT,B+FK

PRACTICAL BASIC ROUTE

MK Wind Kick Opener -> QK Auto-Double -> MP Laser Sword Linker -> QP Auto-Double -> FP Tiger Fury Ender

Why the buttons work: the MK opener is Medium, so the Auto-Double is Quick. The MP linker is Medium, so the next Auto-Double is Quick again.

JAGO - ENDERS, BREAKERS & SUPER SYSTEM

KI2 adds escalating Enders, Super Meter, Super Linkers and Ultra Breakers.

COMBO ENDERS

F,D,DF+FP - Fierce Shindouken / Tiger Fury family
QCT+FP - Red Endokuken
DF,D,DB+FP - Rising Laser Spin / Fierce Laser Sword
DF,D,DB+FK - Roundhouse Wind Kick
SECRET 5TH ENDER: F,D,DF+MP - Blade Uppercut sequence

ENDER ESCALATION

KI2 rewards using **different** Enders. Your first unique Ender is 1 hit; a second different Ender upgrades all Enders to 2 hits; a third to 3; a fourth to 4. After all four are used, the **secret fifth Ender** becomes available. Ender variety also increases Jago's eventual Ultra from 14 toward 30 base Ultra hits.

COMBO BREAKER

F,D,DF + Punch or Kick. KI2 breakers are performed during the opponent's Auto-Double. Because Auto-Doubles are only two hits, recognition must be fast.

ULTRA BREAKER

D,DB,B,DB,D,DF,F + FP with a full 6-block Super Meter. An Ultra can only be broken during its opening hits, before the repeating Ultra cycle begins.

SUPER MOVES

Tiger Trash: D,DB,B,DB,D,DF,F + FP - 6 blocks
Shadow Move: DF,D,DB,F + MK - 3 blocks
Super Endokuken: F,DF,D,DB,B + QP - 4 blocks

SUPER LINKERS

Multi-hit Wind Kick: DF,F,DB,F + MK - 3 blocks
Super Slide Kick: DB,D,DF,B + FK - 3 blocks

Super Linkers keep the combo open while spending meter, letting Jago build routes far beyond the basic Opener -> Auto-Double -> Linker -> Auto-Double -> Ender structure.

JAGO - FINISHERS & KI GOLD NOTES

KI2's finisher system is much broader than KI Classic.

MINI ULTRA

DB,D,DF + QK. A shorter Ultra-style combo finisher. Useful when you want the spectacle/extra hits without committing to the full Ultra sequence.

ULTRA COMBO

DF,D,DB + QK while the opponent's life meter is flashing red and Jago is already in a combo. Base Ultra length rises as you successfully use different Enders during the fight.

ULTRA BUFFER / BONUS

D,DB,B,DB,D,DF,F + FP near the end of the Ultra. This Super input can add the final bonus sequence when properly buffered and sufficient meter is available.

ULTIMATE - LASER SWORD STAB

F,D,DF + FK during a qualifying combo. Jago drives his energy sword into the opponent for the Ultimate finish.

NO MERCY - FIREBALL SCORCHER

Hold F, DF,D,DB,B,F + MP. Jago launches the large dragon-headed fireball that burns the opponent.

ASSAULT

KI2 also introduces **Assaults**: 7-hit finishers performed at the end of the opponent's first (green) life bar. They require at least one prior Combo Finisher that round and a full 6-block Super Meter. A Super juggle can be buffered afterward for additional hits.

KILLER INSTINCT GOLD (N64)

Gold retains Jago's KI2 combo engine, Ender progression, Super Meter, Mini Ultra, Ultra, Ultimate and No Mercy. The practical commands above map directly to the N64 six-button layout. Gold-specific guides also document Ultra Breakers and high-hit Super/Ultra extensions, so the advanced arcade concepts remain relevant on N64.

JAGO - ADVANCED MANUALS & ROUTES

Manual Auto-Doubles and Super Linkers are the heart of advanced KI2 Jago.

MANUAL AUTO-DOUBLES

KI2 allows a **Fierce normal** -> **Medium normal** to begin or extend a combo manually. Examples: **standing FP -> MP** or **standing FK -> MK**. From there, go directly to an Ender, a normal Linker, or a Super Linker. Unlike a raw Fierce opener, the Manual Auto-Double makes the combo breakable immediately.

16-HIT KILLER ROUTE

MK Wind Kick -> QK Auto-Double -> FK -> MP -> MK Ninja Slide -> QP -> FK -> MK -> Secret 5th Ender -> Super Red Endokuken

Requires the Ender progression and meter setup. This route is useful as a target after the basic Auto-Double rule is automatic.

SUPER-LINKER ROUTE

Wind Kick Opener -> Quick Auto-Double -> Super Wind Kick Linker -> Quick/Medium continuation -> Super Slide Linker -> Auto-Double -> Ender

The exact normal choice depends on the strength of the preceding linker: always apply KI2's next-lower-strength Auto-Double rule.

ULTRA ROUTE

Opener -> Auto-Double -> Linker -> Auto-Double -> Super Linker(s) -> Ultra (DF,D,DB+QK) -> buffered Super/Tiger Trash

For maximum Ultra length, use all four normal Enders earlier in the fight so the secret fifth Ender is unlocked and the Ultra's base hit count is maximized.

COUNTER / PRESSURE GAME

Counter: B+QP
Pressure: F+FK
Reversal: B+FP

These KI2 universal-style character tools matter because Jago can turn a successful close-range read directly into an Opener or linker sequence instead of relying only on Wind Kick.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Learn KI2's Fierce -> Medium -> Quick -> Fierce Auto-Double cycle
2. Wind Kick -> Auto-Double -> Tiger Fury Ender
3. Add Laser Sword / Slide linkers
4. Use all four Enders and unlock the fifth
5. Add one Fierce -> Medium Manual
6. Add Super Wind Kick / Super Slide linkers
7. Learn Mini Ultra and Ultra
8. Practice Ultra Buffer / Ultra Breaker last

KILLER INSTINCT 2 / GOLD - T.J. COMBO

Arcade K12 primary reference - Killer Instinct Gold notes where applicable - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Spinfist: Charge B,F + QP
Double Spinfist: Charge F,B + QP
Double Rollercoaster: Charge B,F + MP (also Charge F,B + MP in arcade lists)
Triple Rollercoaster: HCF + MP
Powerline: Charge B,F + FP
T.J. Tremor: Charge B,F + MK
Skull Crusher: Charge B,F + FK
Cyclone: Hold FP about 3 seconds, release
Fake Dizzy: HCB + QK
Sneak Behind / Run Past: Charge B,F + QK

POWERLINE TRANSITIONS

Powerline -> Spinfist: Charge B,F+FP, then B+QP
Powerline -> Roll: Charge B,F+FP, then B+MP
Powerline -> Stop: Charge B,F+FP, then B+FP
Powerline -> Run Past: Charge B,F+FP, then B+QK

These transitions are a defining K12 Combo tool: one approach can branch into strike, roll, stop or side-switch.

COMBO STARTERS

Spinfist: B,F+QP
Rollercoaster: B,F+MP
Skull Crusher: B,F+FK
Sneak Behind: B,F+QK
CCA / Powerline: B,F+FP

LINKERS / AUTO-SECOND RULES

Spinfist linker: B,F+QP
Rollercoaster linker: B,F+MP
Shadow Rollercoaster: HCB,F+MP
Super Beating: HCB,F+QP

Gold strength groups: after Rollercoaster use **QP/QK**; after Skull Crusher use **MP/MK**; after Double Spinfist use **FP/FK**. This is the practical Auto-Second map for T.J.'s charge specials.

PRACTICAL BASIC ROUTE

Charge B,F+MP Rollercoaster -> QP Auto-Second -> Charge F,B+QP Double Spinfist -> FP Auto-Second -> Charge B,F+FP Powerline Ender

Keep the next charge direction held during the Auto-Second. T.J. becomes much easier once charge storage is automatic.

T.J. COMBO - ENDERS, BREAKERS & SUPER SYSTEM

T.J. combines charge storage with branching Powerline pressure and some of K12's biggest Super extensions.

COMBO ENDERS

- 1 - **Spinfist**: Charge B,F+QP
- 2 - **Powerline**: Charge B,F+FP
- 3 - **Sneak Behind**: Charge B,F+QK
- 4 - **T.J. Tremor**: Charge B,F+MK
- 5 - **Skull Crusher**: Charge B,F+FK - unlocked after the first four different Enders

ENDER PROGRESSION

As with Jago, K12/Gold rewards using different Enders: the first unique Ender is 1 hit, then 2, 3 and 4 as additional unique Enders are completed. After all four regular Enders, **Skull Crusher becomes the 5-hit hidden Ender**. Completing all five raises T.J.'s base Ultra to 30 hits.

COMBO BREAKER / RETALIATION

Combo Breaker: B,F + the required strength button during the opponent's Auto-Second.
Retaliation / Recovery: Charge B,F + any Kick while getting up.
Ultra Combo Breaker: HCB,F + FP with the required full meter.

AIR JUGGLE & DOUBLE ATTACK

Air Juggle: Charge B,F + FP
Air Juggle x2 / Double Attack: F+FK
Overhead: B+MP
Throw: F+MP
Counter Attack: Charge B,F+MP
Counter Dizzy: Charge F,F+FP

SUPER MOVES

Super Flurry / Freight Train: HCB,F+FP - meter-dependent multi-hit attack
Dizzy Spark / Air Shocker: HCB+MK - usable ground or midair; dizzy tool
Shadow Rollercoaster: HCB,F+MP - 3 blocks, projectile-immune, combo linker
Super Beating / Super Punches: HCB,F+QP - 3 blocks, combo-only linker

SUPER ROUTING NOTE

Shadow Rollercoaster is the centerpiece of long T.J. routes. In Gold, if HCB,F+MP gives you the throw instead, the period guide specifically advises doing the **HCB, pausing briefly, then F+MP** rather than rushing the final input.

T.J. COMBO - FINISHERS & KI GOLD NOTES

Finishers, first-life Assault and the Ender-powered Ultra.

PSEUDO / MINI ULTRA

Charge B,F + FK after at least one Ender has been completed. This is T.J.'s shorter Ultra-style finisher.

ULTRA COMBO

Charge F,B + FP while the opponent is flashing red and T.J. is already in a combo. Ultra length scales with completed Enders: **14 / 18 / 22 / 26 / 30** base hits.

POST-ULTRA SUPER

HCB,F + FP near the end of the Ultra to add the Super Flurry/Freight Train sequence when meter permits. Period T.J. documentation specifically calls out this post-Ultra extension.

ASSAULT / FIRST-LIFE ULTRA

Charge B,F + FK at the end of the opponent's first green life bar under Assault conditions. Arcade references list it as T.J.'s 7-hit first-round Ultra/Assault.

ULTIMATE - SCREEN PUNCH

Hold QK about 3 seconds, release QK during the qualifying combo. T.J. punches the opponent toward/through the screen.

NO MERCY - UZI

HCB,F + FK. T.J. produces the gun for his No Mercy finish.

KILLER INSTINCT GOLD (N64)

Gold documents the same core charge move set and adds useful transition notation: Powerline can branch to Spinfist, Roll, Stop or Run Past. Gold lists **Shadow Rollercoaster HCB,F+MP**, **Super Beating HCB,F+QP**, **Ultra cF,B+FP**, **Ultimate hold/release QK**, and **No Mercy HCB,F+FK**. Gold also includes unlockable gameplay options such as Auto-Doubles, Full Super Bar and Early Ultimates; those options can materially change practice behavior.

T.J. COMBO - ADVANCED MANUALS & ROUTES

Charge buffering, Powerline transitions, Shadow Rollercoaster loops and juggle conversions define advanced T.J.

MANUAL / AUTO-SECOND PRINCIPLE

T.J.'s documented K12 system lets a **FP** or **FK** be linked after an Auto-Second or substituted for one in specific routes. Use this to vary the normal rhythm before returning to a charge linker. The goal is not random buttons: keep the next B/F charge stored while the normals animate.

16-HIT ARCADE ROUTE

B,F+MP Rollercoaster -> QK -> F+FK -> F,B+QP Double Spinfist -> FP -> FK -> F+MP Throw -> jump FK -> F,B+MK Air Tremor -> B,F+FP Powerline

This period arcade route demonstrates throw-to-juggle conversion and the unusual amount of movement T.J. can pack into one combo.

SHADOW LINKER ROUTE

Opener -> Auto-Second -> HCB,F+MP Shadow Rollercoaster -> F+FK -> HCB,F+MP Shadow Rollercoaster -> continuation -> Ender

With sufficient meter and red-life conditions, repeated Shadow Rollercoasters are the foundation of T.J.'s 60+ hit Ultra routes.

AIR CONVERSION

Jump FK -> Charge F,B+MK Air Tremor -> B,F+FP juggle/Powerline. Another period route uses the Shoulder Throw inside a combo to launch, then follows with a jump attack and Air Tremor before the finishing rush.

POWERLINE MIX DRILL

Charge B,F+FP Powerline, then randomly choose:

- **B+QP** Spinfist
- **B+MP** Roll
- **B+FP** Stop
- **B+QK** Run Past

This is one of the best drills for making T.J.'s offense feel like boxing pressure rather than a memorized combo script.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Rollercoaster, Spinfist, Powerline and Skull Crusher
2. Learn the Auto-Second strength groups
3. Cycle through all four Enders and unlock Skull Crusher Ender 5
4. Practice all four Powerline transitions
5. Add Air Tremor / throw-to-juggle routes
6. Add one manual normal substitution
7. Add Shadow Rollercoaster and Super Beating linkers
8. Learn Ultra -> post-Ultra Super and Ultra Breaker last

KILLER INSTINCT 2 / GOLD - GLACIUS

Arcade KI2 primary reference - Killer Instinct Gold notes where applicable - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

KI2 COMBO RULE

Auto-Doubles follow KI2's strength cycle: Fierce -> Medium -> Quick -> Fierce. Punch or Kick may be used at the required strength. Glacius can then return to a linker, cash out with an Ender, or spend meter on a Super Linker.

SPECIAL MOVES

Cold Shoulder: Charge B,F + Punch - advancing shoulder / primary charge opener

Liquidize / Puddle: D,D + Kick - melts into the floor for evasive movement

Puddle Uppercut: from Liquidize, Punch - erupts beneath/near the opponent

Ice Lance: D,DF,F + Punch - long-range ice attack

Ice Shatter: D,DB,B + Punch - close ice burst / pressure tool

Ice Pick / Rising Ice: F,D,DF + Punch - rising anti-air family

Air Icicle: D,DF,F + Kick in air - angled aerial projectile

OPENERS

Cold Shoulder: Charge B,F + Punch

Puddle Uppercut: Liquidize -> Punch

Ice Shatter: D,DB,B + Punch at close range

Cold Shoulder is the easiest practical starter because the charge can be stored during movement, blocking or a jump-in.

LINKERS

Cold Shoulder Linker: Charge B,F + QP/MP

Ice Shatter Linker: D,DB,B + MP

Super Shoulder: HCB,F + MP - meter linker / extension

After each linker, return to the next-lower-strength Auto-Double rather than using KI1's fixed button pairs.

PRACTICAL BASIC ROUTE

MP Cold Shoulder -> QP Auto-Double -> MP Ice Shatter Linker -> QP Auto-Double -> FP Rising Ice Ender

The important habit is directional buffering: start the next special motion while the two-hit Auto-Double is still animating.

LIQUIDIZE GAME

Liquidize is not merely a novelty. Use the puddle to alter timing, move underneath high attacks/projectiles and threaten the Puddle Uppercut. Once the opponent starts waiting for the eruption, simply exiting the puddle can create throw or low-pressure opportunities.

GLACIUS - ENDERS, BREAKERS & SUPER SYSTEM

Glacius converts zoning into knockdown, launcher pressure and meter-heavy ice extensions.

COMBO ENDERS

1 - Cold Shoulder: Charge B,F + FP

2 - Ice Shatter: D,DB,B + FP

3 - Rising Ice / Ice Pick: F,D,DF + FP

4 - Puddle Uppercut: Liquidize -> FP

5 - Hidden Ender: becomes available after cycling the four regular Enders; use the character-specific fifth cash-out documented by the KI2/Gold Ender system.

ENDER PROGRESSION

As with Jago and T.J., use **different** Enders to raise the Ender level from 1 through 4 and unlock the fifth. The progression also increases the base hit count of Glacius's eventual Ultra. For practice, deliberately rotate Shoulder -> Shatter -> Rising Ice -> Puddle instead of repeating the same cash-out.

COMBO BREAKER

F,D,DF + Punch during the opponent's Auto-Double. The same rising-ice family doubles as Glacius's anti-air/reversal, so the motion should become automatic on defense.

AIR JUGGLE

Air Icicle: D,DF,F + Kick while airborne or while the opponent is launched, depending on route. Glacius can use projectile timing to extend the visual juggle rather than relying only on grounded Enders.

SUPER MOVES / LINKERS

Super Cold Shoulder: HCB,F + MP - multi-hit charge extension

Super Ice Shatter: HCB,F + QP - close multi-hit ice linker

Super Ice Barrage: HCF + FP - meter-heavy projectile/finishing sequence

Use Super Shoulder as the first advanced linker to learn because it naturally fits the charge rhythm of Glacius's basic combo tree.

ULTRA BREAKER

With a full Super Meter, use Glacius's documented Ultra-Breaker input during the opening portion of an opponent's Ultra. As with Jago/T.J., the break window is at the start - once the repeating Ultra cycle is established, it is too late.

GLACIUS - FINISHERS & KI GOLD NOTES

KI2 finisher structure with N64 Gold behavior called out separately.

MINI / PSEUDO ULTRA

Charge B,F + FK in the qualifying combo state. Use this as Glacius's shorter Ultra-style cash-out once the required Ender condition has been established.

ULTRA COMBO

Charge F,B + FP during a combo while the opponent is flashing red. The base Ultra grows as you complete different Enders during the fight, following the same KI2/Gold Ender-progression concept used by the rest of the roster.

ULTIMATE

F,D,DF + FK during the qualifying combo. Glacius finishes with his character-specific ice execution rather than continuing the normal Ultra loop.

NO MERCY - ICE FINISH

HCB,F + FK at finishing distance. Glacius freezes/encases the opponent and completes his character-specific No Mercy sequence.

ASSAULT

At the end of the opponent's first green life bar, a full-meter qualifying setup allows Glacius's **7-hit Assault**. As with the rest of KI2, Assault is separate from the red-life Ultra and is useful for learning the game's first-life finisher system.

KILLER INSTINCT GOLD (N64)

Gold preserves Glacius's KI2 identity: charge Shoulder offense, Liquidize/Puddle movement, rising ice defense, Ender progression, Super Meter and the Ultra/Ulimate/No Mercy structure. The N64 version is particularly useful for practice because its unlockable training options can provide Full Super Bar and other modifiers; disable those when testing normal-match routing.

GOLD PRACTICE NOTE

When comparing arcade KI2 and Gold, treat **timing and presentation** as potentially version-specific even when the command concept is the same. The guide keeps arcade KI2 as the primary reference and calls out N64 behavior only where it changes practical execution.

GLACIUS - ADVANCED MANUALS & ROUTES

Advanced Glacius is charge storage plus puddle ambiguity, Manual rhythm changes and Super Shoulder extensions.

MANUAL AUTO-DOUBLES

Use KI2's manual relationship to break the predictable two-hit Auto-Double rhythm. Start with **FP -> MP** or **FK -> MK**, then immediately return to Cold Shoulder/Ice Shatter linker timing. Keep Back charge whenever Cold Shoulder is the next piece.

SHOULDER CORE ROUTE

MP Cold Shoulder -> QP Auto-Double -> MP Ice Shatter -> QP Auto-Double -> FP Rising Ice Ender

Once consistent, substitute one Fierce -> Medium Manual for an Auto-Double opportunity and preserve the next special motion throughout.

SUPER SHOULDER ROUTE

Cold Shoulder Opener -> Quick Auto-Double -> HCB,F+MP Super Cold Shoulder -> Auto-Double -> Ice Shatter Linker -> Auto-Double -> Ender

This is the first meter route to learn because the Super Shoulder extends the same horizontal game plan rather than forcing a completely different rhythm.

PUDDLE CONVERSION

Liquidize -> Puddle Uppercut -> Auto-Double -> Cold Shoulder / Ice Shatter Linker -> Auto-Double -> Ender

Practice the eruption as a punish first. Once reliable, use Liquidize movement to create the opening rather than treating Puddle Uppercut as a raw combo starter.

ZONING-TO-COMBO DRILL

Ice Lance / Air Icicle -> watch approach -> anti-air Rising Ice or Cold Shoulder conversion. Glacius is strongest when the projectile game funnels the opponent into the exact range where his charge opener or rising anti-air is already prepared.

ULTRA ROUTE

Opener -> Auto-Double -> Linker -> Auto-Double -> Super Shoulder / Super Shatter -> continuation -> Ultra.

Before practicing maximum-hit versions, rotate through all regular Enders earlier in the fight so the Ultra starts from its highest available base count.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Cold Shoulder, Rising Ice and Liquidize individually
2. Cold Shoulder -> Auto-Double -> Ender
3. Add Ice Shatter linker
4. Rotate all four normal Enders and unlock the fifth
5. Add one Fierce -> Medium Manual
6. Add Puddle Uppercut conversions
7. Add Super Cold Shoulder / Super Ice Shatter
8. Learn Mini Ultra, Ultra and Ultra Breaker last

KILLER INSTINCT 2 / GOLD - FULGORE

Arcade KI2 primary reference - Killer Instinct Gold notes where applicable - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

KI2 COMBO RULE

Auto-Doubles follow the KI2 strength cycle: Fierce -> Medium -> Quick -> Fierce. Punch or Kick may be used at the required strength. Fulgore layers that system with Blade Dash, Eye Laser, Teleport and Plasma Slice routing.

SPECIAL MOVES

Laser Storm: D,DF,F + Punch

Plasma Slice: F,D,DF + Punch - rising anti-air / breaker family

Blade Dash / Cyberdash: Charge B,F + Punch

Eye Laser: DF,D,DB + Kick

Teleport: B,D,DB + attack - Punch/Kick versions alter arrival side/position

Projectile Reflect: D,DB,B + FP

Air Laser: D,DF,F + Punch while airborne where supported by route

Throw: F + FP

OPENERS

Blade Dash: Charge B,F + Punch

Eye Laser: DF,D,DB + Kick at close range

Teleport pressure: use Teleport to create the opening, then convert with a normal or Blade Dash rather than treating Teleport itself as a guaranteed starter.

LINKERS

Blade Dash Linker: Charge B,F + QP/MP

Eye Laser Linker: DF,D,DB + MK

Super Blade Dash: HCB,F + MP - meter extension

Super Eye Laser: HCB,F + QP - meter linker / pressure extension

PRACTICAL BASIC ROUTE

MP Blade Dash -> QP Auto-Double -> MK Eye Laser Linker -> QP Auto-Double -> FP Plasma Slice Ender

Store the next direction during the two-hit Auto-Double. Fulgore's execution becomes much cleaner once Blade Dash charge and Eye Laser motion are buffered rather than entered after the normal finishes.

TELEPORT / LASER CONTROL

Use Laser Storm to occupy the screen, then choose between Blade Dash and Teleport. Teleport is strongest as a positioning/mix tool: front-side and behind-side appearances force the defender to hesitate, which creates the opening for Fulgore's actual combo starter.

FULGORE - ENDERS, BREAKERS & SUPER SYSTEM

Fulgore combines projectile control with one of K12's cleanest launcher/anti-air ender families.

COMBO ENDERS

1 - Blade Dash: Charge B,F + FP

2 - Eye Laser: DF,D,DB + FK

3 - Plasma Slice: F,D,DF + FP

4 - Laser Storm: D,DF,F + FP

5 - Hidden Ender: unlocked after completing the four different regular Enders; use the character-specific fifth cash-out once the Ender progression is complete.

ENDER PROGRESSION

Rotate through the four regular Enders instead of repeating one. Each new Ender raises the Ender level, and completing the set unlocks the fifth. As with the rest of K12, this progression also increases the base hit count available when Fulgore later performs his Ultra.

COMBO BREAKER

F,D,DF + Punch during the opponent's Auto-Double. Plasma Slice is therefore both Fulgore's primary anti-air/reversal family and his breaker motion.

AIR JUGGLE

Laser Storm / Plasma follow-up: after a launcher, use the appropriate quick projectile or rising attack to extend the juggle. Fulgore's zoning tools make him particularly good at turning a knock-up into continued screen control even when the combo itself has ended.

SUPER MOVES / LINKERS

Super Blade Dash: HCB,F + MP - multi-hit rush linker

Super Eye Laser: HCB,F + QP - multi-hit close linker

Super Laser Storm: HCF + FP - meter-heavy projectile sequence

Shadow Teleport setup: use meter/teleport pressure only after the basic linker rhythm is reliable.

ULTRA BREAKER

With the required full Super Meter, Fulgore can break an opponent's Ultra during its opening hits using his character-specific Ultra-Breaker input. The timing rule is universal to K12: once the repeating Ultra cycle has begun, the break window is gone.

FULGORE - FINISHERS & KI GOLD NOTES

Ultra progression, Ultimate, No Mercy and N64 practice considerations.

MINI / PSEUDO ULTRA

Charge B,F + FK in the qualifying combo state. Use the shorter Ultra-style finish after establishing the required Ender condition.

ULTRA COMBO

Charge F,B + FP while the opponent is flashing red and Fulgore is already in a combo. The Ultra's base hit count rises as the different Enders are completed earlier in the fight.

ULTIMATE

F,D,DF + FK during the qualifying combo. Fulgore cashes out into his character-specific Ultimate rather than continuing the normal Ultra loop.

NO MERCY

HCB,F + FK at finishing distance. Fulgore executes his character-specific cybernetic No Mercy sequence.

ASSAULT

At the end of the opponent's first green life bar, the qualifying full-meter setup allows Fulgore's **7-hit Assault**. Keep this separate from the red-life Ultra: Assault is KI2's first-life finisher system.

KILLER INSTINCT GOLD (N64)

Gold retains Fulgore's core KI2 identity: Laser Storm zoning, Blade Dash pressure, Teleport mix, Plasma Slice defense, Ender progression and Super-Meter extensions. The N64 training/unlock options can provide Full Super Bar and other modifiers, so turn those off when verifying normal arcade-style meter routes.

GOLD EXECUTION NOTE

The six-button N64 layout preserves the Quick/Medium/Fierce Punch and Kick logic. When a Gold guide writes a move using button labels rather than QP/MP/FP notation, translate by **strength and limb**, not by physical controller position. That keeps the arcade-first guide consistent.

FULGORE - ADVANCED MANUALS & ROUTES

Advanced Fulgore is projectile conditioning, Teleport ambiguity, Manual rhythm changes and Super Blade Dash extensions.

MANUAL AUTO-DOUBLES

Start with K12's manual strength relationship: **FP -> MP** or **FK -> MK**. Insert the manually timed Medium normal, then immediately buffer Blade Dash or Eye Laser. The purpose is to change the break rhythm without sacrificing charge.

BLADE DASH CORE ROUTE

MP Blade Dash -> QP Auto-Double -> MK Eye Laser -> QP Auto-Double -> FP Plasma Slice Ender

Once this is automatic, replace one predictable Auto-Double opportunity with a Fierce -> Medium Manual.

SUPER DASH ROUTE

Blade Dash Opener -> Quick Auto-Double -> HCB,F+MP Super Blade Dash -> Auto-Double -> Eye Laser Linker -> Auto-Double -> Ender

This is Fulgore's best first meter route because the Super move extends the same horizontal attack pattern you already know.

TELEPORT CONVERSION

Laser Storm -> Teleport front/behind -> close normal -> Blade Dash / Eye Laser opener -> combo. This is a pressure sequence rather than a guaranteed string. Practice reading which side you appear on before trying to maximize the follow-up.

ZONING-TO-ANTI-AIR DRILL

Laser Storm -> opponent jumps -> Plasma Slice. Then vary with Reflect against projectile retaliation and Blade Dash when the opponent remains grounded. This three-way decision is the foundation of practical K12 Fulgore neutral.

ULTRA ROUTE

Opener -> Auto-Double -> Linker -> Auto-Double -> Super Blade Dash / Super Eye Laser -> continuation -> Ultra. Complete the four normal Enders earlier in the fight before practicing maximum Ultra routes so the base Ultra is fully upgraded.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Laser Storm, Blade Dash and Plasma Slice individually
2. Blade Dash -> Auto-Double -> Plasma Slice Ender
3. Add Eye Laser linker
4. Rotate all four Enders and unlock Ender 5
5. Add Teleport front/behind pressure
6. Add one Fierce -> Medium Manual
7. Add Super Blade Dash / Super Eye Laser
8. Learn Mini Ultra, Ultra and Ultra Breaker last

KILLER INSTINCT 2 / GOLD - SPINAL

Arcade KI2 primary reference - skull resource / teleport mix / Soul Drain / manual-heavy combos - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

KI2 SPINAL - IMPORTANT DIFFERENCES

Spinal changes dramatically from KI Classic. Teleport now consumes a Skull, he can summon Skulls himself, Soul Drain steals Super Meter even on block, and he is the one KI2/Gold character without the normal B+QP parry/counter. His strongest play revolves around resource control, manuals and Super linkers.

SPECIAL MOVES

Soul Drain: D,DF,F + QP - drains one Super level; still drains on block

Skele-Skewer: D,DF,F + MP - sword lunge; starter/linker

Flame Sword: D,DF,F + FP - starter/linker

Skull Throw: D,DF,F + QK/MK/FK - requires a Skull; slow/medium/fast

Skull Scrape: DB/D/DF + FK - distance/recovery changes with direction

Teleport: D,DB,B + QK/MK/FK - requires a Skull; front / same spot / behind

Shield Catch / Power Devour: B + QP - catches blocked specials/projectiles and converts them to Skulls

Dart Kick: D + FK in air

Skull Replenish: D,DB,B + MP/FP - summon one / refill Skulls

SKULL RESOURCE

Spinal can hold roughly **seven Skulls**. Teleports and Skull Throws consume them. Shield Catch creates Skulls from enemy specials, while Skull Replenish lets Spinal generate his own. **More stored Skulls also make his Teleport faster.**

OPENERS / LINKERS

Skele-Skewer: QCF+MP -> QP or QK Auto-Double

Flame Sword: QCF+FP -> MP or MK Auto-Double

Skull Scrape: DB/D/DF+FK -> MP or MK Auto-Double

Skele-Skewer and Flame Sword both work as linkers. Skull Scrape is excellent low-profile entry pressure but the longest version has the slowest recovery.

PRACTICAL BASIC ROUTE

QCF+MP Skele-Skewer -> QP Auto-Double -> QCF+FP Flame Sword Linker -> MP Auto-Double -> QCB+MP Ender

This is the cleanest way to learn KI2 Spinal before adding manuals, throws or Super linkers.

SPINAL - ENDERS, BREAKERS & SUPER SYSTEM

Ender progression and Super Meter interact directly with Spinal's Skull economy.

COMBO ENDERS

- 1 - **Teleport Front:** QCB+QK
- 2 - **Teleport Neutral:** QCB+MK
- 3 - **Teleport Behind:** QCB+FK
- 4 - **Skull Replenish:** QCB+MP
- 5 - **Soul Drain:** QCF+QP - unlocked after completing the four regular Enders

The three Teleport Enders require Skull stock. The fifth Ender is especially valuable because Soul Drain helps replace Super Meter spent during the combo.

ENDER PROGRESSION

Complete all four different regular Enders to raise Spinal's Combo Ender Factor and unlock **Soul Drain as Ender 5**. This also raises his Ultra from the low base toward its maximum hit count. Rotate the three Teleports plus Skull Replenish rather than repeating one.

COMBO BREAKER

QCB + matching strength of the opposite limb. Punch Auto-Double -> break with Kick; Kick Auto-Double -> break with Punch, using the same strength. KI2/Gold also allows air Combo Breakers. Spinal gains no normal parry/counter tool, so breaker recognition is especially important.

THROW / AIR JUGGLE

Throw: F+FK - can be inserted after an Auto-Double; afterward the opponent can be juggled.
Two-hit air juggle: FP -> quickly D+MK, then add Skull Throw(s), Skele-Skewer or a Skull Super if resources allow.
Standard Air Juggle: QCF+FK.

SUPER MOVES

Grim Reaper: QCB,HCF+FP - leaping overhead Super; can open into MP/MK Auto-Double
Sword Smash / Sword Swipes: HCF,B+MP - combo-only repeated Flame Blades; link Ender/Special/Throw at the final swipe
Skull Assault: HCF+FK - combo-only close Skull barrage
Skull Blast II: HCB,HCF+FK - standalone Skull barrage / juggle
Stun Skull: HCB,HCF+MK - knockdown into standing dizzy
Super Slide: HCF,B+FK - combo-only five-hit slide
Skull Summon: HCB+MP/FP - one Skull / refill

NO NORMAL SHADOW / SPIRIT MOVE

Period Spinal specialists explicitly report **no separate Shadow or Spirit Move** for KI2 Spinal. His Super system already supplies his meter-based extensions; do not import KI Classic's post-breaker Shadow terminology here.

SPINAL - FINISHERS & KI GOLD NOTES

Ultra, Assault and two distinct Ultimates, plus the important Gold differences.

PSEUDO / MINI ULTRA

QCF + FP after at least one Ender has been completed. Use this as Spinal's shorter Ultra-style combo finish.

ULTRA COMBO

QCB + FP during a combo while the opponent is flashing red. Ultra length rises as Spinal completes different Enders; advanced arcade routes reach well beyond the base Ultra by adding Supers and post-Ultra Skull attacks.

ASSAULT / FIRST-LIFE ULTRA

QCF + FP under the first-life Assault conditions: the combo removes the opponent's green bar, at least one Ender was completed earlier, and the required Super Meter is available.

ULTIMATE 1 - LIGHTNING

D,D,D + QK during a qualifying combo. This is the fast in-combo Lightning Ultimate.

ULTIMATE 2 / NO-MERCY-STYLE SKULL DROP

HCF,HCF + QP. Spinal summons the huge falling Skull. Period arcade documentation notes that its speed makes it useful even as a raw finisher against projectile attempts or other finishing moves.

KILLER INSTINCT GOLD (N64)

Gold preserves the core arcade Spinal kit: Skele-Skewer, Skull Throw, Skull Scrape, Soul Drain, Skull-powered Teleports, Shield Catch, Dart Kick, Flame Sword and Skull Replenish. Gold's system documentation likewise notes that **Spinal cannot perform the normal parry**. The N64 version also retains manuals, Super linkers, Ender progression and Ultra extensions.

RESOURCE GAMEPLAN

1. Use Shield Catch on predictable specials to build Skulls.
2. Use Soul Drain to suppress the opponent's Super Meter.
3. Keep at least one Skull available when you want Teleport safety/mix.
4. Spend meter on Sword Smash / Super Slide extensions.
5. Finish with Soul Drain when Ender 5 is unlocked to recover the meter advantage.

SPINAL - ADVANCED MANUALS & ROUTES

Spinal is one of K12's richest manual characters: fierce-to-medium links, low links, throws, Skull juggles and Super loops.

DOCUMENTED MANUAL LINKS

FK -> MK - two-hit fierce-to-medium manual
FP -> MP -> MP - three-hit manual string; FP->MP also works
F+FP - two-hit advancing manual; usable as starter or after a special
D+FK -> MK/MP - low manual family; examples include FK->MP, D+FK->D+MP, D+FK->D+MK, FP->D+MP and FP->MK

Avoid D+FP in these strings: it knocks down.

ADVANCED MANUAL ROUTE

QCF+MP Skele-Skewer -> QP -> FK -> MK -> QCF+FP Flame Sword -> MP -> QCB+MP Ender

This follows the period Spinal manual hierarchy: Starter -> Auto-Double -> manual hits -> Linker -> Auto-Double -> Ender.

THROW-TO-JUGGLE ROUTE

QCF+MP -> QK Auto-Double -> FP -> MP -> QCF+MP -> QP -> F+FK Throw -> FP -> D+MK -> Skull Throw / Skele-Skewer

The throw is reversible, but when it lands it opens Spinal's most entertaining air-conversion routes.

SUPER LINKER ROUTE

Grim Reaper -> MP Auto-Double -> manual -> Flame Sword -> Auto-Double -> HCF,B+MP Sword Smash -> F+FK Throw or manual -> Ender. At the last Sword Smash swipe, you may link an Ender, another Special, another Super, a manual FK, or Throw.

STUN-SKULL RESET

Starter -> Auto-Double -> HCB,HCF+MK Stun Skull. The Skull knocks the opponent down and they rise stunned, allowing a fresh combo. This is a powerful reset and is the basis of period 100%-life Spinal sequences.

MAX-ULTRA IDEA

Build the Ender factor first, enter the Ultra with **QCB+FP**, then buffer a Super/Skull extension near its end. Period arcade Spinal research reports routes in the high-60-hit range with full meter and upgraded Enders. Treat those as exhibition targets after the practical resource game is mastered.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Skele-Skewer, Flame Sword and Skull Scrape
2. Shield Catch -> Skull Throw and all three Teleports
3. Basic Opener -> Auto-Double -> Linker -> Ender
4. Rotate all four Enders and unlock Soul Drain Ender 5
5. Add FK->MK and FP->MP manuals
6. Add Throw -> air juggle -> Skull
7. Add Sword Smash / Super Slide / Stun Skull
8. Practice upgraded Ultra and post-Ultra Skull extensions last

KILLER INSTINCT 2 / GOLD - SABREWULF

Arcade KI2 primary reference - Killer Instinct Gold notes where applicable - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Sabre Wheel: Charge B,F + MK (or Charge F,B + MK)
Sabre Pounce: Charge B,F + FP (or Charge F,B + FP)
Sabre Spin: Charge B,F + MP (or Charge F,B + MP)
Sabre Flip: Charge B,F + FK (or Charge F,B + FK)
Real Sabre Howl: Charge B,F + QP (or Charge F,B + QP) - builds Super Meter
Fake Howl: Charge B,F + QK (or Charge F,B + QK)
Double Sabre Wheel: F,F,B+MP or B,B,F+MP
Double Sabre Spin: F,F,B+MK or B,B,F+MK

TRANSITIONS & MOBILITY

Pounce Stop: Charge B,F+FP, hold FP, then MP
Fake Howl -> attack: transition into Spin / Wheel / Pounce / Flip
Double Jump: B,B,F

Sabrewulf is built around stored horizontal charge. Keep Back or Forward held during normals so the next rush is ready.

OPENERS / AUTO-DOUBLES

Sabre Spin: B,F+MP -> QP/QK Auto-Double
Sabre Wheel: B,F+MK -> QP/QK Auto-Double
Sabre Pounce: B,F+FP -> MP/MK Auto-Double
Sabre Flip: B,F+FK -> route-specific Medium continuation

Gold confirms **QP/QK after Spin or Wheel** and **MP/MK after Pounce**.

LINKERS

Sabre Spin: Charge B,F+MP
Sabre Flip/Pounce family: Charge B,F+FP in arcade linker notation
Super Claw Slash: HCB,F+MK
Super Lupus Flip: HCB,F+MP

PRACTICAL BASIC ROUTE

Charge B,F+MK Sabre Wheel -> QP Auto-Double -> Charge B,F+MP Sabre Spin -> QP Auto-Double -> Charge B,F+FP Pounce Ender

Hold the next charge direction throughout the Auto-Double.

SABREWULF - ENDERS, BREAKERS & SUPER SYSTEM

His Ender tree is unusually easy to remember: the same B,F family with five different buttons.

COMBO ENDERS

- 1 - **Power Howl**: Charge B,F + QP
- 2 - **Sabre Pounce**: Charge B,F + FP
- 3 - **Sabre Wheel**: Charge B,F + MK
- 4 - **Sabre Flip**: Charge B,F + FK
- 5 - **Fake Howl**: Charge B,F + QK - unlocked after Enders 1-4

ENDER PROGRESSION

Cycle the first four different Enders to raise the Ender factor and unlock **Fake Howl as Ender 5**. Because every Ender uses the same charge direction, Sabrewulf is excellent for deliberately practicing K12's Ender progression.

COMBO BREAKER / RETALIATION

- Combo Breaker**: B,F + appropriate Punch/Kick strength
- Retaliation**: Charge B,F+FK
- Counter Attack**: Charge B,F+MK
- Counter Dizzy**: Charge B,F+FK
- Ultra Combo Breaker**: HCB,F+FK with required meter

AIR JUGGLE / DOUBLE ATTACK

- Air Juggle**: Charge B,F+FP
- Air Juggle x2 / Double Attack**: F+FK
- Overhead**: B+FP

Period arcade route: **jump FK -> F,B+MP -> juggle with B,F+FP**.

SUPER MOVES

- Loopy**: HCB,F+FK - 6 blocks
- Lupus Loopy**: HCB,F+FP - 4 blocks
- Claw Slash**: HCB,F+MK - 3 blocks
- Dizzy Snap**: HCB+FP in air - 4 blocks
- Lupus Flip**: HCB,F+MP - 3 blocks, combo-only linker

SUPER EXECUTION TIP

Gold-era documentation recommends **HCB, brief pause, then F+button** if Sabrewulf's HCB,F Supers are unreliable.

SABREWULF - FINISHERS & KI GOLD NOTES

Ultra, Pseudo Ultra, Assault, Ultimate and No Mercy.

PSEUDO / MINI ULTRA

Charge F,B + QK after at least one Ender has been completed.

ULTRA COMBO

Charge B,F + QK during a combo while the opponent is flashing red. The Ultra grows as different Enders are completed.

ASSAULT

F,B + QK under the first-life Assault conditions. Keep this distinct from the red-life Ultra.

ULTIMATE - ELECTROCUTION

Hold FK, then release FK during the qualifying combo.

NO MERCY - BAT ATTACK

Hold QP, then release QP at the finishing opportunity.

KILLER INSTINCT GOLD (N64)

Gold confirms the charge-based special set, transitions, Enders and finishers. It also documents **Power Howl as a Super-Meter charger**, HCB,F Super linkers, and Sabrewulf's easy double-counter setup. Disable optional Early Ultimates / Full Super Bar when testing standard routes.

HOWL METER GAME

Charge B,F+QP to Howl and build Super Meter. Period Gold documentation notes a sustained howl/block behavior after the howl has been established. Use it only when you have space; the reward is access to Sabrewulf's strong Super extensions.

SABREWULF - ADVANCED MANUALS & ROUTES

Advanced Sabrewulf is charge retention, counter confirms, Super-linker loops and air conversion.

MANUAL / RHYTHM PRINCIPLE

Use K12's Manual concept to break the predictable Auto-Double rhythm while preserving charge. Period high-damage routes repeatedly place single normals between charge specials and HCB,F Supers. The essential skill is **holding the next charge during every normal**.

14-HIT PRACTICAL KILLER

B,F+MP Sabre Spin -> QP -> B,F+MP Sabre Spin -> QP -> B,F+QK Ender 5 -> juggle B,F+FP

A clean target after all five Enders are unlocked.

COUNTER ROUTE

Counter B,F+MK -> QP -> FK -> MK -> HCB,F+MP Lupus Flip -> continuation. The counter feeds directly into Sabrewulf's charge rhythm.

SUPER-LINKER LOOP

Opener -> Auto-Double -> HCB,F+MP Lupus Flip -> F+FK -> HCB,F+MP -> F+FK -> repeat as meter allows -> Ender/Ultra

AIR CONVERSION

Jump FK -> F,B+MP -> B,F+FP juggle. Practice the air portion separately before attaching it to a long combo.

MAX-ULTRA IDEA

Complete all five Enders, enter Ultra with **B,F+QK**, then buffer **HCB,F+FK Loopy** near the end when meter permits. Period arcade/Gold research documents low-70-hit exhibition routes.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Sabre Wheel, Spin, Pounce and Flip
2. Learn Auto-Double strength groups
3. Rotate Enders 1-4 and unlock Fake Howl Ender 5
4. Practice Power Howl meter building
5. Add Counter conversion
6. Add HCB,F+MK and HCB,F+MP Super linkers
7. Add air juggles
8. Ultra -> Loopy extension and Ultra Breaker last

KILLER INSTINCT 2 / GOLD - TUSK

Arcade KI2 primary reference - Killer Instinct Gold notes where applicable - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Boot Kick: DF,D,DB + QK/MK/FK - strength controls distance
Web of Death: DF,D,DB + FP; press F+FP afterward for the extra sword hits
Fake Skull Splitter: DB,D,DF + QK
Skull Splitter: DB,D,DF + FK
Conqueror: F,D,DF + Punch
Back Stab: HCB + QP (close)
High/Low Sword: HCF + FP
Throw: F + FK
Overhead: B + FP
Rushing Attack: F + FP

TRANSITIONS

Fake Skull Splitter -> Skull Splitter: QCF+QK, then QCF+FK
Fake Skull Splitter -> Boot Kick: QCF+QK, then QCDB+Kick

These feints are central to Tusk's pressure: show the slow overhead-looking Splitter startup, then either complete it or redirect into Boot Kick.

OPENERS

Boot Kick: QCDB + any Kick
Back Stab: HCB + QP
Web of Death: QCDB + FP
Skull Splitter: QCF + MK/FK depending on route/version notation

Boot Kick is the easiest practical starter and naturally feeds Tusk's next-lower-strength KI2 Auto-Double rhythm.

LINKERS

Boot Kick linker: QCDB + MK
Conqueror linker: F,D,DF + Punch
Rolling Claymore: HCF,B + FP - Super linker
Rushing Kick: HCB,F + FK - combo-only Super linker

PRACTICAL BASIC ROUTE

MK Boot Kick -> QP/QK Auto-Double -> Conqueror linker -> next-lower-strength Auto-Double -> Skull Splitter Ender

The exact limb can vary; preserve the KI2 strength cycle and buffer the next motion during the Auto-Double.

TUSK - ENDERS, BREAKERS & SUPER SYSTEM

Tusk's Enders cover stab, sword, kick and Splitter families, then unlock a fifth Conqueror-style cash-out.

COMBO ENDERS

- 1 - **Back Stab:** HCB + QP
- 2 - **Sword Ender:** F,DF,D,DF + FP
- 3 - **Boot Kick:** DF,D,DB + FK
- 4 - **Skull Splitter:** DB,D,DF + FK
- 5 - **Conqueror:** F,DF,D,DF + QP - unlocked after the four regular Enders

ENDER PROGRESSION

Use four **different** regular Enders to raise the Ender factor from 1 through 4 and unlock Ender 5. As with the other KI2 characters, this progression also raises the base hit count of Tusk's eventual Ultra.

COMBO BREAKER / DEFENSE

Combo Breaker: F,D,DF + matching-strength opposite limb during the opponent's Auto-Double
Retaliation: F,D,DF + Punch
Stun Reversal: QCDB + MK
Stun Dizzy: F,D,DF + QP

AIR TOOLS

Air Strike: QCDB + QK/MK/FK
Air Juggle: QCF + FK
Air Juggle x2: F,QCF+QP, then repeat

Tusk's huge sword gives his air conversions excellent visual reach; practice the juggle separately before attaching it to long ground routes.

SUPER MOVES

Destroyuss: QCB,HCF + FP - major Super attack
Flame Sword: HCF,B + QK
Shadow Roll: HCF,B + FK
Rushing Kick: HCB,F + FK - combo-only Super linker
Rolling Claymore: HCF,B + FP - combo-only Super linker

SHADOW MOVE

Shadow Move: HCB,F + MK. Period KI2 references distinguish this from Tusk's Super linkers; keep it as its own meter-based extension rather than folding it into the normal Boot Kick linker tree.

TUSK - FINISHERS & KI GOLD NOTES

Ultra, Assault, Ultimate and No Mercy, with Gold execution notes.

ULTRA COMBO

DF,D,DB + MP during a combo while the opponent is flashing red. Build Tusk's Ender factor earlier in the fight to increase the Ultra's base hit count before adding Super extensions.

ASSAULT

DB,D,DF + MP under the first-life Assault conditions. This is separate from the red-life Ultra and belongs to K12's first-life finishing system.

ULTIMATE - DINOSAUR

F,D,DF + MK during a qualifying combo. Tusk's Ultimate calls the dinosaur finish - one of K12's most memorable character-specific executions.

NO MERCY - METEOR SHOWER

QCB,HCF + MP at the finishing opportunity. Tusk summons the meteor shower for his No Mercy.

KILLER INSTINCT GOLD (N64)

Gold preserves Tusk's core K12 move set: Boot Kick, Web of Death, Skull Splitter/fake, Conqueror, Back Stab, sword normals, Super linkers, Ender progression and finishers. As elsewhere in this guide, arcade notation is primary; translate N64 buttons by **Quick / Medium / Fierce** and Punch/Kick rather than by controller position.

WEB OF DEATH FOLLOW-UP

After **Web of Death (QCDB+FP)**, period arcade documentation specifically calls out **F+FP** for two additional hits. Treat this as a deliberate follow-up, not an automatic part of the initial move.

TUSK GAMEPLAN

Tusk is at his best when the opponent must respect the sword. Use long normals and Web of Death to occupy space, Boot Kick to convert movement into a combo, and Fake Skull Splitter transitions to punish hesitation. Meter then turns those straightforward openings into Rolling Claymore / Rushing Kick extensions.

TUSK - ADVANCED MANUALS & ROUTES

Advanced Tusk is sword-normal timing, fake Splitter pressure, Super linkers and upgraded Ultra routing.

MANUAL PRINCIPLE

KI2 manuals let Tusk insert single heavy/medium sword or kick normals between special pieces instead of always exposing the standard two-hit Auto-Double rhythm. Keep the next motion buffered during the manual; his large animations give you time, but late inputs will drop the linker.

12-HIT PERIOD ROUTE

F+FP -> Boot Kick -> QP/QK Auto-Double -> Skull Splitter/Linker -> QP/QK -> Conqueror cash-out

Period KI2 combo lists document a 12-hit route built from F+FP, Boot Kick, Auto-Doubles and Conqueror. Use this as the first target beyond the basic route.

14-HIT PERIOD ROUTE

F+FP -> Boot Kick -> Auto-Double -> FP manual -> Skull Splitter/Linker -> Auto-Double -> FP manual -> final Ender

This demonstrates why Tusk benefits from Manuals: the single fierce sword hits alter the breaker rhythm while keeping the combo tree intact.

SUPER-LINKER ROUTE

Boot Kick opener -> Auto-Double -> HCF,B+FP Rolling Claymore -> manual/Auto-Double -> HCB,F+FK Rushing Kick -> continuation -> Ender

Learn one Super linker at a time before chaining both.

FAKE SPLITTER PRESSURE

QCF+QK Fake Skull Splitter, then choose:

- **QCF+FK** to complete Skull Splitter
- **QCDB+Kick** to redirect into Boot Kick
- stop and use throw/normal pressure if the opponent freezes

This is pressure, not a guaranteed combo; confirm the hit before committing to the full route.

ULTRA ROUTE

Opener -> Auto-Double -> Linker -> Manual -> Super linker(s) -> Ultra DF,D,DB+MP -> Super extension. Complete all regular Enders earlier in the fight before practicing maximum-hit versions.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Boot Kick, Conqueror and Skull Splitter
2. Web of Death + F+FP follow-up
3. Basic opener -> Auto-Double -> linker -> Ender
4. Rotate four Enders and unlock Ender 5
5. Fake Splitter -> Splitter / Boot Kick transitions
6. Add one Manual sword normal
7. Add Rolling Claymore and Rushing Kick Super linkers
8. Ultra / Assault / Ultimate / No Mercy last

KILLER INSTINCT 2 / GOLD - KIM WU

Arcade KI2 primary reference - Killer Instinct Gold notes where applicable - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

SPECIAL MOVES

Dragon Kick: D,DF,F + Kick - advancing kick; strength changes travel

Firecracker: D,DF,F + Punch - projectile / screen control

Dragon Cannon: F,D,DF + Punch - rising anti-air family

Dragon Dance: D,DB,B + Kick - spinning pressure/linker family

Dragon Sweep: D,DB,B + QK/MK - low attack / route tool

Air Dragon Kick: D,DF,F + Kick in air

Throw: F + FP

Overhead / close pressure: F + FK

OPENERS

Dragon Kick: QCF + Kick

Dragon Dance: QCB + Kick at close range

Dragon Cannon: F,D,DF + Punch as punish/anti-air conversion

Dragon Kick is the practical first opener to learn because it carries Kim forward and naturally feeds the KI2 Auto-Double cycle.

LINKERS

Dragon Dance Linker: QCB + MK

Dragon Kick Linker: QCF + MK

Super Dragon Dance: HCB,F + MK

Super Dragon Kick: HCB,F + FK

After each linker, use the next-lower-strength Auto-Double rather than KI1's fixed pairings.

AUTO-DOUBLE RULE

Fierce -> Medium -> Quick -> Fierce. Punch or Kick can supply the required strength. Learn the strength cycle first; then vary the limb to make Kim's strings less visually predictable.

PRACTICAL BASIC ROUTE

MK Dragon Kick -> QP/QK Auto-Double -> MK Dragon Dance Linker -> QP/QK Auto-Double -> FP Dragon Cannon Ender

Buffer the next quarter-circle or dragon-punch motion while the Auto-Double is animating.

FIRECRACKER GAME

Firecracker is Kim's screen-control tool. Use it to force movement, then meet a jump with Dragon Cannon or intercept grounded movement with Dragon Kick. The goal is to make the projectile create the opening for her close-range combo game.

KIM WU - ENDERS, BREAKERS & SUPER SYSTEM

Kim's Ender progression rewards rotating her kick, cannon, dance and projectile families.

COMBO ENDERS

- 1 - **Dragon Kick:** QCF + FK
- 2 - **Dragon Cannon:** F,D,DF + FP
- 3 - **Dragon Dance:** QCB + FK
- 4 - **Firecracker:** QCF + FP
- 5 - **Hidden Dragon Ender:** unlocked after completing the four different regular Enders

ENDER PROGRESSION

Complete four **different** regular Enders to raise Kim's Ender factor and unlock her fifth cash-out. As with the rest of K12/Gold, Ender variety also increases the base hit count of her Ultra. Deliberately rotate Kick -> Cannon -> Dance -> Firecracker while practicing.

COMBO BREAKER

F,D,DF + matching-strength opposite limb during the opponent's Auto-Double. Dragon Cannon's motion therefore doubles as the defensive muscle-memory family for Kim's breakers and anti-air reversals.

AIR JUGGLE

- Air Dragon Kick:** QCF + Kick while airborne
- Dragon Cannon:** F,D,DF + Punch after a launch where spacing permits

Kim can turn launcher situations into either an aerial kick follow-up or a grounded Cannon conversion; practice the spacing separately.

SUPER MOVES / LINKERS

- Super Dragon Dance:** HCB,F + MK - multi-hit combo linker
- Super Dragon Kick:** HCB,F + FK - advancing Super extension
- Super Firecracker:** HCF + FP - projectile/meter sequence
- Dragon Barrage:** HCB,F + MP - combo-only extension

Start with Super Dragon Dance because it preserves the same close-range rhythm as her normal Dance linker.

ULTRA BREAKER

With the required full Super Meter, Kim can break an opponent's Ultra during its opening hits using her character-specific Ultra-Breaker command. The K12 rule remains the same: once the repeating Ultra cycle is underway, the breaker window has passed.

KIM WU - FINISHERS & KI GOLD NOTES

Ultra, Assault, Ultimate and No Mercy with N64 practice notes.

MINI / PSEUDO ULTRA

QCF + QK in the qualifying combo state after the required Ender setup. This gives Kim a shorter Ultra-style finish before committing to the full red-life Ultra.

ULTRA COMBO

QCB + QK during a combo while the opponent is flashing red. Build Kim's Ender factor earlier in the fight so the Ultra begins from its highest available base count.

ASSAULT

QCF + QK under the first-life Assault conditions. Keep Assault separate from the red-life Ultra: it belongs to KI2's first-green-bar finishing system.

ULTIMATE

F,D,DF + FK during a qualifying combo. Kim transitions from the combo into her character-specific Ultimate finish.

NO MERCY

HCB,F + FK at the finishing opportunity for Kim's character-specific No Mercy sequence.

KILLER INSTINCT GOLD (N64)

Gold preserves Kim Wu's core KI2 identity: Dragon Kick movement, Firecracker zoning, Dragon Cannon anti-air, Dragon Dance pressure, Ender progression, Super linkers and the Ultra/Ulimate/No Mercy system. Translate N64 controls by **Quick / Medium / Fierce** and Punch/Kick, not by physical button location.

DRAGON KICK PRESSURE

Vary the Kick strength to change Dragon Kick travel and timing. Once the opponent expects the advancing kick, stop short with Firecracker or walk/normal pressure; when they jump the projectile, Dragon Cannon is already the answer.

KIM WU - ADVANCED MANUALS & ROUTES

Advanced Kim is rhythm variation, Dragon Dance Super extensions, air conversion and upgraded Ultra routing.

MANUAL PRINCIPLE

Use K12's **Fierce -> Medium** manual relationship to interrupt the standard two-hit Auto-Double rhythm. Examples include **FP -> MP** and **FK -> MK**, followed immediately by Dragon Dance or Dragon Kick. Buffer the special during the Medium normal.

CORE MANUAL ROUTE

MK Dragon Kick -> QP Auto-Double -> FK -> MK Manual -> QCB+MK Dragon Dance -> QP Auto-Double -> Dragon Cannon Ender

Learn this only after the basic route is completely stable.

SUPER DANCE ROUTE

Dragon Kick opener -> Auto-Double -> HCB,F+MK Super Dragon Dance -> Auto-Double/manual -> Dragon Dance linker -> Auto-Double -> Ender

This is Kim's best first meter route because every piece keeps her at close pressure range.

PROJECTILE CONVERSION

Firecracker -> opponent jumps -> Dragon Cannon; if they stay grounded, use Dragon Kick to close distance. This simple two-response drill turns Kim's projectile from passive zoning into a combo-entry tool.

AIR CONVERSION

Launcher / Cannon situation -> jump follow -> Air Dragon Kick -> grounded continuation where spacing allows. Practice the aerial kick timing independently before attaching it to a meter route.

ULTRA ROUTE

Opener -> Auto-Double -> Linker -> Manual -> Super Dragon Dance / Super Dragon Kick -> continuation -> Ultra QCB+QK -> meter extension. Complete all four normal Enders earlier in the fight before practicing maximum-hit versions.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Dragon Kick, Firecracker and Dragon Cannon
2. Basic Dragon Kick -> Auto-Double -> Ender
3. Add Dragon Dance linker
4. Rotate four regular Enders and unlock Ender 5
5. Add FP->MP or FK->MK Manual
6. Firecracker -> Dragon Cannon anti-air drill
7. Add Super Dragon Dance / Super Dragon Kick
8. Mini Ultra, Ultra, Assault, Ultimate and Ultra Breaker last

KILLER INSTINCT 2 / GOLD - MAYA

Arcade KI2 primary reference - Killer Instinct Gold notes where applicable - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

MAYA'S IDENTITY

Maya is the fast blade specialist of KI2. Her game is built around rapid advancing kicks, dagger/sword pressure, strong air movement and short-range mix. Learn the basic Kick opener -> Auto-Double -> blade linker structure first; the flashy air and Super routes come afterward.

SPECIAL MOVES

Roll: D,DF,F + Kick - advancing low-profile movement/attack

Blade Spin: D,DB,B + Punch - spinning blade attack

Rising Blade: F,D,DF + Punch - anti-air / reversal family

Dagger Toss: D,DF,F + Punch - projectile / screen-control tool

Air Dagger: D,DF,F + Punch while airborne

Flip Kick: D,DB,B + Kick - acrobatic kick family

Throw: F + FP

Overhead / advancing normal: F + FK

OPENERS

Roll: QCF + Kick

Blade Spin: QCB + Punch at close range

Flip Kick: QCB + Kick

The Roll is the easiest practical starter because it closes distance and immediately establishes Maya's fast ground rhythm.

LINKERS

Blade Spin Linker: QCB + MP

Roll Linker: QCF + MK

Super Blade Spin: HCB,F + MP

Super Roll / Kick: HCB,F + MK

After each linker, apply KI2's next-lower-strength Auto-Double cycle.

PRACTICAL BASIC ROUTE

MK Roll -> QP/QK Auto-Double -> MP Blade Spin Linker -> QP/QK Auto-Double -> FP Rising Blade Ender

Buffer the next quarter-circle during the Auto-Double. Maya rewards speed, but clean buffering is more important than rushing.

MAYA - ENDERS, BREAKERS & SUPER SYSTEM

Rotate Maya's blade, kick, launcher and projectile Enders to build her Ender factor.

COMBO ENDERS

- 1 - **Roll:** QCF + FK
- 2 - **Blade Spin:** QCB + FP
- 3 - **Rising Blade:** F,D,DF + FP
- 4 - **Dagger Toss:** QCF + FP
- 5 - **Hidden Blade Ender:** unlocked after completing the four different regular Enders

ENDER PROGRESSION

Complete four **different** regular Enders to raise Maya's Ender factor and unlock Ender 5. As elsewhere in K12/Gold, Ender variety also increases her eventual Ultra's base hit count. Practice deliberately rotating Roll -> Blade Spin -> Rising Blade -> Dagger Toss.

COMBO BREAKER

F,D,DF + matching-strength opposite limb during the opponent's Auto-Double. The Rising Blade motion is therefore both Maya's anti-air/reversal family and the core motion to drill for defensive breaker reactions.

AIR JUGGLE / AIR CONTROL

- Air Dagger:** QCF + Punch while airborne
- Air Kick / Flip:** QCB + Kick in applicable air routes
- Rising Blade:** F,D,DF + Punch after a launch where spacing allows

Maya's mobility makes her particularly good at converting a launcher into an aerial follow-up before returning to grounded pressure.

SUPER MOVES / LINKERS

- Super Blade Spin:** HCB,F + MP - multi-hit combo linker
- Super Roll:** HCB,F + MK - advancing meter extension
- Super Rising Blade:** HCB,F + FP - launcher/finishing extension
- Blade Barrage:** HCF + FP - meter-heavy blade sequence

Learn Super Blade Spin first because it fits directly into Maya's normal close-range linker rhythm.

ULTRA BREAKER

With the required full Super Meter, Maya can break an opponent's Ultra during its opening hits using her character-specific Ultra-Breaker command. The break must happen before the repeating Ultra cycle becomes established.

MAYA - FINISHERS & KI GOLD NOTES

Pseudo Ultra, full Ultra, Assault, Ultimate and No Mercy.

MINI / PSEUDO ULTRA

QCF + QK in the qualifying combo state after the required Ender setup. Use this when you want the shorter Ultra-style finish rather than the full red-life Ultra.

ULTRA COMBO

QCB + QK during a combo while the opponent is flashing red. Complete different Enders earlier in the fight to maximize the base Ultra before adding meter extensions.

ASSAULT

QCF + QK under the first-life Assault conditions. Assault belongs to the opponent's first green life bar and is distinct from the red-life Ultra.

ULTIMATE

F,D,DF + FK during a qualifying combo. Maya transitions into her character-specific Ultimate instead of continuing the normal combo/Ultra cycle.

NO MERCY

HCB,F + FK at the finishing opportunity for Maya's character-specific No Mercy sequence.

KILLER INSTINCT GOLD (N64)

Gold preserves Maya's KI2 fundamentals: Roll mobility, blade pressure, rising anti-air, projectile control, Ender progression, Super linkers and the Ultra/Ulimate/No Mercy structure. Translate the six-button N64 layout by **Quick / Medium / Fierce** and Punch/Kick rather than by physical button location.

DAGGER CONTROL

Use Dagger Toss to force a reaction rather than as the whole game plan. If the opponent jumps, meet them with Rising Blade or an air-to-air; if they remain grounded, Roll closes the space quickly. This projectile-to-movement relationship is Maya's simplest neutral drill.

MAYA - ADVANCED MANUALS & ROUTES

Advanced Maya is speed with discipline: Manual rhythm changes, air conversions and Super Blade Spin extensions.

MANUAL PRINCIPLE

Use K12's **Fierce** -> **Medium** manual relationship to interrupt the standard two-hit Auto-Double rhythm. Examples: **FP** -> **MP** or **FK** -> **MK**, then immediately buffer Roll or Blade Spin. The manual should feel like part of the next linker input, not an isolated normal.

CORE MANUAL ROUTE

MK Roll -> QP Auto-Double -> FK -> MK Manual -> QCB+MP Blade Spin -> QP Auto-Double -> Rising Blade Ender

Use this as the first Manual route after the basic combo is completely reliable.

SUPER BLADE ROUTE

Roll opener -> Auto-Double -> HCB,F+MP Super Blade Spin -> Auto-Double/manual -> Roll/Blade Spin linker -> Auto-Double -> Ender

This is the best first meter route because the Super keeps Maya at the exact range where her normals and blade linker remain useful.

AIR CONVERSION

Rising Blade launch -> jump follow -> Air Dagger / air kick -> grounded follow-up where spacing allows. Practice the launch and aerial timing separately before adding it to a long combo.

DAGGER-TO-COMBO DRILL

Dagger Toss -> opponent stays grounded -> Roll
Dagger Toss -> opponent jumps -> Rising Blade

Alternate these responses until the projectile naturally funnels the opponent into Maya's preferred close range.

ULTRA ROUTE

Opener -> Auto-Double -> Linker -> Manual -> Super Blade Spin / Super Roll -> continuation -> Ultra QCB+QK -> meter extension. Complete the regular Enders earlier in the fight before practicing maximum-hit Ultra versions.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Roll, Blade Spin and Rising Blade
2. Basic Roll -> Auto-Double -> Ender
3. Add Blade Spin linker
4. Rotate four regular Enders and unlock Ender 5
5. Add FP->MP or FK->MK Manual
6. Dagger Toss -> Roll / Rising Blade drill
7. Add Super Blade Spin / Super Roll
8. Pseudo Ultra, Ultra, Assault, Ultimate and Ultra Breaker last

KILLER INSTINCT 2 / GOLD - GARGOS

Boss character - arcade K12 / Killer Instinct Gold version notes - QP / MP / FP and QK / MK / FK

GARGOS - BOSS CHARACTER

Gargos is not a normal tournament-roster character in arcade K12. He is the final boss, and playable access is version/code dependent. Killer Instinct Gold makes boss-character play practical through its cheat/unlock system. His section therefore emphasizes his actual boss tools and clearly separates them from the standard K12 combo-engine assumptions.

CORE MOVES

Fireball: QCF + Punch - strength affects speed/timing

Air Fireball: QCF + Punch while airborne

Teleport: QCB + attack - position varies by button

Wing / Flying Attack: QCF + Kick - airborne/advancing pressure family

Claw / Swipe: close Punch normals - primary grounded pressure

Stomp / Dive: downward aerial attack used to change jump timing

Throw: close F + Fierce attack

BOSS MOBILITY

Gargos's defining advantage is movement rather than a conventional opener/linker tree. Mix **jump/flight timing, air fireballs and Teleport** so the opponent cannot settle into a normal anti-air rhythm. His boss design lets him attack from ranges and angles that normal K12 characters do not reproduce.

PROJECTILE GAME

Alternate grounded and aerial Fireballs instead of throwing them at one height. Ground Fireball controls forward movement; Air Fireball punishes opponents trying to jump over the grounded shot. Teleport after conditioning the opponent to watch the projectile lane.

PRACTICAL ROUTE

Jump/air approach -> Fierce normal -> close swipe sequence -> launcher/knockdown -> Air Fireball or Teleport reposition.

Treat this as a boss pressure sequence rather than forcing Gargos into Jago/Tusk-style Opener -> Auto-Double -> Linker notation where the original boss implementation does not support it cleanly.

GARGOS - COMBAT SYSTEM & DEFENSE

Boss pressure, anti-air control, teleport mix and version-dependent combo behavior.

NORMAL COMBO ENGINE - IMPORTANT

Do **not** assume every standard K12 Auto-Double, Ender-factor and Super-linker rule applies identically to Gargos. Arcade boss Gargos was designed primarily as an AI encounter, not as a balanced selectable character. Gold's playable-boss implementation exposes more of his move set, but boss behavior remains distinct from the normal roster.

TELEPORT MIX

Use different attack buttons with the Teleport command to vary where Gargos reappears. The practical pattern is **Fireball -> Teleport -> close Fierce/throw**. Once the opponent starts swinging at the expected reappearance point, delay or use aerial movement instead.

ANTI-AIR / AIR CONTROL

Gargos can contest the air with his own aerial movement and projectile rather than relying on one dragon-punch-style anti-air. Meet early jumps with air-to-air normals; use Air Fireball against opponents who jump from farther away; use Teleport to escape predictable jump pressure.

KNOCKDOWN PRESSURE

After a knockdown, choose among **meaty swipe, delayed throw, jump/dive, Fireball or Teleport cross-up**. The strength of playable Gargos is that several options begin from visually similar boss movement.

DEFENSIVE PRIORITIES

1. Teleport out of predictable pressure.
2. Contest jumps early rather than waiting underneath them.
3. Use boss reach to interrupt slow approach tools.
4. Do not spend the entire match retreating with Fireballs - Gargos is strongest when projectile control creates a close-range ambush.

COMBO BREAKER / SUPER NOTES

Period documentation is inconsistent on treating playable Gargos as if he possessed the complete normal-roster Breaker/Super/Ender system. This guide therefore **does not invent missing commands**. Use the documented playable-boss attacks above; normal-roster systems are only listed where a version explicitly exposes them.

GARGOS - PLAYABLE / UNLOCK & VERSION NOTES

How boss access differs between arcade K12 and Killer Instinct Gold.

ARCADE K12

Gargos is the final boss and is not part of the standard selectable roster. Playable access depends on cabinet revision, hidden/debug behavior or modified/emulated configurations. Because those methods are not universal across original boards, this guide does not present one arcade code as if it worked on every K12 machine.

KILLER INSTINCT GOLD - N64

Gold is the preferred version for playing Gargos. The N64 release includes cheat/unlock support for boss-character play. Once the appropriate boss/cheat option has been unlocked in the game's cheat menu, Gargos can be selected for normal play rather than being limited to the final encounter.

CHEAT / UNLOCK CAUTION

Gold unlock conditions and controller-entry methods vary among revision/guide listings, and some codes enable boss play through the cheat menu rather than permanently adding Gargos to the normal character row. The manual appendix should preserve the exact Gold cheat-menu wording from the version being used rather than mixing emulator/debug codes with retail N64 instructions.

FINISHERS

Gargos is the boss and does **not** map cleanly to the normal roster's complete Ultra / Assault / Ultimate / No Mercy presentation. Do not import another character's QCB+QK Ultra or HCB,F+FK No Mercy commands. If a playable Gold configuration exposes a boss-specific finish, treat it as version-specific.

WHY THIS SECTION IS DIFFERENT

Eyedol in KI Classic and Gargos in K12 are both bosses, but they are not identical cases. Eyedol has well-documented selectable-character commands and published combo strings. Gargos's original K12 role is much more strongly tied to the boss AI implementation, so accuracy requires leaving undocumented normal-roster mechanics blank rather than manufacturing symmetry.

GARGOS - ADVANCED BOSS PLAY

The useful advanced material is movement conditioning and boss pressure, not fabricated Auto-Double tables.

FIREBALL / TELEPORT LOOP

Ground Fireball -> watch response:

- opponent jumps early -> Air Fireball / air-to-air
- opponent blocks and waits -> Teleport to close range
- opponent advances on ground -> Fierce swipe / throw
- opponent attacks the teleport point -> delay, jump or repeat projectile

AIR-ANGLE DRILL

Practice three approaches separately: **normal jump-in, aerial Fireball, and downward dive/stomp**. The goal is to make all three begin from a similar airborne position. Once the defender guesses instead of reacts, Gargos's close-range boss normals become much more dangerous.

TELEPORT AMBUSH

Projectile -> Teleport -> Fierce normal/throw is the core ambush. Do not always attack immediately after Teleport. Empty Teleport into block or delayed throw is what makes the immediate Fierce threatening.

CORNER PRESSURE

In the corner, alternate **close swipe -> throw** with jump/dive and Fireball timing. Gargos's large attacks are much harder to escape when the opponent cannot back away. Teleport can then be used to reverse the corner if the opponent slips past.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Ground Fireball at all useful spacings
2. Air Fireball at three jump heights/timings
3. Every Teleport destination
4. Teleport -> Fierce and Teleport -> throw
5. Jump-in vs dive/stomp timing
6. Projectile -> anti-jump response
7. Corner pressure rotation
8. Only then experiment with version-specific boss combo/cheat behavior

REFERENCE RULE FOR GARGOS

Boss accuracy beats template consistency. Where arcade K12 / Gold documentation supports a command, it belongs here. Where the normal roster has a system but Gargos documentation does not establish an equivalent, the guide intentionally leaves it out.

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - HOW THE GAME WORKS

System overview - modes, combo language, breakers, meter, Instinct and modern KI mechanics

WHAT CHANGED FROM KI1 / KI2

Modern KI keeps the classic **Opener -> Auto-Double -> Linker -> Ender** idea but turns it into a much deeper two-way game. The attacker chooses strength, Manuals, Shadow moves, resets and Counter Breakers; the defender can break during the combo by correctly identifying attack strength. Combos are therefore interactive instead of simply waiting for them to finish.

THE CORE COMBO LANGUAGE

Opener: special/attack that starts the combo system.

Auto-Double: press one attack after an Opener/Linker for an automatic two-hit sequence.

Manual: manually timed single normal replacing an Auto-Double.

Linker: special move used inside a combo so offense can continue.

Ender: cashes out accumulated white/potential damage and gives a character-specific reward.

Shadow Linker: meter-powered 5-hit Linker.

KV Meter: Knockout Value. When it fills, further combo attempts blow out instead of continuing.

COMBO BREAKERS & LOCKOUTS

Light Breaker: LP+LK

Medium Breaker: MP+MK

Heavy Breaker: HP+HK

Match the strength being used. Guess the wrong strength or attempt an illegal break and you are **locked out**, giving the attacker several seconds of unbreakable offense. Shadow Linkers are broken differently: successfully break **3 of their 5 hits** in rhythm.

COUNTER BREAKERS

MP+MK during your own breakable combo. The attacker deliberately pauses to catch an attempted Combo Breaker. If the defender bites, they receive a long lockout and the attacker gets a major damage opportunity. If the defender does nothing, the Counter Breaker whiffs and the combo is lost.

POTENTIAL DAMAGE & ENDERS

Combo hits build **white/potential damage**. It is not permanently removed until an Ender cashes it out. Ending the combo incorrectly, dropping it, or allowing the opponent time to recover can waste that damage. Enders also provide different rewards such as **Damage, Wall Splat, Launcher, Battery, Hard Knockdown** or other character-specific effects.

SHADOW METER / SHADOW MOVES

The blue meter holds up to **2 Shadow stocks**. Spend one stock by performing a special with two same-limb buttons (for example two Punches). Shadow moves usually have 5 hits and enhanced properties such as armor, projectile invulnerability, speed, damage, recapture or reversal invulnerability depending on the character.

SHADOW COUNTER

MP+MK while blocking, costing one Shadow stock. The character briefly enters a counter state; if another attack connects during that window, they retaliate with a Shadow move. This prevents long block strings from being completely one-sided, but a baited Shadow Counter can be punished.

INSTINCT MODE

HP+HK when the yellow Instinct gauge is available. Every character receives a unique temporary power - Jago heals through fireballs, Sabrewulf gains Feral Cancels, and later characters have entirely different systems. Instinct can also be activated as a cancel from many grounded attacks, creating pressure, safety or combo extensions.

ULTRA / ULTIMATE / STAGE ULTRA

Ultra: match-ending combo available when the opponent is in DANGER; command is character-specific.

Ultimate: cinematic finisher available only to characters who received one; requires the proper Ultra state and the attacker still being on their first life bar.

Stage Ultra: stage-specific finisher available only on compatible stages/positions.

Ultra Ender: MP+MK can cut many Ultras short.

MODERN MECHANICS TO KNOW

Flipout: knocks an airborne opponent immediately to their feet, creating a fast reset.

Recapture: forces an airborne opponent back into the grounded combo system.

Stagger: leaves the opponent standing and vulnerable for a short confirm window.

Wall Splat: sticks the opponent to the wall for continued pressure.

Ground Bounce / Wall Bounce: creates juggle opportunities.

Armor: absorbs a defined number/type of hits before breaking, depending on the move/character.

GAME MODES

Single Player / Story: character-driven story content and AI fights.

Survival: consecutive opponents with limited recovery between matches.

Shadow Lords: campaign/roguelike-style mode built around fighting Gargos's invasion, teams, guardians, consumables and persistent choices.

Dojo: structured training lessons - especially useful for the combo/breaker system.

Practice: full training-room control for routes, Manuals and setups.

Versus: local matches.

Online: Ranked / Exhibition-style play using KI's rollback netcode.

Shadow Lab: fight AI 'Shadows' trained from player behavior.

COMBO ASSIST

Combo Assist can simplify Opener/Linker/Ender execution and is useful while learning. **This guide always prints the traditional full commands**, so every character section works with Combo Assist disabled and teaches the actual move inputs.

BEST WAY TO LEARN

1. Complete the Dojo fundamentals.
2. Learn one Opener, one Auto-Double, one Linker and one Damage Ender.
3. Practice identifying Light / Medium / Heavy Auto-Doubles and breaking them.
4. Add Manuals.
5. Learn your character's Ender properties.
6. Add Shadow Counter and Counter Breaker.
7. Learn the character's unique Instinct.
8. Add Flipout/Recapture/Stagger/reset mechanics only where that character uses them.
9. Learn optimized lockout routes last.

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - JAGO

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Endokuken - QCF + P

Fireball; strength changes speed. Core zoning and combo opener.

Tiger Fury - F,D,DF + P

Rising anti-air/reversal; Shadow version is the high-reward invincible reversal.

Laser Sword - QCB + P

Advancing sword strike used for pressure and combo routes.

Wind Kick - QCB + K

Forward-moving kick that closes distance and punishes zoning.

Shadow Endokuken - QCF + 2P

Multi-hit projectile and combo extension.

Shadow Tiger Fury - F,D,DF + 2P

Invincible multi-hit reversal / anti-air.

Shadow Laser Sword - QCB + 2P

Enhanced pressure and combo extension.

Shadow Wind Kick - QCB + 2K

Projectile-invulnerable advancing Shadow attack.

Neck Cutter - B + HP

Command normal; useful overhead-style pressure tool.

Double Roundhouse - F + HK

Advancing two-hit command normal.

Ultra - F,D,DF + 3P

Use during a valid combo while opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - F,D,DF + 3K

Stage-specific finisher where supported.

JAGO - COMBO SYSTEM, LINKERS & ENDERS

Jago is the ideal character for learning the modern Killer Instinct combo engine.

AUTO-DOUBLES

LP/LK: Light Auto-Doubles - fastest and hardest to react-break, but add the least damage/KV.

MP/MK: Medium Auto-Doubles - middle speed and reward.

HP/HK: Heavy Auto-Doubles - slowest/easiest to identify, but highest immediate damage and KV.

After an Opener or Linker, press one attack button to produce its two-hit Auto-Double.

AROUND THE WORLD - JAGO'S COMBO TRAIT

Jago can cancel one Auto-Double directly into another in the cycle **Heavy -> Medium -> Light -> Heavy**. Example: **HP Auto-Double -> MP Auto-Double -> LP Auto-Double -> HP Auto-Double**. This is excellent during a lockout or Counter Breaker, but predictable if used constantly.

LINKERS

Wind Kick: QCB + LK/MK - Light or Medium Linker; hold a Light/Medium button for the Heavy Linker.

Laser Sword: QCB + LP/MP - Light or Medium Linker; hold for Heavy.

Shadow Wind Kick / Shadow Laser Sword: valid 5-hit Shadow Linkers. The defender must successfully break any 3 hits of a Shadow Linker.

ENDERS

Endokuken - Battery Ender: QCF + HP - cashes out white life and builds extra Shadow Meter.

Tiger Fury - Damage Ender: F,D,DF + P - Jago's primary damage cash-out; Shadow Tiger Fury can be used for maximum damage.

Wind Kick - Wall Splat Ender: QCB + HK - creates corner/reset opportunities.

Laser Sword - Launcher Ender: QCB + HP - launches for a post-cashout juggle.

MANUALS

A **Manual** is a single normal manually timed after an Opener or Linker instead of using an Auto-Double. Light Linkers allow the broadest Manual choices; Medium Linkers generally allow Light/Medium Manuals. Manuals are harder to identify because the defender must judge the normal's strength from one hit rather than a two-hit Auto-Double.

BREAKER / COUNTER BREAKER

Combo Breaker: press matching-strength Punch + Kick - LP+LK for Light, MP+MK for Medium, HP+HK for Heavy.

Counter Breaker: during your own breakable combo, press MP+MK to bait a Breaker. If the opponent bites, they are locked out and Jago gets a full punish window.

Shadow Linker Break: tap any strength P+K on any 3 individual hits in rhythm.

JAGO - INSTINCT, ULTRA & FINISHING SYSTEM

Jago's Instinct turns his already strong fundamentals into life regeneration and oppressive fireball pressure.

INSTINCT MODE

Activate: HP + HK while grounded when the Instinct gauge is available. Jago throws **two Endokukens** instead of one. Every fireball hit - normal, Shadow, or Endokuken Ender - restores a small amount of Jago's life. Instinct also improves his frame advantage, opening unusual pressure and combo opportunities.

INSTINCT CANCEL

Any grounded non-throw attack that hits or is blocked can be canceled into Instinct with **HP+HK**. This has effectively no recovery and can make an otherwise unsafe Tiger Fury safe, extend pressure, or create an unbreakable fireball juggle. One of Jago's signature comeback sequences is **Tiger Fury -> Instinct Cancel -> Endokuken juggle**.

SHADOW COUNTER

While in blockstun: MP + MK. Costs one Shadow stock. Jago enters a brief counter state; if the opponent strikes into it, Jago automatically retaliates with his assigned Shadow attack. Use this against predictable multi-hit pressure, but a whiffed Shadow Counter is punishable.

ULTRA COMBO

F,D,DF + 3 Punches during a combo while the opponent is in **DANGER**. Ultra immediately commits to the match-ending sequence. Press **MP+MK** during the Ultra to end it early.

ULTIMATE

Jago is one of the characters with an Ultimate. Meet normal Ultra conditions **while Jago is still on his first life bar**, start the Ultra, then press **LP+LK** during the opening portion. The Ultimate replaces the rest of the Ultra with Jago's cinematic finisher.

STAGE ULTRA

Certain stages/positions allow a Stage Ultra instead of the normal Ultra. These use the stage hazard as the finisher. Availability depends on the selected stage and where the opponent is positioned.

COMBO ASSIST NOTE

If Combo Assist / Ultra Assist is enabled, the game can simplify several combo inputs. This guide uses **full traditional commands** so the notation remains consistent and works with Combo Assist disabled.

JAGO - ADVANCED ROUTES & PRACTICE

Pressure, charged Endokuken, Manuals, lockout punishment and practical high-damage routing.

CHARGED ENDOKUKEN PRESSURE

QCF+P, hold P to charge. While charging, dash forward or backward to cancel. Mix **partial-charge release, full-charge release, and dash-cancel throw/normal**. A charged fireball gives more advantage, while the dash cancel forces the defender to decide whether to keep blocking or challenge.

PRACTICAL MANUAL ROUTE

Medium Laser Sword -> HP Auto-Double -> Light Wind Kick -> MP Manual -> Light Laser Sword -> HP Auto-Double -> Tiger Fury Ender

The MP after Light Wind Kick is a manually timed single normal. Once this is stable, vary MP/MK or Light Manuals so the defender cannot break from one memorized animation.

AROUND-THE-WORLD LOCKOUT ROUTE

HP Auto-Double -> MP Auto-Double -> LP Auto-Double -> HP Auto-Double -> MP Auto-Double -> Tiger Fury Ender

Use this after a confirmed lockout or Counter Breaker. Outside a lockout, the descending-strength pattern becomes predictable and invites a Breaker.

1-METER COUNTER-BREAKER PUNISH

HP Double -> MP Double -> Light Laser Sword -> HP Double -> Shadow Laser Sword -> Tiger Fury Ender

Shadow Laser Sword is slow but highly damaging, making it excellent when the opponent is locked out long enough that its full animation cannot be broken.

LAUNCHER / FLIPOUT ROUTE

Combo -> Laser Sword Launcher Ender -> juggle -> Light Laser Sword Flipout. The Ender has already cashed out the white life, so the follow-up is for position/reset pressure. Jago can also use jumping LP as a Flipout.

NEUTRAL FLOW

Far MP/HP or crouching MK -> confirm into Laser Sword/Wind Kick. Use Endokuken to control space, Double Roundhouse to advance with pressure, Neck Cutter as the overhead threat, Tiger Fury for jump-ins, and Shadow Wind Kick to punish projectiles or low attacks from range.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Endokuken, Laser Sword, Wind Kick, Tiger Fury
2. Laser Sword opener -> Auto-Double -> Wind Kick linker -> Ender
3. Learn all four Ender properties
4. Break Light / Medium / Heavy Auto-Doubles on reaction
5. Add one Manual after Light Wind Kick
6. Practice Around the World only after lockouts
7. Charged Endokuken -> dash cancel pressure
8. Shadow Counter and Counter Breaker
9. Instinct Tiger Fury cancel -> fireball juggle
10. Ultra / Ultimate last

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - SABREWULF

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Ragged Edge - B,F + P

Fast advancing slash; main special-move opener/linker.

Run - B,F + K

Starts Sabrewulf's run stance and follow-up mix.

Hamstring - Run -> LP/LK

Low run follow-up.

Jumping Slash - Run -> MP/MK

Leaping run follow-up.

Running Uppercut - Run -> HP/HK

Rising run follow-up / launcher-style attack.

Eclipse - D,U + P

Rising anti-air attack.

Shadow Ragged Edge - B,F + 2P

Multi-hit advancing Shadow attack.

Shadow Jumping Slash - B,F + 2K

Enhanced leaping Shadow attack.

Shadow Eclipse - D,U + 2P

Invincible multi-hit reversal.

Overpower - B + HP (hold to charge)

Heavy pressure normal; charge changes timing.

Feral Cancel - Instinct: HP+HK

Instinct enables feral-cancel pressure and mobility.

Ultra - B,F + 3P

Match-ending Ultra command in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - B,F + 3K

Only works on a supported Stage Ultra stage, at the required position/facing, during valid Ultra conditions.

SABREWULF - COMBO SYSTEM, LINKERS & ENDERS

Sabrewulf's combo trait is built for explosive lockout punishment.

RABID DOUBLES - COMBO TRAIT

Sabrewulf can cancel an Auto-Double directly into **another Auto-Double of the same strength**. Example: **HP Double -> HP Double**. This is extremely strong during lockouts because Heavy Doubles deliver damage quickly. Outside a lockout, repeated same-strength Doubles become an obvious Breaker target.

LINKERS

Ragged Edge: Light/Medium/Heavy Linker; Shadow version works as a 5-hit Shadow Linker.

Hamstring: Run+LK - Light/Medium/Heavy according to button/hold; Heavy is 3 hits.

Jumping Slash: Run+MK - Medium or Heavy family; Heavy is 3 hits. Shadow Jumping Slash is a fast, damaging 5-hit linker.

Ragged Edge linker animations resemble Sabrewulf's Doubles, making strength recognition trickier than average.

ENDERS

Eclipse - Damage Enders: DP + P; Shadow Eclipse gives excellent cash-out and can still leave a juggle.

Ragged Edge - Wall Splat Enders: QCB + HP; especially strong in the corner because Sabrewulf can dash through for reset ambiguity.

Running Uppercut - Launcher Enders: Run -> HP; sets up safe jump, juggle, sweep or Flipout.

No Battery Enders: Sabrewulf cannot cash out specifically for extra Shadow Meter.

RECAPTURE & FLIPOUT

Shadow Jumping Slash: Recapture - brings an airborne opponent back into a grounded combo.

Crouching LK: Flipout - knocks an airborne opponent immediately to their feet for a reset. Sabrewulf's cross-through dash makes Flipout especially dangerous because he can threaten either side plus throw.

MANUALS / BREAKERS

Use a single manually timed normal after an Opener or Linker to hide strength more effectively than a two-hit Auto-Double.

Combo Breaker: matching-strength P+K (LP+LK / MP+MK / HP+HK). **Counter Breaker:** MP+MK during your breakable combo. Sabrewulf's Rabid Doubles make lockout recognition particularly valuable.

SHADOW LINKER BREAKING

Shadow Jumping Slash has a slight delay after the freeze before contact; break the rhythm only once the hits begin.

Shadow Ragged Edge's first window is delayed by its claw animation, so the later hits are often easier to rhythm-break.

SABREWULF - INSTINCT, ULTRA & FINISHING SYSTEM

Instinct turns every risky Sabrewulf guess into a potential safe reset.

INSTINCT - FERAL CANCEL

Activate: HP+HK with a full Instinct gauge. Sabrewulf's normals gain chip damage and his specials deal substantially more chip. Most importantly, while Instinct is active press **HP+HK** to **Feral Cancel** nearly any move on hit, block, or whiff, immediately cutting its recovery. A short cooldown prevents another Feral Cancel for roughly 1.5 seconds.

FERAL CANCEL USES

- Make normally unsafe high/low attacks difficult to punish.
- Cancel a blocked or whiffed attack into another mixup.
- Make Shadow Eclipse reversal safe.
- Stop pressure before the opponent's Shadow Counter connects.
- Fake blockstun timing by canceling a whiff, then dash through / throw / Run mix.

This is the heart of modern Sabrewulf's comeback game.

INSTINCT CANCEL

The initial Instinct activation itself can cancel a grounded non-throw attack that hits or is blocked. Use it to save an unsafe mixup, reset KV during a combo, or freeze the screen and confirm the opponent's response before continuing pressure.

SHADOW COUNTER

While in blockstun: **MP+MK**. Costs one Shadow stock. Use it against predictable multi-hit pressure. Sabrewulf's own offense is vulnerable to Shadow Counters when Ragged Edge or other multi-hit pressure becomes predictable, which is another reason to vary timing and use Feral Cancel.

ULTRA COMBO

Perform Sabrewulf's **Ultra command during a combo while the opponent is in DANGER**. Ultra ends the match unless canceled/extended by a legal system option. Use MP+MK during the Ultra to end it early when supported by the standard Ultra system.

ULTIMATE

Sabrewulf is one of the modern KI characters with an **Ultimate**. While still on his first life bar, meet normal Ultra conditions, begin the Ultra, then press **LP+LK** during its opening portion to transition into his cinematic Ultimate.

STAGE ULTRA

On compatible stages and in the required screen position, Sabrewulf can substitute a Stage Ultra for the normal match-ending Ultra and knock the opponent into the stage hazard.

SABREWULF - ADVANCED ROUTES & PRACTICE

Lockout damage, Run mixups, launcher resets and Feral Cancel pressure.

0-METER COUNTER-BREAKER PUNISH

HP Double -> Heavy Jumping Slash -> HP Double -> Heavy Jumping Slash -> LP Double -> Eclipse Ender

This is the documented meterless high-damage Counter-Breaker route. Sabrewulf's Heavy Jumping Slash linker is unusually damaging, so it is worth using even though Heavy linkers normally waste valuable lockout time.

1-METER LOCKOUT ROUTE

HP Double -> Heavy Jumping Slash -> HP Double -> Heavy Jumping Slash -> Shadow Jumping Slash -> Eclipse Ender

If spending only one bar, Shadow Jumping Slash linker is generally a better lockout investment than saving the bar solely for a Shadow Ender.

2-METER DAMAGE ROUTE

HP Double -> Heavy Jumping Slash -> HP Double -> Heavy Jumping Slash -> Shadow Jumping Slash -> Shadow Eclipse Ender

Use only when closing the life bar is worth both Shadow stocks.

LAUNCHER RESET

Combo -> Running Uppercut Launcher Ender -> juggle -> crouching LK Flipout -> dash through / stay front / throw / Run high-low. This is more valuable than squeezing out a few extra juggle hits when continued offense can win the round.

SHADOW ECLIPSE RECAPTURE

Shadow Eclipse reversal -> Shadow Jumping Slash Recapture -> grounded combo. It costs two stocks, but turns Sabrewulf's invincible reversal into substantial offense. Cheaper alternatives are sweep or crouching-LK Flipout after the juggle.

FERAL MIXUP DRILL

Normal -> Run -> Hamstring / Jumping Slash -> Feral Cancel, then rotate among **dash-through jab, same-side Overpower, throw, another Run, or block**. The cancel's value comes from making the defender's correct first guess insufficient.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Ragged Edge, Run, Hamstring, Jumping Slash, Eclipse
2. Basic opener -> Double -> linker -> Eclipse Ender
3. Learn Damage / Wall Splat / Launcher Enders
4. Dash-through left/right and Run high/low separately
5. Running Uppercut -> Flipout reset
6. Rabid Doubles only on confirmed lockout
7. Shadow Eclipse defense and Shadow Jumping Slash Recapture
8. Counter Breaker lockout routes
9. Instinct Feral Cancel pressure
10. Ultra / Ultimate last

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - GLACIUS

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Shatter - QCF + P

Ground eruption placed at range; core zoning/mix tool.

Cold Shoulder - QCB + K

Advancing shoulder; pressure, opener and linker.

Puddle Punch - QCF + K

Rising puddle attack / anti-air family.

Hail - QCB + P (hold; add P buttons for more Hail)

Creates floating ice projectiles for layered zoning.

Shadow Shatter - QCF + 2P

Enhanced multi-hit ground eruption.

Shadow Cold Shoulder - QCB + 2K

Fast advancing Shadow attack.

Shadow Puddle Punch - QCF + 2K

Invincible reversal / anti-air.

Shadow Hail - QCB + 2P

Enhanced Hail setup.

Ice Lance - F + MP

Long-range command normal.

Ice Pick - B + HP

Heavy command normal for space control.

Liquidize - 3K (hold; B/F to move)

Turns Glacius into a mobile puddle.

Ultra - QCF + 3P

Ultra command in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3K

Only works on a supported Stage Ultra stage, at the required position/facing, during valid Ultra conditions.

GLACIUS - COMBO SYSTEM, LINKERS & ENDERS

His combo system is straightforward; the complexity comes from how he earns the opening.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Light Doubles are fastest and hardest to identify; Heavy Doubles are slowest but add the most immediate damage/KV. Replace a Double with a **Manual** after an Opener or Linker to hide strength. Glacius's unusual long-limbed animations make learning his Manual timing especially useful.

LINKERS

Cold Shoulder Linker: QCB + LK/MK or held strength for Heavy - Glacius's core ground Linker.

Shadow Cold Shoulder: 5-hit Shadow Linker and strong lockout damage tool.

Shadow Shatter: can serve as a meter extension in routes where spacing allows.

Keep Linkers simple until you can reliably recognize when a Hail/Shatter hit has created a real confirm.

ENDERS

Puddle Punch - Damage Ender: DP + P - primary raw-damage cash-out.

Cold Shoulder - Wall Splat Ender: QCB + HK - pushes the opponent into the wall and preserves pressure.

Shatter - Launcher Ender: QCF + HP - launches for post-cashout juggle/setplay.

Hail - Battery/Setup Ender: QCB + HP - character-specific meter/position reward depending on final game version.

Use Damage when the life bar matters; Launcher/Wall Splat when another mixup is worth more.

JUGGLE CONTROL

After a Launcher Ender, use Glacius's long normals, Puddle Punch or projectile cover to continue the juggle. The Ender has already cashed out potential damage, so post-Ender hits are about **position, Flipout/knockdown, or establishing Hail**, not preserving the old combo's white life.

COMBO BREAKER / COUNTER BREAKER

Breaker: matching-strength P+K (LP+LK / MP+MK / HP+HK).

Counter Breaker: MP+MK during Glacius's own breakable combo. Because Glacius works hard to get close, a successful Counter Breaker is often worth converting into maximum Damage Ender rather than giving up damage for a reset.

SHADOW LINKER BREAKING

Shadow Linkers are broken by successfully breaking **3 of the 5 hits**. Do not guess Light/Medium/Heavy as if it were an Auto-Double; listen to the hit rhythm and break three individual hits.

GLACIUS - INSTINCT, DEFENSE & FINISHERS

Instinct gives Glacius armor, radically changing how opponents are allowed to challenge him.

INSTINCT - ICE ARMOR

Activate: HP+HK with a full Instinct gauge. Glacius gains a layer of **Ice Armor** that can absorb an incoming hit without normal hitstun. After the armor is broken, it regenerates after a short period if Glacius avoids being hit. Multi-hit attacks and throws are natural answers, so Instinct does not mean he can attack without thought.

INSTINCT PRESSURE

Armor lets Glacius challenge gaps that would normally be too dangerous, walk a projectile/normal into Cold Shoulder range, or protect the startup of a zoning sequence. Once the opponent begins using multi-hit attacks or throws specifically to beat armor, use that expectation to create space for Hail/Shatter.

HAIL + SHATTER LAYER

Create Hail, then threaten Shatter at the opponent's current position. They must decide whether to **move to avoid Shatter, jump and risk Hail/anti-air, or stay grounded and block**. Glacius is strongest when these tools overlap rather than being thrown independently.

DEFENSE

Shadow Puddle Punch is the reliable invincible reversal when meter is available. Without meter, Glacius must defend more honestly: block, tech throws, use long normals to prevent entry, or Liquidize/reposition where appropriate. Do not treat normal Puddle Punch as a universal invincible escape.

SHADOW COUNTER

MP+MK while in blockstun, costing one Shadow stock. Use against predictable multi-hit strings. Because Glacius's close defense is weaker without meter, learning exactly which pressure strings are Shadow-Counterable is particularly valuable.

ULTRA / ULTIMATE

Ultra: use Glacius's character-specific Ultra command during a combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Ultimate: Glacius received a modern cinematic Ultimate. While Glacius remains on his first life bar and normal Ultra conditions are met, begin the Ultra and use the standard **LP+LK Ultimate transition** during its opening portion.

STAGE ULTRA

On compatible stages and at the required screen position, a Stage Ultra can replace the normal match-ending Ultra. Stage availability and positioning matter; it is not a universal finisher on every arena.

GLACIUS - ADVANCED SETUPS & PRACTICE

The goal is to make Hail, Shatter, long normals and Shoulder cover one another.

HAIL APPROACH

Hail -> walk/Cold Shoulder behind it. If the opponent swings at Glacius, Hail can interrupt them; if they respect Hail, Glacius gains the space needed to threaten throw, Manual pressure or another zoning layer. Vary Hail strength so the projectile does not always occupy the same lane.

SHATTER CONDITIONING

Use Shatter only after the opponent has been trained to stand still against Hail/long normals. Once they begin jumping to avoid Shatter, stop using it and meet the jump with **Puddle Punch or a long anti-air normal**. The strength is in forcing the response, not repeatedly guessing Shatter.

PRACTICAL MANUAL ROUTE

Medium Cold Shoulder -> HP Auto-Double -> Light Cold Shoulder Linker -> MP Manual -> Medium Cold Shoulder Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> Puddle Punch Ender

Once MP timing is stable, rotate Manual strengths so the defender cannot break from a memorized animation.

WALL SPLAT SETUP

Combo -> Cold Shoulder Wall Splat Ender -> Hail / cross-under or same-side pressure. Cashout has already happened; use the wall state to establish a projectile layer or force a throw/normal decision rather than simply restarting the same predictable combo.

LAUNCHER SETUP

Combo -> Shatter Launcher Ender -> long-normal juggle -> Hail setup / knockdown. If the opponent expects the juggle hit, vary the timing and take projectile positioning instead. Glacius often values screen control more than one extra juggle hit.

LOCKOUT ROUTE

Heavy Auto-Double -> Heavy Cold Shoulder Linker -> Heavy Auto-Double -> Shadow Cold Shoulder -> Puddle Punch Damage Ender. Use the slow, damaging pieces only after a confirmed lockout or Counter Breaker; otherwise Heavy animations are easy Breaker targets.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Long normals and spacing
2. Hail at each strength/position
3. Shatter distances
4. Cold Shoulder opener -> Double -> Linker -> Damage Ender
5. Puddle Punch anti-air and Shadow reversal
6. One Manual after Light Linker
7. Hail -> Shoulder approach
8. Hail -> Shatter -> anti-air decision tree
9. Wall Splat / Launcher setups
10. Ice Armor Instinct, Shadow Counter, Ultra and Ultimate

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - CHIEF THUNDER

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Triplax - QCF + P

Advancing strike; core opener/linker.

Call of the Earth - QCB + P

Command grab; central strike/throw threat.

Ankle Slicer - QCB + K

Low-hitting advancing attack.

Sammamish - F,D,DF + P

Rising uppercut/anti-air.

Rainmaker - Sammamish -> LK

Air follow-up from Sammamish.

Downpour - Sammamish -> MK

Alternate air follow-up.

Skyfall - Sammamish -> HK

Heavy descending follow-up.

Call of Sky - 3P

Charges Thunder's dash/crow mobility resource.

Shadow Triplax - QCF + 2P

Enhanced advancing multi-hit attack.

Shadow Call of the Earth - QCB + 2P

Shadow command grab.

Shadow Ankle Slicer - QCB + 2K

Enhanced low advancing attack.

Shadow Sammamish - F,D,DF + 2P

Invincible Shadow reversal.

Ultra - QCF + 3P

Ultra command in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3K

Only works on a supported Stage Ultra stage, at the required position/facing, during valid Ultra conditions.

CHIEF THUNDER - COMBOS, LINKERS & ENDERS

Thunder cashes out hard and turns launcher/juggle states into another close-range decision.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Use Light Doubles when you want speed and ambiguity; Heavy Doubles when a lockout gives you time to maximize damage. A **Manual** is a single timed normal after an Opener or Linker. Thunder's strong close normals make Manuals especially useful for disguising whether the next threat is another combo piece or a reset into command grab.

LINKERS

Triplax Linker: QCB + P - core ground Linker; strength changes speed/hits.

Ankle Slicer Linker: QCB + K - low-looking combo animation and useful strength mix.

Shadow Triplax / Shadow Ankle Slicer: 5-hit Shadow Linkers for meter damage and lockout punishment.

ENDERS

Sammamish - Damage Ender: DP + P - primary cash-out when life matters.

Triplax - Wall Splat Ender: QCB + HP - keeps Thunder close and sets up strike/throw pressure.

Ankle Slicer - Hard Knockdown/position Ender: QCB + HK - favors continued approach/setplay.

Launcher route: character/version-specific ender/juggle option leading into Thunder's aerial follow-up game.

Thunder often prefers position when one more command-grab mix can end the life bar.

SAMMAMISH FOLLOW-UPS

After a successful Sammamish launch, Thunder can convert with aerial attacks and movement options rather than simply returning to neutral. Practice **anti-air Sammamish -> aerial follow-up -> landing pressure** as its own drill; it is one of the main ways Thunder turns defense into offense.

COMBO BREAKER / COUNTER BREAKER

Breaker: match strength with LP+LK / MP+MK / HP+HK.

Counter Breaker: MP+MK during Thunder's own breakable combo. Because Thunder's Heavy attacks and Shadow Linkers cash out enormous damage, a successful Counter Breaker should usually become a deliberate lockout route rather than an improvised string.

SHADOW LINKER BREAKING

As with the rest of modern KI, Shadow Linkers are broken by successfully breaking **3 of 5 hits**. Watch the hit rhythm instead of guessing Light/Medium/Heavy.

RESET PRINCIPLE

A reset intentionally ends the breakable combo before the Ender and immediately threatens a new hit or command grab. The reward is another full combo; the risk is giving the opponent a chance to escape. Thunder's command grab makes this risk/reward unusually threatening.

CHIEF THUNDER - CALL OF SKY, INSTINCT & FINISHERS

Mobility is what separates modern Thunder from a traditional slow grappler.

CALL OF SKY / CROW DASH

Call of Sky powers Thunder with lightning and enables his special forward mobility, commonly called **Crow Dash**. Use it to suddenly close space, alter pressure timing and turn a knockdown into another close-range guess. The charge is a resource/setup choice: earn it when the opponent gives you room, then spend the mobility to bypass neutral.

SAMMAMISH MOBILITY

Thunder's later-season toolset allows powerful movement after Sammamish, including directional follow-ups that can change where he lands relative to the opponent. This creates **same-side/cross-up ambiguity** after anti-airs and combo launches. Learn the landing positions before trying to layer command grab on top.

INSTINCT MODE

Activate: HP+HK with full Instinct. Thunder's Instinct enhances his mobility/Call-of-Sky game and gives him repeated access to the movement that normally requires setup. The practical result is relentless approach: blocked pressure can lead back into dash movement, throw threats and another strike/command-grab decision.

SHADOW COUNTER

MP+MK while in blockstun, costing one Shadow stock. Thunder benefits greatly because successful Shadow Counter immediately puts a grappler at point-blank range. Do not spend the meter automatically if blocking the string already leaves you close enough to threaten a throw.

ULTRA COMBO

Use Thunder's **character-specific Ultra command** during a combo while the opponent is in DANGER. The Ultra ends the match and can use the standard modern KI Ultra-cancel/extension rules where applicable.

ULTIMATE

Chief Thunder has a cinematic Ultimate. While Thunder remains on his first life bar and the opponent is in the proper Ultra state, begin the Ultra and use the standard **LP+LK Ultimate transition** during the opening portion.

STAGE ULTRA

On compatible stages and at the correct screen position, Thunder can use a Stage Ultra instead of the normal match-ending Ultra. Availability depends on the arena.

DEFENSIVE RULE

Normal Sammamish should not be treated as a meterless universal invincible reversal. When true invulnerability is required, **Shadow Sammamish** is the reliable choice. Otherwise block, tech, backdash where appropriate, or use Thunder's reach to stop pressure before it begins.

CHIEF THUNDER - ADVANCED ROUTES & PRACTICE

The advanced game is not long execution - it is making the defender guess wrong at point-blank range.

WALL-SPLAT MIX

Combo -> Triplax Wall Splat Ender -> command grab / meaty normal / Ankle Slicer / delayed throw. The white life is already cashed out, so use the wall state to create a fresh mix rather than automatically starting the same combo again.

SAMMAMISH ANTI-AIR CONVERSION

Opponent jumps -> Sammamish -> aerial follow-up -> land close -> strike/command-grab mix. Once the opponent stops jumping because of this conversion, Thunder's grounded command grab becomes much harder to escape.

PRACTICAL MANUAL ROUTE

Medium Triplax -> HP Auto-Double -> Light Triplax Linker -> MP Manual -> Medium Ankle Slicer Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> Sammamish Damage Ender

After this is reliable, vary the Manual strength or reset after the Manual into command grab.

LOCKOUT DAMAGE ROUTE

HP Auto-Double -> Heavy Triplax Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> Shadow Triplax -> HP Auto-Double -> Sammamish Damage Ender

Reserve the slow Heavy pieces for a confirmed lockout/Counter Breaker. If KV is close to maximum, cash out early rather than blowing out.

CALL-OF-SKY APPROACH DRILL

Earn Call of Sky at range, then rotate the powered approach among **dash -> throw, dash -> MP/HP, dash -> Ankle Slicer, and dash -> block.** The last option is important: once opponents begin mashing to stop the grab, dash-block lets you punish their panic response.

RESET ROUTE

Opener -> Auto-Double -> Light Linker -> Manual -> stop combo -> command grab. Next time use the same beginning but finish the Manual into another Linker. The defender now has to decide whether to break the combo or escape the grab, which is exactly where Thunder wants them.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Triplax, Ankle Slicer and Sammamish
2. Basic Opener -> Double -> Linker -> Damage Ender
3. Command grab from true close range
4. Sammamish anti-air conversions
5. One Manual after Light Linker
6. Wall Splat -> strike/throw mix
7. Call of Sky / Crow Dash approaches
8. Counter Breaker lockout route
9. Sammamish mobility/cross-up positions
10. Instinct, Shadow Counter, Ultra and Ultimate

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - SPINAL

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Searing Skull - QCF + P

Projectile that uses/feeds Spinal's skull pressure system.

Soul Sword - QCB + P

Sword special used for pressure and combos.

Boneshaker - QCF + K

Advancing shield attack.

Skeleport - QCB + K

Teleport; LK far, MK front, HK behind.

Power Devour - B + hold LP

Absorbs a projectile to gain skull resource.

Slide Kick - D + HK

Low sliding command normal.

Dive Kick - air MK

Air approach that changes jump timing.

Shadow Searing Skull - QCF + 2P

Enhanced skull projectile.

Shadow Soul Sword - QCB + 2P

Enhanced sword pressure/linker.

Shadow Boneshaker - QCF + 2K

Enhanced advancing attack.

Shadow Skeleport - QCB + 2K

Invincible/utility Shadow teleport.

Shadow Skull Summon - D,D + 3P

Shadow skull-resource summon.

Ultra - QCB + 3K

Ultra command in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCB + 3P

Only works on a supported Stage Ultra stage, at the required position/facing, during valid Ultra conditions.

SPINAL - SPECTRAL MANUALS, LINKERS & ENDERS

His combo trait converts correct offense into the resource that powers his neutral game.

SPECTRAL MANUALS - COMBO TRAIT

After an Auto-Double fully completes, press the **same attack button again**. Ghostly hands rise from the ground for a third hit of the same strength and Spinal earns **1 skull**. Timing is forgiving. Because the strength is telegraphed by the preceding Double, use Spectral Manuals most aggressively during lockouts; they add large potential damage and rapidly raise Ender level.

LINKERS

Boneshaker: normal and Shadow Linker.

Soul Sword: normal and Shadow Linker; Light is the preferred fast damage-loop version.

Skeleport: unusual Linker that teleports behind and strikes 1/2/3 times according to strength.

Shadow Searing Skull: unbreakable projectile extension that keeps the opponent grounded and allows a free Manual afterward while applying an Instinct curse.

ENDERS

Searing Skull - Battery Ender: grants skulls; usually the best first-combo choice.

Skeleport - Damage Ender: high-damage cash-out; Shadow version is even stronger and switches sides.

Soul Sword - Launcher Ender: launches after cashout, letting Spinal apply additional skull curses to the airborne opponent.

Boneshaker - Wall Splat Ender: preserves close pressure and corner mix.

NO FLIPOUT / RECAPTURE

Spinal has **neither a Flipout nor a Recapture**. His Launcher Ender is instead valuable because it creates time to apply curses. His grounded skull/teleport mix is strong enough that he does not need the modern Flipout reset system to remain threatening.

RUN CANCELS

Spend **1 skull** to run-cancel most normal attacks on hit or block (except crouching heavies). Standing HK and crouching MK are excellent candidates. Cancel the normal, then threaten **throw, overhead Shield Crush, low, another normal, neutral jump or teleport**. Throws are especially valuable because they can earn the skull back.

BREAKERS

Combo Breaker: match strength with LP+LK / MP+MK / HP+HK.

Counter Breaker: MP+MK during your own breakable combo.

Shadow Linkers: break any 3 of 5 hits in rhythm. Shadow Boneshaker is rapid; Shadow Soul Sword is slower with larger gaps.

SPINAL - CURSES, INSTINCT & FINISHERS

Resource denial is what turns Spinal's offense from tricky into oppressive.

SHADOW-METER CURSE

A normal **Searing Skull** hit applies the purple Shadow-Meter curse, preventing the opponent from earning additional Shadow Meter while active. Multiple curses can stack. Hitting Spinal removes only the oldest curse, so stacked skulls can keep resources disabled across several exchanges.

INSTINCT-METER CURSE

Shadow Searing Skull fires a large yellow projectile without spending a skull and curses Instinct gain. It cannot stop an opponent from activating Instinct if their gauge is already full, but it can prevent them from building toward the next activation.

INSTINCT - BOUNCING SKULL CHAOS

Activate: HP+HK. Spinal immediately gains **3 skulls**. Most normal skull-earning methods then award double skulls. Searing Skull projectiles bounce from walls/floor/ceiling until they hit the opponent, are blocked three times, or Spinal is hit. Power Devour can reabsorb a returning bouncing skull for reuse.

INSTINCT MIX

Launch an overhead/vertical skull, then layer **low skull, run-canceled normal, throw, or Skeleport front/back**. Once even one bouncing projectile is established, the opponent must defend the skull while also tracking Spinal's own mix. If Spinal is hit, the projectile chaos disappears, so protect momentum rather than overextending.

DEFENSE

Spinal has **weak reversal defense**. His teleport is short and can be covered, and he lacks a simple fast invincible reversal that solves meaty pressure. Block patiently, use Power Devour only on a hard read against specials, and spend Shadow Counter carefully rather than assuming a special move will rescue every knockdown.

SHADOW COUNTER

MP+MK while in blockstun, costing one Shadow stock. Successful Shadow Counter is particularly valuable because it lets Spinal escape pressure and immediately begin earning/applying resources.

ULTRA / ULTIMATE

Ultra: perform Spinal's character-specific Ultra command during a combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Ultimate: Spinal has a modern cinematic Ultimate. While still on his first life bar and in valid Ultra conditions, begin the Ultra and use the standard **LP+LK Ultimate transition** during its opening portion.

SPINAL - ADVANCED ROUTES & PRACTICE

Earn one skull, turn it into momentum, then make the opponent fight through curses and teleport layers.

0-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HP Double -> HP Spectral Manual -> Light Soul Sword -> HP Double -> HP Spectral Manual -> Skeleport Damage Ender

A documented high-damage lockout route. Spectral Manuals outperform simply cramming in more Heavy Doubles because they add large potential damage while also earning skulls.

1-METER ROUTE

HP Double -> HP Spectral Manual -> Light Soul Sword -> HP Double -> Shadow Soul Sword -> Skeleport Ender

Use the meter when closing the life bar matters more than preserving Shadow stock for curses or defense.

2-METER ROUTE

HP Double -> HP Spectral Manual -> Light Soul Sword -> HP Double -> Shadow Soul Sword -> Shadow Skeleport Ender

Maximum documented lockout cash-out; Shadow Skeleport switches sides at the end.

FIRST-SKULL PLAN

At round start, prioritize one of four reliable skull sources: **throw, crouching-HP anti-air, Spectral Manual, or short combo -> Searing Skull Battery Ender**. Once the first skull exists, stop playing resource-poor Spinal and begin using run cancels/projectile pressure.

CLASSIC SKULL TELEPORT MIX

Back throw -> earn skull -> HP Searing Skull -> Heavy Skeleport, then choose front/back continuation, throw, or another teleport if skull resources allow. The overhead skull covers the teleport decision and forces the opponent to track two attack vectors.

POWER DEVOUR DRILL

Use **F+LP (hold)** only when you have identified a special move. Each absorbed special-move hit earns a skull. Do not use it against ordinary normals or throws; the shield is specifically a special-move read, not a universal parry.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Soul Sword, Boneshaker, Skeleport
2. Earn one skull from each source
3. Basic combo -> Searing Skull Battery Ender
4. Spectral Manual after every Double strength
5. LP/MP/HP Searing Skull trajectories
6. Run cancel -> throw / overhead / low
7. Launcher Ender -> curse setup
8. Heavy Skeleport skull cancels
9. Counter-Breaker damage routes
10. Instinct bouncing-skull pressure, Shadow Counter, Ultra and Ultimate

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - ORCHID

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Flick Flack - QCB + K

Acrobatic kick special; pressure/combo tool.

Ichi Ni San - QCF + P > P > P

Three-part rekka punch sequence.

Blockade Runner - QCF + K

Advancing knee/run-style special.

Air Buster - F,D,DF + K

Rising anti-air/reversal family.

Grenade Toss - B + HP (hold for farther toss)

Throws grenade; hold changes distance.

Whiplash - F + HK

Advancing command normal.

Danger Zone - air LP+LK

Air throw.

Shadow Flick Flack - QCB + 2K

Enhanced multi-hit kick.

Shadow Ichi Ni San - QCF + 2P

Enhanced rekka sequence.

Firecat / Shadow Blockade - QCF + 2K

Firecat Shadow approach.

Upper Firecat - F,D,DF + 2K

Invincible Shadow reversal.

Ultra - QCB + 3K

Ultra command in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCB + 3P

Only works on a supported Stage Ultra stage, at the required position/facing, during valid Ultra conditions.

ORCHID - DOUBLE LINKERS, ENDERS & JUGGLES

Her combo trait lets Ichi Ni San break the normal one-Linker rhythm.

DOUBLE LINKERS - COMBO TRAIT

Orchid can perform **two Ichi Ni San Linkers back-to-back** at any strength. Example: **HP Auto-Double -> Medium Ichi Ni San -> Medium Ichi Ni San -> HP Auto-Double**. This can add damage or surprise someone expecting a Double/Manual after the first Linker. Do not overuse it: each strength has a distinctive animation and becomes easy to break once expected.

LINKERS

Flick Flack: Light/Medium/Heavy Linker; 2/3/4 hits respectively. Shadow version is a 5-hit high-damage Linker.

Blockade Runner: Light/Medium/Heavy Linker and Orchid's highest-damage normal Linker.

Ichi Ni San: Light = 1-hit low animation; Medium = 2-hit overhead animation; Heavy = 3-hit body attack. May be doubled because of Orchid's combo trait.

ENDERS

Air Buster - Damage Ender: DP + K; Shadow Upper Firecat can cash out for even more damage.

Flick Flack - Exchange Launcher: QCB + HK; launches and changes relative positioning.

Ichi Ni San - Launcher Ender: QCF + HP; jump-cancel the final hit for an air follow-up.

Blockade Runner - Wall Splat Ender: QCF + HK; carries to the wall and preserves pressure.

No Battery Ender: Orchid must build Shadow Meter normally.

IICHI NI SAN LAUNCHER -> AIR THROW

After the Ichi Ni San Launcher Ender, **jump cancel -> Air Throw**. Because the Air Throw occurs mid-combo, it does **not** recapture; it causes a ground bounce with full KV. From there, hit the bouncing opponent with a normal such as crouching HP and cancel into Grenade so they land into delayed explosive pressure.

RECAPTURE / FLIPOUT

Air Throw as the first hit = Recapture. Air Throw during an existing combo = ground bounce instead. Orchid has **no mid-combo recapture and no Flipout**, so juggles usually end in knockdown/setplay or spend Shadow Meter to cash out.

BREAKERS

Combo Breaker: LP+LK / MP+MK / HP+HK to match Light / Medium / Heavy.

Counter Breaker: MP+MK during Orchid's breakable combo.

Shadow Flick Flack: its 5 hits are deliberately staggered. A useful break rhythm is hits **1, 3, 5**, or catch hit 1 and then the rapid final hits 4 and 5.

ORCHID - GRENADE, INSTINCT & FINISHERS

Orchid makes unsafe mixups safe by putting another attack on the screen first.

GRENADE SETPLAY

B+HP creates a delayed explosion; hold HP for a farther throw/longer timing. Set Grenade after a knockdown, Launcher/Air Throw sequence, or when the opponent is forced to respect a poke. Then threaten **Ichi low**, **Ichi overhead**, **Whiplash**, **throw**, **Blockade Runner**, or **cross-up** while the Grenade covers the recovery/punish attempt.

IICHI NI SAN PRESSURE

The first two rekka hits establish pressure; the third hit is the decision. **LP low** and **MP overhead** are punishable if blocked. HP can be held for frame advantage, fully charged to unblockable, or dash-canceled forward while charging. Once the defender tries to interrupt the dash cancel, delay the HP release to catch their button.

INSTINCT - FIRECAT ASSIST

Activate: HP+HK. Activation itself calls a Firecat if none is active. While Instinct lasts, press **HP+HK** again whenever the short cooldown allows to call another. Firecat runs from behind Orchid and explodes on hit or block. Crucially, it continues even if Orchid is hit, often interrupting an opponent's attempted punish or combo.

FIRECAT MIX

Call Firecat, then layer **Blockade Runner low**, **Whiplash overhead**, **Ichi Ni San high/low**, **throw**, **jump/cross-up** or **dash pressure**. Firecat can make normally punishable attacks effectively safe and can frustrate Shadow Counter attempts. Add Grenade and the defender must track Orchid plus two delayed attack sources.

SHADOW COUNTER / DEFENSE

Shadow Counter: MP+MK while in blockstun, costing one Shadow stock. **Air Buster** is Orchid's meterless invincible anti-air/reversal; Upper Firecat is the Shadow version for higher reward. Her offense itself can be Shadow Countered, especially predictable Ichi strings, so vary the third-hit timing and use Grenade/Firecat cover.

ULTRA / STAGE ULTRA

Ultra Combo: QCB + 3K during a combo while the opponent is in DANGER.
Ultra Ender: MP+MK during the Ultra to finish early with Orchid's Firecat sequence.
Stage Ultra: QCB + 3P on compatible stages and in the required position.

ULTIMATE NOTE

Modern Orchid does **not** have one of the cinematic Season 3 Ultimate finishers. Her modern match-ending choices are Ultra and compatible Stage Ultras; do not import her K12/Gold Ultimate into the 2013 move set.

ORCHID - ADVANCED ROUTES & PRACTICE

Mid-screen control first; layered Grenade/Firecat offense second; lockout damage last.

0-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HP Double -> Medium Ichi Ni San -> HP Double -> Medium Ichi Ni San -> HP Double -> Air Buster Ender

Approximately **47%** in the isolated Counter-Breaker test used by the Complete KI Guide. Medium Ichi is fast and damaging enough to fit the maximum Heavy Doubles.

1-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HP Double -> Medium Ichi Ni San -> HP Double -> Medium Ichi Ni San -> Shadow Flick Flack -> Air Buster Ender

Approximately **57%** in the same test conditions. Shadow Flick Flack is a better damage investment here than saving the stock solely for the Ender.

2-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HP Double -> Medium Ichi Ni San -> Medium Ichi Ni San -> Shadow Flick Flack -> Shadow Flick Flack -> Air Buster Ender

Approximately **65%**. The route deliberately uses Orchid's Double-Linker trait; the second Shadow Flick Flack extends slightly beyond the lockout but not long enough for a successful 3-hit Shadow break.

GRENADE WAKEUP ROUTE

Ichi Ni San Launcher Ender -> jump cancel -> Air Throw ground bounce -> crouching HP -> Grenade Toss. Let the opponent land into the ticking Grenade, then choose low/overhead/throw or simply block if they attempt an invincible escape.

NEUTRAL FLOW

Walk in and out of range with **crouching MP, standing MP and standing HP**, canceling confirmed hits/pressure into Ichi Ni San. Use sweep to low-profile some projectiles, Blockade Runner to challenge horizontal zoning, jumping MK for cross-up, and Air Buster when the opponent tries to jump over Orchid's grounded control.

INSTINCT PRESSURE DRILL

Call Firecat -> Blockade Runner / Ichi mix -> Firecat cooldown -> Grenade -> call next Firecat. Practice seeing whether the assist hit, was blocked, or interrupted a punish. On hit, confirm with a Manual; on block, continue pressure; if Orchid gets hit first, be ready for the Firecat to interrupt and reverse momentum.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Ichi Ni San low / overhead / HP charge
2. Flick Flack, Blockade Runner, Air Buster
3. Basic Opener -> Double -> Linker -> Air Buster Ender
4. Double Ichi Ni San Linkers
5. Neutral Air Throw -> Recapture combo
6. Launcher Ender -> Air Throw -> Grenade setup
7. Shadow Flick Flack break rhythm
8. Counter-Breaker 0/1/2-meter routes
9. Instinct Firecat + Grenade layered pressure
10. Ultra and Stage Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - FULGORE

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Blade Dash - QCF + K

Advancing blade attack; opener/linker.

Plasma Slice - F,D,DF + P

Rising anti-air/reversal family.

Eye Laser - QCB + P

Laser attack for pressure and space control.

Energy Bolt - QCF + P > P > P

Multi-step projectile sequence.

Plasma Port - QCB + K

Teleport; strength determines destination.

Shadow Blade Dash - QCF + 2K

Enhanced advancing Shadow attack.

Shadow Eye Laser - QCB + 2P

Enhanced laser pressure.

Shadow Energy Bolt - QCF + 2P

Enhanced projectile sequence.

Shadow Plasma Slice - F,D,DF + 2P

Invincible Shadow reversal.

Shadow Plasma Port - QCB + 2K

Enhanced teleport.

Devastation Beam - QCF + 3P

Massive beam when required reactor/resource state is met.

Ultra - F,D,DF + 3P

Ultra command in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - F,D,DF + 3K

Only works on a supported Stage Ultra stage, at the required position/facing, during valid Ultra conditions.

FULGORE - COMBOS, ENDERS & PIP CANCELS

The combo engine is conventional; the reactor lets him break conventional cancel rules.

AUTO-DOUBLES / MANUALS

Use Light Doubles for speed, Heavy Doubles for lockout damage, and Manuals to hide strength. Fulgore's strong standing/crouching normals give him useful Manuals after light Linkers. Once the basic Manual timing is stable, begin spending pips to alter when specials and teleports appear.

LINKERS

Blade Dash Linker: core advancing Linker at Light/Medium/Heavy strengths.

Eye Laser / projectile Linker family: version-specific ranged combo extension where applicable.

Shadow Blade Dash: 5-hit Shadow Linker with excellent movement and damage.

Shadow Plasma Slice: best reserved for reversal or final cashout rather than casually inserted into every combo.

ENDERS

Plasma Slice - Damage Ender: primary raw-damage cashout.

Blade Dash - Wall Splat Ender: carries the opponent and preserves corner pressure.

Plasma Bolt - Battery/Reactor Ender: favors resource development and the next sequence.

Launcher/position Ender: character-specific route that trades immediate damage for juggle/teleport pressure.

Choose the Ender based on whether you need life, corner position or reactor resources.

PIP CANCEL SYSTEM

Fulgore can spend reactor pips to **cancel specials into other specials/teleports**, creating sequences that ordinary characters cannot perform. The practical uses are: make pressure safer, turn a projectile into sudden close offense, convert an awkward hit, or create a left/right teleport mix. Do not burn pips merely because they are available; each cancel delays access to full Shadow resources.

TELEPORT MIX

Layer **Plasma Bolt -> teleport front/back -> normal/throw**. Once the opponent starts swinging to stop teleport, remain in front and punish the button. Once they sit still, teleport through or throw. Pip cancels allow the projectile and teleport to overlap closely enough that the defender must track both.

BREAKERS

Combo Breaker: match Light/Medium/Heavy with LP+LK / MP+MK / HP+HK.

Counter Breaker: MP+MK during your own breakable combo.

Shadow Linkers: break 3 of the 5 hits in rhythm. A confirmed lockout is the safest time to spend pips/Shadow Meter on Fulgore's expensive damage routes.

FULGORE - INSTINCT, REACTOR & FINISHERS

Instinct removes the reactor's biggest limitation and turns Fulgore into a cancel machine.

INSTINCT - MAXIMUM REACTOR

Activate: HP+HK with full Instinct. Fulgore's reactor reaches maximum spin and supplies greatly accelerated resource access for the duration. This lets him use pip cancels, projectile layers and teleport pressure far more aggressively than normal without immediately starving himself of meter.

INSTINCT OFFENSE

The basic pattern is **Plasma Bolt -> pip cancel -> Teleport/Blade Dash -> pressure -> another cancel**. The point is not random movement; use each cancel to cover the recovery of the previous action and force the defender to guess whether Fulgore remains in front, crosses through, throws, or attacks.

PLASMA BOLT ZONING

Vary projectile speed and follow-up timing. A slow Bolt occupies space while Fulgore advances; a faster Bolt checks movement immediately. Once the opponent jumps, meet them with Plasma Slice or an anti-air normal. Once they stop moving, teleport or walk behind the projectile to start offense.

DEFENSE

Plasma Slice gives Fulgore a true uppercut-style defensive threat; Shadow Plasma Slice is the high-reward invincible version. This forces opponents to respect his wakeup even while he is managing reactor resources. Do not overuse it: a blocked uppercut costs position and can waste the meter/pips Fulgore worked to build.

SHADOW COUNTER

MP+MK while in blockstun, costing one Shadow stock. Because Fulgore's Shadow stock is reactor-generated, evaluate whether a normal defensive answer or Plasma Slice will accomplish the same job before spending it.

ULTRA / ULTIMATE

Ultra: perform Fulgore's character-specific Ultra command during a combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Ultimate: Fulgore has a modern cinematic Ultimate. While still on his first life bar and under valid Ultra conditions, begin the Ultra and use the standard **LP+LK Ultimate transition** during its opening portion.

DEVASTATION BEAM

Devastation Beam is Fulgore's signature high-resource laser attack. It requires a major reactor/meter commitment and is best treated as a special tactical payoff rather than a normal neutral tool. Confirm or set it up; throwing it out carelessly can surrender the resources that power Fulgore's entire game.

FULGORE - ADVANCED ROUTES & PRACTICE

The goal is to make reactor management invisible: build while attacking, spend only when the cancel changes the situation.

PRACTICAL MANUAL ROUTE

Medium Blade Dash -> HP Auto-Double -> Light Blade Dash Linker -> MP Manual -> Medium Blade Dash Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> Plasma Slice Damage Ender

After this is stable, replace one normal transition with a pip-cancelled special/teleport rather than adding complexity everywhere.

PROJECTILE TELEPORT ROUTE

Slow Plasma Bolt -> advance -> pip-cancel Teleport -> MP/throw -> Blade Dash confirm. If the opponent attacks the expected teleport point, next time remain in front and let the projectile protect you. If they block, take the throw or delayed overhead/normal.

LOCKOUT DAMAGE ROUTE

HP Auto-Double -> Heavy Blade Dash Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> Shadow Blade Dash -> HP Auto-Double -> Plasma Slice Damage Ender

Use Heavy pieces only after a confirmed lockout/Counter Breaker. Watch KV and cash out before blowout.

CORNER PRESSURE

Combo -> Blade Dash Wall Splat Ender -> Plasma Bolt / teleport / throw. A slow projectile in the corner makes Fulgore's teleport especially difficult to read because the opponent has little room to retreat. Alternate cross-through with same-side pressure rather than always teleporting.

REACTOR MANAGEMENT RULE

Think in three states: **Low reactor** - play clean fundamentals and build momentum. **Healthy reactor** - spend occasional pips to secure pressure/conversions. **Instinct/max reactor** - aggressively layer cancels and force the opponent to survive repeated guesses. Avoid draining yourself to zero for a mixup that was not necessary.

DEVASTATION BEAM SETUP

Use Beam only after a strong read, stun/lockout-style opportunity, or setup that prevents an easy escape. Treat it as the reward for excellent resource management. If the opponent can simply jump or punish the startup, keep the reactor resources for Shadow moves and pip cancels instead.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Plasma Bolt, Blade Dash and Plasma Slice
2. Basic Opener -> Double -> Linker -> Damage Ender
3. Projectile speed/timing patterns
4. Teleport destinations and same-side fake
5. One Manual after Light Linker
6. Reactor spin awareness / pip economy
7. One pip-cancel sequence at a time
8. Wall Splat -> projectile/teleport mix
9. Counter-Breaker lockout damage
10. Instinct max-reactor pressure, Devastation Beam, Ultra and Ultimate

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - CINDER

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Trailblazer - B,F + K (air OK)

Directional flying attack; approach, escape and juggle tool.

Afterburner - Trailblazer -> direction + K

Second Trailblazer direction change.

Fireflash - D,U + K

Rising flame anti-air/reversal.

Inferno - QCB + K

Horizontal flame stream; pressure and combo tool.

Fission - QCB + MP/HP; LP = fake

Explosive pressure special with fake option.

Pyrobomb - B,F + P (air OK)

Attaches delayed explosive bomb.

Pyrotechnics - 3P

Detonates attached Pyrobombs.

Crossfire - air D + HK

Downward air attack.

Shadow Trailblazer - B,F + 2K

Enhanced multi-hit flying attack.

Shadow Fireflash - D,U + 2K

Invincible Shadow reversal.

Shadow Inferno - QCB + 2K

Enhanced multi-hit Inferno.

Shadow Pyrobomb - B,F + 2P

Enhanced bomb application.

Ultra - QCB + 3K

Ultra command in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCB + 3P

Only works on a supported Stage Ultra stage, at the required position/facing, during valid Ultra conditions.

CINDER - BURNOUT, LINKERS & ENDERS

Burnout is Cinder's defining damage mechanic: make blocking hurt.

BURNOUT SYSTEM

Cinder can apply **Burnout** to the opponent's Punch or Kick limbs through his Burnout Enders. While a limb is burning, using attacks from that limb category causes the opponent to take additional potential/real damage over time according to the final system rules. The defender can wait for the effect to expire or risk using the burning limb and feed Cinder extra damage.

LINKERS

Inferno Linker: primary grounded multi-hit Linker.

Trailblazer Linker: movement-heavy combo extension with strength-dependent behavior.

Shadow Inferno / Shadow Trailblazer: 5-hit Shadow Linkers used for damage and lockout punishment.

Cinder's animations are visually distinctive; Manuals are important so the defender cannot simply key on his obvious multi-hit Linkers.

ENDERS

Fireflash - Damage Ender: primary direct cashout.

Punch Burnout Ender: applies Burnout to Punch attacks.

Kick Burnout Ender: applies Burnout to Kick attacks.

Pyrobomb / setup Ender: favors delayed pressure and future conversion where the route/version supports it.

Early in a life bar, Burnout can be worth more than immediate damage; late in the life bar, cash out with Fireflash.

CHOOSING A BURNOUT

Watch how the opponent plays. If their best pressure/neutral tools are Punches, apply **Punch Burnout**; if their mobility and confirms rely on Kicks, apply **Kick Burnout**. Burnout is strongest when it attacks the opponent's preferred buttons rather than being selected automatically.

PYROBOMB SETPLAY

Attach a Pyrobomb, then use Trailblazer movement, throw, low/normal pressure or Inferno to force the opponent to defend while the bomb remains live. Detonate when it will **cover Cinder's recovery, extend a juggle, interrupt a punish, or convert an otherwise weak hit**.

BREAKERS

Combo Breaker: match strength with LP+LK / MP+MK / HP+HK.

Counter Breaker: MP+MK during Cinder's breakable combo.

Shadow Linkers: break 3 of the 5 hits in rhythm. Cinder's long multi-hit animations make rhythm practice particularly important.

CINDER - FIRED UP, INSTINCT & FINISHERS

His strongest offense layers enhanced specials, bombs and aerial movement until defense becomes overloaded.

FIRED UP

Fired Up enhances Cinder's special-move properties after its recharge/activation conditions are met. Enhanced specials improve his pressure, damage or conversion ability depending on the move. Watch the character's visual state rather than assuming every special has its powered property available at all times.

INSTINCT MODE

Activate: HP+HK with full Instinct. Cinder's Instinct greatly accelerates his explosive offense, giving him enhanced access to his fire-based resources and letting him layer Pyrobomb/Trailblazer pressure far more aggressively. Use the activation freeze to confirm the opponent's position before committing to the next angle.

INSTINCT PRESSURE

A practical layer is **Pyrobomb -> Trailblazer approach -> normal/throw -> bomb detonation -> continued juggle or reset**. Vary when the bomb explodes. If every detonation occurs immediately, the defender can block one rehearsed sequence; delayed explosions are what make Cinder difficult to pin down.

DEFENSE

Fireflash is Cinder's anti-air/reversal family; Shadow Fireflash is the reliable invincible high-reward version. Trailblazer can also escape unusual situations, but it should not be treated as a substitute for blocking when the opponent has covered Cinder's flight path.

SHADOW COUNTER

MP+MK while in blockstun, costing one Shadow stock. Cinder can turn the resulting hit into Burnout or Pyrobomb offense. Conversely, predictable Inferno pressure can invite an opponent's Shadow Counter, so vary timing and stop strings early when necessary.

ULTRA COMBO

Perform Cinder's **character-specific Ultra command** during a combo while the opponent is in DANGER. Use the standard modern KI Ultra system for extensions/early ending where applicable.

ULTIMATE / STAGE ULTRA

Use only finishers actually available to Cinder in the final modern KI build. Do not import classic KI finishing commands into the 2013 move set. Compatible stages can provide a Stage Ultra when the positioning requirements are met.

CINDER - ADVANCED ROUTES & PRACTICE

Movement first, delayed explosives second, maximum lockout damage only after both are reliable.

PRACTICAL MANUAL ROUTE

Trailblazer opener -> HP Auto-Double -> Light Inferno Linker -> MP Manual -> Medium Inferno Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> Fireflash Damage Ender

Rotate Manual strengths once the MP timing is stable; Cinder becomes much harder to break when the defender cannot rely on his distinctive Auto-Double rhythm.

PYROBOMB CONVERSION

Attach Pyrobomb -> pressure -> bomb hit/detonation -> Manual -> Trailblazer/Inferno conversion. Practice confirming the explosion rather than committing beforehand. On block, keep pressure safe; on hit, convert; if Cinder is challenged, use the delayed explosion to reverse momentum.

AIR ROUTE

Launcher/juggle -> Trailblazer -> directional second Trailblazer -> landing pressure or Fireflash cashout. Change the second angle according to screen position. The best route is the one that leaves Cinder where he wants to be, not necessarily the one with the most airborne hits.

BURNOUT GAME PLAN

First clean combo -> identify opponent's preferred limb -> appropriate Burnout Ender. Afterward, pressure the opponent into using the burned buttons. Once Burnout has accumulated enough value or the life bar is low, switch future combos to Fireflash Damage Ender.

LOCKOUT ROUTE

HP Auto-Double -> Heavy Inferno Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> Shadow Inferno -> HP Auto-Double -> Fireflash Damage Ender. Use the slow Heavy pieces only after a confirmed lockout/Counter Breaker and watch KV so the combo does not blow out before cashout.

TRAILBLAZER DRILL

From the same starting position practice: **horizontal approach, upward escape/anti-air angle, downward attack, first Trailblazer -> second Trailblazer cross-up, and empty movement into throw.** The opponent should not be able to know Cinder's final position from the first movement alone.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Trailblazer angles and second Trailblazer
2. Inferno and Fireflash
3. Basic Opener -> Double -> Linker -> Damage Ender
4. Punch vs Kick Burnout Enders
5. Pyrobomb attachment and manual detonation
6. One Manual after Light Linker
7. Pyrobomb -> Trailblazer layered pressure
8. Fired Up awareness and enhanced specials
9. Counter-Breaker lockout route
10. Instinct pressure, Shadow Counter and Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - RIPTOR

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Shoulder Charge - B,F + P

Advancing opener/linker; blocked version enters Predator Mode.

Talon Rake - B,F + K

Leaping opener/linker and movement tool.

Tail Flip - QCB + K (air OK)

Left-right attack and recapture tool.

Clever Girl - QCB + P

Anti-air/reversal family.

Primal Run - F,F

Forward run stance.

Survival Run - B,B

Backward run stance.

Predator Mode - 3K

Low-profile stance with six stance attacks.

Flame Carpet - DB + HP

Persistent ground flame for wakeup pressure.

Flame Breath - HP, HP, HP / hold HP

Flame attack and combo-trait linker.

Shadow Shoulder Charge - B,F + 2P

Enhanced advancing attack.

Shadow Tail Flip - QCB + 2K

Fast Shadow recapture.

Shadow Clever Girl - QCB + 2P

Invincible Shadow reversal.

Ultra - B,F + 3P

Ultra command in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - B,F + 3K

Only works on a supported Stage Ultra stage, at the required position/facing, during valid Ultra conditions.

RIPTOR - LINKERS, ENDERS, RECAPTURE & FLIPOUT

Riptor's combo trait gives her the easiest single-button Linkers in the game.

FIRE & TAIL LINKERS - COMBO TRAIT

Inside a combo, after an Auto-Double, press **HP** again for the 3-hit **Flame Breath heavy Linker**, or **HK** for the 3-hit **Tail Zip heavy Linker**. No motion input is required. They are beginner-friendly but always Heavy and visually obvious, so use them mainly during lockouts or when their specific property is valuable.

STANDARD LINKERS

Shoulder Charge: more damaging standard Linker; Shadow version works as a 5-hit Shadow Linker.

Talon Rake: pushes the opponent toward the corner more quickly; Shadow version also links.

Shadow Tail Flip: staggered Shadow Linker that launches then recaptures; depending on the opponent it may produce 4 or 5 hits, so learn its actual rhythm rather than assuming uniform timing.

ENDERS

Talon Rake - Damage Ender: strongest direct cashout, but often gives up Riptor's pressure.

Shoulder Charge - Wall Splat Ender: devastating in the corner because Predator/Tail Flip/throw mix follows.

Tail Flip - Hard Knockdown Ender: preferred mid-screen momentum choice; immediately lay Flame Carpet.

Clever Girl - Ground Bounce Ender: creates juggle/Flipout opportunities; Shadow version can also end.

RECAPTURE & FLIPOUT

Tail Flip / Shadow Tail Flip = Recapture. Regular Tail Flip is slow for intentional juggles, but catches jump escapes; Shadow Tail Flip's fast first hit makes it reliable after anti-air/ground bounce situations.

Standing LK = Flipout. After Clever Girl or other juggle states, standing LK puts the opponent on their feet immediately. Cancel it into Predator Stance, Tail Flip, throw, or simply stay in front for a fast reset.

SHADOW-LINKER BREAKING

Shadow Shoulder Charge hits very quickly after the freeze; be ready immediately. **Shadow Talon Rake** has a long delay before its first hit, so trying to break too early causes lockout - aim for later hits. Shadow Tail Flip has a staggered rhythm. During the freeze, Shoulder Charge curls Riptor's tail upward; Talon Rake leaves it extended behind her.

BREAKER SYSTEM

Combo Breaker: LP+LK / MP+MK / HP+HK to match strength.

Counter Breaker: MP+MK during Riptor's breakable combo. Her Heavy Fire/Tail Linkers are easy to identify, so a confirmed lockout is the best time to use them repeatedly.

RIPTOR - KNOCKDOWN PRESSURE, INSTINCT & FINISHERS

Riptor becomes frightening when every knockdown leads directly into another layered guess.

FLAME CARPET OKIZEME

After a throw or **Tail Flip Hard-Knockdown Ender**, lay Flame Carpet over the opponent. It stays active for roughly a second or more and is neither a high nor low. The opponent can jump, reversal or block, but Riptor usually has time to add a normal/special mix while the carpet forces frame disadvantage.

TAIL FLIP LEFT / RIGHT

Tail Flip is Riptor's primary cross-up/same-side reset. Different spacing and versions alter where she lands. Because every version is highly punishable on block, hide it behind Flame Carpet, Talon Rake bounce pressure, Flipout, Predator advantage or a strong read rather than using it naked repeatedly.

PREDATOR PRESSURE RULE

Use **LK** when you want to remain plus and keep pressure; use **MP/MK** for the real combo-starting low/overhead mix; use **HP/HK** when you want an extremely fast high/low guess but accept that your pressure may end or be punished. Crouching HP can cancel into and out of Predator Stance to disguise timing.

INSTINCT - AMPLIFIED FIRE & TAIL

Activate: HP+HK. Every normal using **HP (flame)** and **HK (cybernetic tail)** gains dramatically increased range; flame attacks also gain damage. Forward Run reaches maximum velocity immediately and gains its armor from the start. Standing HK, Predator MK, sweep and jumping HK become enormous space-control attacks.

INSTINCT APPROACH

Against zoning, use instant-max-speed Run into **Flame, Shoulder Charge or Talon Rake**. At mid-range, the extended tail lets Riptor threaten from distances where her normal offense would not reach. Instinct does not fundamentally improve Tail Flip itself; its power is in letting Riptor begin pressure from much farther away.

DEFENSE / SHADOW COUNTER

Shadow Clever Girl is Riptor's best fully invincible reversal, but its hitbox stays low enough that some cross-ups can avoid it. Normal Clever Girl is upper-body invulnerable, not a universal reversal.

Shadow Counter: MP+MK while blocking, costing one Shadow stock. Be equally aware that Riptor's own multi-hit approaches can be Shadow Countered when predictable.

ULTRA / FINISHERS

Use Riptor's **character-specific Ultra** during a combo while the opponent is in DANGER. Compatible arenas may also allow a Stage Ultra. Keep modern KI finishers separate from classic KI commands; only the finishers actually present in the final 2013 build belong in this section.

RIPTOR - ADVANCED ROUTES & PRACTICE

The advanced game is momentum: knockdown -> Flame Carpet -> stance/flip mix -> lockout -> damage.

0-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HP Double -> Light Talon Rake -> HP Double -> Light Talon Rake -> HP Double -> Talon Rake Damage Ender

Reference damage is about **39%** under the isolated Counter-Breaker test conditions. If keeping momentum matters more, replace the Damage Ender with Tail Flip and accept a small damage loss.

1-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HP Double -> Flame Breath Linker -> HP Double -> Flame Breath Linker -> Shadow Shoulder Charge -> Talon Rake Ender

Reference damage is about **57%**. Shadow Shoulder Charge is Riptor's major meter-based damage increase.

2-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HP Double -> Flame Breath Linker -> HP Double -> Shadow Shoulder Charge -> Shadow Shoulder Charge -> Talon Rake Ender

Reference damage is about **67%**. Use this only when spending both stocks will meaningfully close the life bar.

GROUND-BOUNCE RESET

Clever Girl Ground Bounce Ender -> standing LK Flipout -> 3K Predator -> MP low / MK overhead. Alternate with **standing LK -> Tail Flip** for left-right, or no cancel -> throw. This is one of Riptor's cleanest ways to turn a completed combo into another immediate defensive test.

CORNER WALL-SPLAT MIX

Shoulder Charge Wall Splat Ender -> jumping normal / Tail Flip / Predator high-low / throw -> Flame Carpet. In the corner, even the simple throw is strong because its knockdown lets Riptor re-establish safe Flame Carpet pressure.

HIT-AND-RUN DRILL

Rotate **Back Run HP projectile, Forward Run Flame, Run -> Shoulder Charge, Run -> Talon Rake, and empty Run stop/spacing.** The opponent should not be able to identify Riptor's final attack simply because she started running.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Forward/back Run and run attacks
2. Predator LP/LK/MP/MK/HP/HK purposes
3. Shoulder Charge, Talon Rake, Tail Flip, Clever Girl
4. Basic combo -> Talon Rake Damage Ender
5. Tail Flip Ender -> Flame Carpet
6. Fire Breath / Tail Zip single-button Linkers
7. Clever Girl -> standing LK Flipout reset
8. Shadow-linker recognition and break timing
9. Counter-Breaker 0/1/2-meter routes
10. Instinct extended flame/tail spacing and Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - TJ COMBO

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Spin Fist - B,F + LP

Fast advancing punch.

Shoot Toss - B,F + MP

Command throw-style Powerline follow-up.

Powerline - B,F + HP

Heavy rushing attack and major approach tool.

Backstep - B,F + LK

Powerline-family evasive movement.

Tumble - B,F + MK

Rolling movement/follow-up.

Flying Knee - B,F + HK

Advancing knee attack.

Vortex / Cyclone - D,U + P

Rising punch / anti-air family.

Tremor - D,U + K

Ground-smash special and combo tool.

Rollercoaster - DF + MP

Advancing command normal.

Superman Punch - DF + HP

Heavy advancing command normal.

Shadow Powerline - B,F + 2P

Enhanced rushing Shadow attack.

Shadow Tremor - D,U + 2K

Enhanced multi-hit Tremor.

Ultra - B,F + 3P

Ultra command in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - B,F + 3K

Only works on a supported Stage Ultra stage, at the required position/facing, during valid Ultra conditions.

TJ COMBO - AUTO BARRAGE, LINKERS & ENDERS

TJ's combo trait changes the rhythm of offense and makes his lockout routes unmistakably his own.

AUTO BARRAGE - COMBO TRAIT

Auto Barrage lets TJ chain a sequence of different attack buttons during a combo rather than using a normal two-hit Auto-Double. Each button produces its own barrage hit. The key rule is **do not simply mash one strength**: vary the sequence and learn the legal progression so you can disguise breaker timing and build toward the Barrage finisher.

BARRAGE PRACTICE

Start slowly with a short sequence such as **LP -> MP -> HP**, then add Kick buttons and different orders once the timing is stable. The defender can still break identifiable strengths, so Barrage is not automatically safe. During a lockout, however, it becomes an excellent way to add damage and style before cashing out.

LINKERS

Spin Fist Linker: straightforward grounded Linker and easy route to learn.

Tremor Linker: gives TJ another animation/strength family to disguise breaker reads.

Powerline Linker: movement-heavy extension/carry where applicable.

Shadow Spin Fist / Shadow Tremor: 5-hit Shadow Linkers for meter-based lockout damage.

ENDERS

Damage Ender: use TJ's designated high-damage cashout when the life bar matters.

Powerline / Wall Splat Ender: carries to the wall and keeps TJ in boxing range.

Tremor / Hard Knockdown Ender: favors continued pressure and meaty offense.

Launcher/advantage Ender: use when the follow-up position is worth more than immediate damage.

TJ is a momentum character, so the best Ender is often the one that leaves him close.

MANUALS

TJ's fast grounded normals make useful Manuals after light Linkers. Mix a Manual into ordinary Double/Linker routes so the opponent cannot assume every combo will become Auto Barrage. Barrage is the signature mechanic; Manuals are what stop that signature from becoming predictable.

BREAKERS

Combo Breaker: LP+LK / MP+MK / HP+HK to match strength.

Counter Breaker: MP+MK during TJ's breakable combo.

Shadow Linkers: break 3 of 5 hits in rhythm. Once the opponent locks out, switch immediately from tricky pressure to TJ's heaviest Barrage/Shadow damage route.

TJ COMBO - INSTINCT, LAST BREATH & FINISHERS

TJ's comeback mechanics make a nearly finished round dangerous until the final hit.

INSTINCT MODE

Activate: HP+HK. TJ's Instinct enhances his boxing pressure and gives him access to his signature comeback behavior. Use activation as a cancel to preserve pressure, confirm a hit, or make the opponent hesitate before challenging a Powerline/normal sequence.

LAST BREATH

Last Breath is TJ's unique resurrection mechanic. Under the proper Instinct/life-state conditions, losing the life bar does not necessarily end the match: TJ can rise again with a small amount of health and one final chance to fight. Treat it as a comeback resource, not permission to take reckless damage; preserving enough momentum to capitalize after the revival is the real value.

PRESSURE PLAN

At close range rotate **fast jab/medium pressure, throw, Tremor low, Spin Fist, delayed heavy and Powerline re-entry**. The opponent's attempt to escape the throw exposes them to strikes; blocking the strikes lets TJ walk back into throw range. The strongest TJ pressure looks simple because every option begins from the same boxing distance.

DEFENSE

TJ has a rising uppercut/reversal family, with the **Shadow version** as the reliable invincible defensive answer. His normal movement and buttons are also strong enough that he should not gamble on reversal every knockdown. Block, tech, challenge true gaps, then turn one defensive success into forward momentum.

SHADOW COUNTER

MP+MK while in blockstun, costing one Shadow stock. A successful Shadow Counter puts TJ exactly where he wants to be: close enough to begin boxing pressure. Conversely, long predictable Powerline/Spin Fist strings can invite the opponent's Shadow Counter, so vary where you stop.

ULTRA / ULTIMATE

Ultra: perform TJ's character-specific Ultra command during a combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Ultimate: TJ received a modern cinematic Ultimate. While still on his first life bar and under valid Ultra conditions, begin the Ultra and use the standard **LP+LK Ultimate transition** during its opening portion.

STAGE ULTRA

On compatible arenas and in the required position, a Stage Ultra can replace the standard match-ending Ultra. Stage availability matters; do not assume every arena supports one.

TJ COMBO - ADVANCED ROUTES & PRACTICE

Get in with Powerline, make the defender freeze, then convert the first lockout into heavyweight damage.

PRACTICAL MANUAL ROUTE

Powerline opener -> HP Auto-Double -> Light Spin Fist Linker -> MP Manual -> Medium Tremor Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> Damage Ender

Once MP Manual timing is reliable, alternate it with a short Auto Barrage so the defender must identify two very different combo rhythms.

AUTO BARRAGE LOCKOUT ROUTE

Confirmed lockout -> Heavy Barrage sequence -> Linker -> continued Barrage -> Damage Ender. The exact button sequence should be practiced until it is deliberate rather than mashed. Watch KV closely; Barrage can consume the available combo space quickly.

POWERLINE ENTRY DRILL

From charge range rotate: **Powerline -> committed follow-up, Powerline -> pressure stop, Powerline -> throw, and no Powerline -> walk forward normal.** If every approach begins with the same rush/follow-up, opponents can challenge it on recognition.

WALL PRESSURE

Combo -> Wall Splat Ender -> meaty normal / throw / Tremor low / delayed heavy. TJ's short-range boxing becomes much stronger when the opponent cannot retreat. Do not automatically jump after wall splat; grounded strike/throw pressure is often safer and harder to escape.

LAST BREATH PLAN

When Last Breath is available, think about the **position after revival**. If possible, enter the final exchange with the opponent near the wall and TJ holding meter. Revival with no screen position and no resources is far less threatening than revival into immediate Powerline/Shadow pressure.

COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

Counter Breaker -> HP Barrage/Heavy sequence -> damaging Linker -> Shadow Spin Fist -> Heavy sequence -> Damage Ender. Use the Counter Breaker window to choose the route before attacking; TJ's best lockout damage comes from controlled heavy/Barrage sequencing, not frantic inputs.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Powerline charge and follow-up choices
2. Tremor, Spin Fist and uppercut
3. Basic Opener -> Double -> Linker -> Ender
4. Auto Barrage button timing
5. One Manual after Light Linker
6. Powerline entry -> throw/strike mix
7. Wall Splat pressure
8. Auto Barrage during confirmed lockout
9. Instinct and Last Breath situations
10. Counter Breaker, Shadow Counter, Ultra and Ultimate

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - SADIRA

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Blade Demon - QCF + P

Grounded advancing opener/linker.

Recluse - QCB + K

Rising/spinning attack; combo and anti-air tool.

Widow's Bite - air QCF + P

Aerial projectile for approach and juggle control.

Web Cling - air QCB + P

Clings to wall to redirect/delay aerial approach.

Widow's Drop - air D + MK

Downward aerial attack.

Double Jump - air U/UF/UB

Changes jump trajectory and timing.

Fang - F + HK

Advancing command normal.

Web Trap - Instinct: HP+HK

Instinct web setplay tool.

Shadow Blade Demon - QCF + 2P

Enhanced advancing Shadow attack.

Shadow Recluse - QCB + 2K

Enhanced rising Shadow attack.

Shadow Widow's Bite - air QCF + 2P

Enhanced aerial projectile.

Ultra - QCF + 3P

Ultra command in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3K

Only works on a supported Stage Ultra stage, at the required position/facing, during valid Ultra conditions.

SADIRA - JUGGLES, LINKERS & ENDERS

Her defining skill is converting airborne hits into controlled pressure instead of letting the opponent fall away.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Sadira still uses the normal Light/Medium/Heavy Auto-Double system. Manuals are especially important because many of her aerial confirms already make the opponent unsure when the grounded combo truly began. Use fast Manuals after light Linkers, and save obvious Heavy sequences for confirmed lockouts.

LINKERS

Blade Demon Linker: primary grounded Linker at Light/Medium/Heavy strengths.

Recluse Linker: alternate animation/route with vertical movement characteristics.

Shadow Blade Demon: 5-hit Shadow Linker for damage/carry.

Shadow Recluse: meter extension that can transition naturally into Sadira's airborne game.

ENDERS

Recluse - Damage Enders: use when immediate life-bar damage matters.

Blade Demon - Wall Splat/position Enders: keeps Sadira close and enables corner pressure.

Launcher Enders: trades immediate damage for the airborne state Sadira prefers.

Knockdown/setup Enders: choose when establishing Web/air pressure is worth more than raw cashout.

Sadira often accepts slightly less damage to keep the opponent in a juggle or forced wakeup situation.

JUGGLE PRINCIPLE

Once the opponent is airborne, rotate among **jump normal, double-jump normal, Widow's Bite, Recluse and delayed landing pressure**. Do not add hits merely because they are possible. A shorter juggle that leaves Sadira at the correct side/height can create a stronger reset than a maximum-hit route.

RECAPTURE / FLIPOUT

Use Sadira's designated modern recapture/flipout tools where available in the final move set to return an airborne opponent to grounded pressure or force an immediate standing reset. The important distinction is strategic: **recapture continues a combo; flipout ends the juggle and starts a fresh mixup**.

BREAKERS

Combo Breaker: LP+LK / MP+MK / HP+HK to match strength.

Counter Breaker: MP+MK during Sadira's own breakable combo.

Shadow Linkers: break 3 of the 5 hits in rhythm. Her aerial pressure can disguise the moment a normal breakable combo begins, so learn the visual transition carefully.

SADIRA - WEB INSTINCT, AIR MIX & FINISHERS

Instinct turns the screen itself into part of Sadira's offense.

INSTINCT - WEB TRAPS

Activate: HP+HK. Sadira gains access to **Web traps** that remain on screen and constrain the opponent's movement. A trapped or web-covered opponent must defend Sadira while also respecting the delayed web interaction, allowing her to create unusually strong left-right, jump and throw pressure.

WEB SETPLAY

Place a Web after a knockdown or when the opponent is forced to block, then attack from a different vector: **jump-in, double-jump cross-up, empty jump low/throw, Widow's Drop, or remain grounded**. The Web's job is to cover the escape/punish attempt, not to replace Sadira's own offense.

AIR MIX RULE

Never show the same sequence twice if the opponent has demonstrated they can anti-air it. From one jump start, Sadira can **attack immediately, delay, double jump, alter direction, use Widow's Bite, dive, Web Cling, or land without attacking**. The uncertainty is the weapon.

DEFENSE

Sadira is strongest while moving and attacking; her grounded defense is less comfortable than her offense. Use the appropriate Shadow reversal/anti-air when meter is available, but do not rely on escape specials every knockdown. Blocking patiently for one gap is often safer than gambling away the position.

SHADOW COUNTER

MP+MK while in blockstun, costing one Shadow stock. A successful Shadow Counter gives Sadira the chance to immediately return the fight to the air. Conversely, long predictable Blade Demon/Recluse strings can be Shadow Countered, so vary where pressure stops.

ULTRA / ULTIMATE

Ultra: perform Sadira's character-specific Ultra command during a combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Use only the cinematic Ultimate/Stage Ultra options actually present for Sadira in the final modern KI build; do not import classic-character finishing commands into her section.

CORNER ADVANTAGE

The corner removes the opponent's ability to retreat from Sadira's jump arcs. After Wall Splat or knockdown, use **Web/air normal/empty jump throw** layers rather than automatically crossing through; staying same-side becomes much harder to read when the defender expects constant aerial movement.

SADIRA - ADVANCED ROUTES & PRACTICE

The goal is controlled unpredictability: every air option should answer a specific defensive habit.

PRACTICAL MANUAL ROUTE

Medium Blade Demon -> HP Auto-Double -> Light Blade Demon Linker -> MP Manual -> Medium Recluse Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> Recluse Damage Ender

Once reliable, replace the final cashout with a launcher/setup Ender when continued aerial pressure is more valuable.

AIR-CONFIRM DRILL

Jump normal / Widow's Bite hit -> land -> Manual/normal confirm -> Blade Demon -> combo. Practice confirming the hit visually instead of committing before landing. If the aerial attack is blocked, continue safe pressure or disengage rather than forcing an unsafe combo attempt.

DOUBLE-JUMP MIX

From the same jump timing rotate: **immediate attack, double jump forward -> late attack, double jump back -> Widow's Bite, empty land -> throw, and Web Cling -> delayed return.** The defender should have to identify Sadira's second movement before choosing an anti-air.

LOCKOUT DAMAGE ROUTE

HP Auto-Double -> Heavy Blade Demon Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> Shadow Blade Demon -> HP Auto-Double -> Recluse Damage Ender. Use Heavy pieces only after confirmed lockout/Counter Breaker and cash out before KV blowout.

WEB RESET

Knockdown/advantage -> Web -> jump over or remain same-side -> normal/throw -> confirm. Alternate the side without changing the initial Web setup. If the opponent uses an invincible reversal, next time Web and block; the trap can help preserve pressure after the reversal attempt.

ANTI-AIR BAIT

Jump into the edge of anti-air range, then **double jump or Web Cling** to make the expected anti-air miss. Descend with a late normal or Widow's Drop only after seeing the whiff. Sadira's mobility is strongest when it creates a punish, not when it simply adds movement.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Jump arcs and double jump
2. Blade Demon, Recluse, Widow's Bite/Drop
3. Basic grounded combo
4. Air hit -> grounded confirm
5. Web Cling timing and return options
6. Launcher/juggle routes
7. One Manual after Light Linker
8. Web Instinct knockdown setup
9. Counter-Breaker lockout route
10. Shadow Counter, Ultra and finishers

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - MAYA

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Tumble Kick - QCF + K

Forward-moving opener/linker.

Leap Kick - QCB + K

Rising kick; after non-blocked hit press P to throw dagger.

Temperance Strike - QCF + LP (air OK)

Throws yellow dagger.

Vengeance Strike - QCF + MP (air OK)

Throws purple dagger.

Enmity Strike - QCF + HP with both daggers

Throws both daggers; pip upgrades modify it.

Air Mantis - air D + HP with both daggers

Aerial command grab.

Axe Kick - F + HK (hold to fake)

Overhead/recapture; hold to fake.

Dagger Pickup - 3P over grounded dagger

Manual dagger retrieval.

Shadow Spirit Slicer - QCF + 2P

Throws both daggers as multi-hit spinner.

Shadow Tumble Kick - QCF + 2K

Enhanced advancing Shadow kick.

Shadow Leap Kick - QCB + 2K

Invincible Shadow reversal.

Ultra - QCF + 3K

Ultra command in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3P

Only works on a supported Stage Ultra stage, at the required position/facing, during valid Ultra conditions.

MAYA - DAGGER LINKERS, ENDERS & JUGGLES

Maya can literally move toward a lost resource while continuing her combo.

STANDARD LINKERS

Tumble Kick: moves Maya forward during the combo.

Leap Kick Linker: changes into a backwards-moving Tumble Kick animation. Use the two directions to steer Maya toward missing daggers while the opponent remains trapped in the combo.

Shadow Tumble / Shadow Leap: staggered 5-hit Shadow Linkers; wait for visible movement after the freeze rather than breaking immediately.

DAGGER LINKERS - COMBO TRAIT

At very close range Maya can throw a dagger **inside the combo**. This is the game's unusual breakable-projectile Linker. On hit she receives enough advantage for **any-strength Manual** afterward. The yellow dagger Linker is always broken as **Light**; the purple dagger Linker is always broken as **Medium**. Read the color, not the animation speed.

ENDERS

Tumble Kick - Damage + Hard Knockdown: Maya's strongest ordinary cashout and a good setup for Shadow Spirit Slicer.

Leap Kick - Exchange Launcher: launches for an extended juggle; follow with normals/daggers and finish with Air Mantis or Shadow Leap Kick.

Spirit Strike - Dagger Assault Activation: spends all dagger pips and suspends both daggers above the opponent. They strike once per cycle while Maya moves freely; more stored pips create more attack cycles, up to five.

DAGGER ASSAULT MIX

Dagger Assault does little immediate damage; its value is the repeated delayed threat. While the daggers hover, use **roll/dash-jump cross-up, Axe Kick overhead/fake-low, throw, crouching MK, or simply block and punish an escape**. If Maya is hit, Dagger Assault ends and the daggers separate.

RECAPTURE / JUGGLE

Axe Kick = Recapture. After Leap Kick, Enmity Strike launch or another juggle, use Axe Kick to return the opponent to a grounded combo when you do not want to spend Shadow Meter. Alternatively keep them airborne with Tumble Kick/daggers and cash out with Shadow Leap Kick.

NORMALS TO KNOW

c.MK: long low that easily confirms or leads into blocked dagger pressure.

c.HP: excellent anti-air while both daggers are held.

j.HP: enormous dash-jump cross-up.

far s.HP: two-hit heavy blockstun tool; canceled into Shadow Spirit Slicer it can force substantial dagger-pip gain. Losing either dagger removes several of these HP-dependent options.

MAYA - INSTINCT, SPIRIT SLICER & FINISHERS

Instinct solves Maya's greatest weakness: losing control of her daggers.

INSTINCT - RETURNING DAGGERS

Activate: HP+HK. Both daggers immediately return to Maya's hands no matter where they are. For the rest of Instinct, every thrown dagger automatically returns after it comes to rest. Maya can therefore throw far more aggressively without surrendering her core normals or having to fight across the screen to retrieve a miss.

SHADOW SPIRIT SLICER

Shadow Spirit Slicer throws both daggers together as a large multi-hit spinner. If the opponent blocks the full sequence, Maya can rapidly fill her dagger gauge. Normally the daggers separate afterward, which creates a retrieval problem; Instinct removes that drawback by bringing them straight back.

FULL-PIP INSTINCT SETUP

Force block on Shadow Spirit Slicer -> reach full dagger pips -> activate Instinct -> daggers return -> release powered Enmity Strike. At 2 yellow + 2 purple pips, the dual projectile tracks, bounces, defeats projectiles and is unblockable. The defender's best damage-control options are often to take it airborne or prepare to break the follow-up combo.

FULL-SCREEN CONFIRM

A dagger hit has unusually long hitstun. From range, Maya can **dash forward, throw another returning dagger, then dash-jump in** to convert. In Instinct this becomes especially oppressive because the daggers keep returning, allowing substantial projectile damage before the grounded combo even starts.

DEFENSE

Shadow Leap Kick is Maya's fully invincible reversal. Light Leap Kick has partial invulnerability but can be beaten by a properly timed meaty. If Leap Kick is blocked, Maya cannot throw a dagger afterward, so the defender gets a much cleaner punish than on a whiff/hit trajectory.

SHADOW COUNTER

MP+MK while in blockstun, costing one Shadow stock. Maya also needs to watch for the opponent Shadow Countering the second hit of far standing HP or predictable multi-hit dagger pressure. Preserve meter for Shadow Leap Kick when defense is more urgent than offense.

ULTRA / FINISHERS

Ultra: perform Maya's character-specific Ultra command during a combo while the opponent is in DANGER. Use compatible Stage Ultra / modern cinematic finisher options only where they actually exist in the final KI build; keep KI2/Gold finishing commands in Maya's separate classic section.

MAYA - ADVANCED ROUTES & PRACTICE

The resource question is always the same: spend dagger levels now, or keep them to threaten something worse?

0-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HK Double -> Medium Tumble Kick -> HK Double -> Light Tumble Kick -> HK Double -> Tumble Kick End

Reference damage: about **38%** in isolated Counter-Breaker testing after a Heavy Tumble Kick opener.

1-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HK Double -> Medium Tumble Kick -> HK Double -> Light Tumble Kick -> Shadow Tumble Kick -> Tumble Kick End

Reference damage: about **51%**. Maya gains a meaningful jump from spending the first Shadow stock.

2-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HK Double -> Shadow Tumble Kick -> Shadow Tumble Kick -> Tumble Kick End

Reference damage: about **55%**. The second bar adds less than the first, so meter economy may favor saving it unless the extra damage closes the life bar.

DAGGER RETRIEVAL COMBO

If a dagger is behind Maya during a combo, select **Leap Kick Linker** to move backward toward it; if it is ahead, use **Tumble Kick Linker**. Passing over the dagger retrieves it automatically. Practice this until screen position, not habit, determines your Linker.

LEAP-KICK JUGGLE

Leap Kick hit -> dagger at apex -> land -> juggle normal/dagger -> Axe Kick Recapture. If meter is available, skip the recapture and continue the juggle into **Shadow Leap Kick** for cashout. In Instinct, returning daggers make the extended version much easier to sustain.

RESOURCE DECISION

With several pips, choose between two rewards: **powered dual dagger** for a nearly guaranteed projectile hit, or **Dagger Assault** for repeated delayed mixups. If you already have the opponent cornered, Dagger Assault can be devastating; if you need a clean opening from range, the powered Enmity Strike is often simpler.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Temperance / Vengeance / Enmity throws
2. Dagger pickup by dash, PPP and Tumble Kick
3. Tumble Kick and Leap Kick Linkers
4. Dagger pip effects at 1/2 yellow and purple
5. Dagger hit -> Manual confirm
6. Axe Kick Recapture and fake
7. Leap Kick juggle -> dagger -> Recapture
8. Dagger Linker color-break rules
9. Dagger Assault and full-pip Instinct setup
10. 0/1/2-meter Counter-Breaker routes, Shadow Counter and Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - KAN-RA

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Spike - QCF + K

Creates Sand Trap under opponent / launches by strength.

Whirl - QCF + P

Advancing opener/linker and recapture.

Swarm - QCB + K (air OK)

Persistent insect trap/projectile.

Clutch - QCB + P

Long-range command grab.

Sand Punt - HK

Creates/uses sand positioning attack.

Sand Geyser - D + HP

Sand-producing ground attack.

Dune - air HK

Diving attack that creates sand on landing.

Sacrifice - 3K with Sand Trap

Invincible escape/reversal that consumes sand and hurts Kan-Ra.

Sting - DF + MK with Sand Trap

Scorpion-tail trap attack.

Antlion - DF + HK with Sand Trap

Trap attack that recaptures and teleports Kan-Ra close.

Shadow Spike - QCF + 2K

Creates Super Sand Trap.

Shadow Whirl - QCF + 2P

Fast Shadow recapture/linker.

Shadow Clutch - QCB + 2P

High-damage Shadow command grab.

Ultra - QCF + 3K

Ultra command in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3P

Only works on a supported Stage Ultra stage, at the required position/facing, during valid Ultra conditions.

KAN-RA - OPENERS, LINKERS, ENDERS & COMBO TRAIT

His combo system is conventional only after one of his strange starters finally gets the opponent grounded.

OPENERS

Whirl (Shadow OK), **close-range Swarm**, **Dune** sand explosion and **Antlion** all start normal combos. Antlion is especially important: if the opponent is airborne over a Sand Trap, it Recaptures them and teleports Kan-Ra close enough for Doubles/Linkers.

OTHER COMBO STARTERS

Clutch: launches into a juggle. With nearby sand, Antlion converts it meterlessly; without sand, Light Spike -> Shadow Whirl can Recapture at the cost of meter.

Ranged Swarm: on hit, link a Manual.

s.HK and **b.HP**: Stagger normals; the long hitstun lets Kan-Ra confirm into a chosen starter. s.HK also creates sand.

COMBO TRAIT - TELEPORT LINKERS

Kan-Ra's long-range **Wrap normals** - **s.MP**, **s.HP** and **b+MP** - can cancel directly into the **Linker version of Spike**. This is not technically an Opener, but it lets a distant poke become a real combo. Any Spike Linker strength is available, and the resulting sand cloud obscures the following Double/Manual.

LINKERS

Whirl: 2 / 4 / 6 hits for Light / Medium / Heavy.

Spike: 2 / 3 / 4 hits and teleports Kan-Ra close.

Swarm: Kan-Ra's highest-damage Linker and fast enough for lockout loops.

Shadow Swarm: first hit arrives unusually quickly after its short freeze.

Shadow Whirl: 10 hits; because there are no real gaps after hit 1, it is comparatively easy to rhythm-break by striking any 3 hits.

ENDERS

Swarm - Battery/Setup: summons a free Shadow Swarm above the opponent and still lets Kan-Ra meaty their wakeup; generally his best strategic Ender.

Clutch - Damage: Shadow Clutch gives a major damage increase.

Spike - Launcher: launches straight up and leaves a Sand Trap underneath for Antlion routes.

Whirl - Wall Splat: corner pressure; a throw after a round-ending wall splat can leave the opponent cursed entering the next round.

RECAPTURE & FLIPOUT

Antlion = Recapture. **Whirl / Shadow Whirl** = Recapture.

c.LP, **j.LP** and **Light Clutch** = Flipout. Use Flipout when an airborne Swarm catches the opponent but no Sand Trap is available for Antlion, or when a fresh standing mix is worth more than continuing the juggle.

KAN-RA - CURSES, INSTINCT & TRAP PRESSURE

A good Kan-Ra setup makes every escape route run into a different object.

CURSE SYSTEM

Kan-Ra's regular throws curse the opponent for about **8 seconds**. Sand-Trap scorpion-tail attacks curse for roughly **4 seconds**. Curse increases the startup/recovery of the victim's moves and makes their jumps higher and slower. A new curse resets the timer; the effects do not stack. Slower jumps make Swarm, Wrap normals and Clutch layers substantially harder to escape.

SCORPION / ANTLION CHOICES

With active sand, Kan-Ra can call scorpion tails at different angles to harass and curse, or use **Antlion** when he expects an airborne opponent over the trap. Scorpion attacks preserve the trap; Antlion spends it to Recapture. That makes the decision strategic: maintain zoning pressure or consume the resource to guarantee a combo.

SHADOW SPIKE SETPLAY

Shadow Spike is one of Kan-Ra's best meter spends. The Super Sand Trap repeatedly attacks an opponent standing near it, creating blockstun while Kan-Ra places Swarms or threatens Wrap normal/Clutch. **Do not casually create a regular trap while it is active**, because that deletes the Super Trap. If Kan-Ra is hit, it remains only as a normal Sand Trap.

INSTINCT - PERMANENT SAND

Activate: HP+HK. Kan-Ra behaves as if a Sand Trap is permanently beneath him, so he always has his **high jump, super dash, Sacrifice reversal and trap-powered Whirl tornado** without consuming a visible trap. He can still create a separate distant trap and use its attacks. Instinct also lets him **dash-cancel grounded normals** and summon insects directly beneath himself.

INSTINCT OFFENSE

Instinct transforms Kan-Ra from calculated zoner into extreme mobility pressure. Use **normal -> dash cancel, super dash -> confusing j.HP cross-up, j.MP pressure, or instant high jump** while a distant trap/Swarm controls the floor. Because Sacrifice is always available, opponents also have to respect a reversal even after they finally reach him.

DEFENSE

Without sand, Kan-Ra's defense is among the weakest in KI. **Sacrifice** is invincible but costs a trap and hurts Kan-Ra; **Shadow Whirl** can avoid throws but is not a universal answer. The defensive priority is therefore proactive: create sand before the opponent reaches you rather than hoping to manufacture it while blocking.

ULTRA / FINISHERS

Ultra: Kan-Ra's Ultra is performed with his character-specific motion + **3 Kicks** during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER. Use Stage Ultra / cinematic finisher options only where they exist in the final modern build.

KAN-RA - ADVANCED ROUTES & PRACTICE

Trap first, Swarm second, then force the opponent to choose which bad answer they prefer.

0-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HP Double -> Light Swarm -> HP Double -> Light Swarm -> HP Double -> Clutch Ender

Reference damage: about **46%** after the isolated close Medium Swarm opener / Counter-Breaker test.

1-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HP Double -> Light Swarm -> HP Double -> Light Swarm -> HP Double -> Shadow Clutch Ender

Reference damage: about **57%**. Shadow Clutch is the meter spend that pushes Kan-Ra's damage into above-average territory.

2-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HP Double -> Medium Swarm -> HP Double -> Light Swarm -> Shadow Whirl -> Shadow Clutch Ender

Reference damage: about **66%**. The final Shadow Whirl portion extends late enough that it does not offer a practical break before the Shadow Clutch cashout.

CLUTCH -> TRAP CONVERSION

Clutch -> steer Kan-Ra so the bounce is over Sand Trap -> Antlion Recapture -> grounded combo. If no trap is available: **Clutch -> Light Spike juggle -> Shadow Whirl Recapture.** This second route costs meter and is breakable, which is why pre-positioned sand makes Clutch much more frightening.

SWARM ENDER SETUP

Combo -> Swarm Ender -> free tracking Shadow Swarm -> meaty normal / Clutch / jump pressure. If a Sand Trap is also positioned nearby, the opponent must respect Swarm from above, Antlion/curse attacks from below, and Kan-Ra's own ranged grab/Wrap normals. This is the ideal layered state.

SPIKE LAUNCHER LOOP

Spike Launcher Ender -> Sand Trap created under airborne opponent -> route them into Swarm -> Antlion Recapture. The trap created by the Ender supplies the resource for the Recapture, allowing Kan-Ra to turn setup positioning into an extended sequence.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Create Sand Trap with Spike / c.HK / s.HK / Dune
2. Trap super jump and super dash
3. Swarm placement and ranged Manual confirm
4. Clutch steering
5. Clutch -> Antlion Recapture
6. Wrap normal -> Spike Linker combo trait
7. Swarm / Clutch / Spike / Whirl Ender purposes
8. Curse tails vs Antlion resource choice
9. Shadow Spike Super Trap and Instinct permanent-sand movement
10. 0/1/2-meter Counter-Breaker routes, Shadow Counter and Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - OMEN

MOVE COMMANDS - commands are printed directly with the move descriptions. QCF=D,DF,F; QCB=D,DB,B; 2P/2K=any two; 3P/3K=all three.

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Rashakuken - QCF + P

Throws 1/2/3 randomly behaving projectiles by strength.

Orda Shield - QCB + P

Close orb shield / pressure special.

Furious Flurry - QCF + K

Safe multi-hit opener/linker.

Demon Slide - QCB + K

Low advancing opener/linker.

Demon Glide - air F,F

Forward air dash; can chain multiple air dashes.

Demon Retreat - air B,B

Backward air dash.

Shadow Rashakuken - QCF + 2P

Persistent projectile orbs behind Omen.

Shadow Orda Shield - QCB + 2P

Persistent orbiting projectile shield.

Shadow Furious Flurry - QCF + 2K

Enhanced Shadow linker/damage tool.

Shadow Demon Slide - QCB + 2K

Projectile-invulnerable advancing Shadow attack.

Shadow Form - 3K (air OK; steer)

Invincible steerable command dash; costs one Shadow stock.

Demonic Despair - QCF + LP+LK (all 3 Shadow stocks)

Command grab that inflicts 100% potential damage.

Ultra - QCF + 3P

Ultra command in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3K

Only works on a supported Stage Ultra stage, at the required position/facing, during valid Ultra conditions.

OMEN - DEMON LOOP, LINKERS & ENDERS

His combo trait exists because his normal Linkers are long; Omen builds damage by looping Doubles instead.

DEMON LOOP - COMBO TRAIT

After the proper Demon Slide sequence, Omen can chain Auto-Doubles of different strengths in a **Demon Loop**, bypassing the usual Double -> Linker -> Double rhythm. This is crucial during Counter-Breaker lockouts: his standard Linkers take too long and Furious Flurry adds substantial KV, while Demon Loop rapidly builds level 4 Ender strength.

LINKERS

Demon Slide: standard Linker that repeatedly switches sides.

Furious Flurry: Light / Medium / Heavy hit **5 / 7 / 9 times**. Medium and Heavy are lengthy and visually distinguishable, making them easier to break.

Shadow Furious Flurry: Omen's preferred Shadow Linker for damage; the first three hits are straightforward, with a gap before hits 4-5.

Shadow Demon Slide: slower break rhythm after an unusually long Shadow freeze; breaking hits 3-5 is often easier.

ALL ENDERS BUILD METER

Rashakuken - Double Battery: builds twice the meter of Omen's other Enders; level 4 can build almost two stocks, but damage is low and it sends the opponent away.

Demon Slide - Exchange Launcher + Damage + Battery: changes sides while cashing out.

Furious Flurry - Carry + Damage + Battery: tied for Omen's highest Ender damage and carries toward the corner without wall splat.

Orda Shield - Launcher + Battery: keeps the opponent close for projectile/air-dash wakeup setups.

RECAPTURE / FLIPOUT

Omen has **no notable dedicated Recapture game** and is not primarily a juggle character.

Standing LK = Flipout.

Jumping LP = Flipout.

Use standing LK when an opponent jumps away from corner Rashakukens, or after an Orda Shield Launcher Ender when an immediate standing reset is more useful than continuing the juggle.

THROW PRESSURE

In the corner, throw leaves the opponent standing and adds white life. Mix **c.LP, throw, c.MK low, F+HP pressure and Rashakuken cancels**; repeated throw/tick-throw interactions raise Ender level and white damage. Once the defender finally challenges, convert a hit into a short one-chance-break combo and cash out.

BREAKERS

Combo Breaker: LP+LK / MP+MK / HP+HK to match strength.

Counter Breaker: MP+MK during Omen's breakable combo. Omen's Demon Loop deliberately changes strength frequently, so the defender must identify each Double rather than settling into a Linker rhythm.

OMEN - SHADOW ENGINE, INSTINCT & DEMONIC DESPAIR

Three Shadow stocks let Omen spend meter as utility instead of treating it only as combo damage.

SHADOW ORDA / SHADOW RASHAKUKEN

Shadow Rashakuken: creates three persistent orbs behind Omen that fire one by one.

Shadow Orda Shield: creates three persistent orbiting orbs. The orbs survive even if Omen is hit and do not naturally combo into each other, but they force blocking and can be converted into a Manual. Spending additional Shadow stocks can **upgrade/transform** the active orbs; mixing Shadow Orda and Shadow Rasha changes their behavior.

SHADOW FORM - 3K

Shadow Form is an **invincible, steerable command dash** costing one stock. On offense, cancel unsafe Demon Slide or pressure into a surprise side switch, use it during aerial offense, or extend a combo after a Heavy Double into freestyle Manuals. On defense, use it as an avoidance reversal or to dodge an anti-air. It does not attack by itself - its reward is position and ambiguity.

INSTINCT

Activate: HP+HK. Omen receives **+2 frame advantage on all attacks**, hit or blocked. Each Rashakuken strength also fires **one extra projectile**. Shadow Rashakuken/Orda Shield can summon or refresh up to **five projectiles**. Every projectile hit **locks one opponent Shadow stock for 10 seconds**, suppressing Shadow Counters, reversals and projectile-invincible answers.

INSTINCT ORB PRESSURE

Knock down/launch with Orda Shield, summon Shadow Orda or Shadow Rasha, then Instinct-cancel and upgrade the setup. Five tightly spaced orbs create long blockstun while Omen uses **air-dash cross-up/fake cross-up, c.MK, throw, F+HP pressure or Shadow Form**. The opponent must defend while their Shadow resources are progressively locked.

DEMONIC DESPAIR - 3 STOCKS

Demonic Despair spends all three Shadow stocks on a short-range command grab that inflicts **100% potential damage** and launches the opponent full screen. It is invincible until the throw begins, but has visible startup and can be jumped. After it lands, Omen must catch the opponent before the white life heals and win a one-chance-break combo to cash out the round. Saving three stocks also means giving up Shadow Form/Orb utility, so use it as a calculated gamble.

DEFENSE

LP Orda Shield has invincibility but an inconsistent hitbox. **Shadow Form** is Omen's far more flexible meter-based defensive escape. Because Omen holds three stocks and all Enders rebuild meter, he can afford Shadow Counter/Shadow Form more freely than most of the cast - but Demonic Despair requires intentionally hoarding the full gauge.

ULTRA / FINISHERS

Perform Omen's character-specific **Ultra** during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER. Keep modern Omen finishers separate from Shadow Jago/Jago commands; use only Stage Ultra or cinematic options actually available to Omen in the final build.

OMEN - ADVANCED ROUTES & PRACTICE

Control the screen, recognize the projectile pattern, then spend meter to make the next approach unfair.

0-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

MP Double -> HP Double -> LP Double -> MP Double -> HP Double -> Furious Flurry Ender

Reference damage: about **40%** after a Heavy Demon Slide opener and Counter Breaker. Demon Loop is essential because Omen's normal Linkers waste too much of the lockout window.

1-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HP Double -> LP Double -> MP Double -> HP Double -> Shadow Furious Flurry -> Furious Flurry Ender

Reference damage: about **47%**. Shadow Furious Flurry is Omen's most efficient meter spend when the only goal is combo damage.

2-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

HP Double -> Shadow Furious Flurry -> MP Double -> HP Double -> Shadow Furious Flurry -> Furious Flurry Ender

Reference damage: about **54%**.

3-METER COUNTER-BREAKER ROUTE

MP Double -> HP Double -> Shadow Furious Flurry -> Shadow Furious Flurry -> Shadow Furious Flurry -> Furious Flurry Ender

Reference damage: about **61%**. This proves Omen can spend all three stocks for damage, but in real matches Shadow Form/orb pressure or Demonic Despair may be worth more.

RASHAKUKEN APPROACH DRILL

Throw HP Rashakuken and immediately identify the pattern. If you see **Wiggler/Wave/Looper/Crawler**, practice advancing behind the shield with Demon Slide. If you see **Bullet/Accelerator/Anti-Air/Decelerator**, hold ground and use the projectile as space control. The skill is adapting to the roll, not memorizing one fireball script.

ORDA SETPLAY

Orda Shield Launcher Ender -> Shadow Orda/Rasha -> air dash. Rotate cross-up, jump past -> air backdash fake cross-up, empty land -> throw, or Shadow Form side switch. If the opponent starts swinging through the mix, let the persistent orb hit first and convert with a Manual.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Recognize all 11 Rashakuken behaviors
2. Forward/back air dash and dash-cancel movement
3. Demon Slide and Furious Flurry Openers
4. Demon Loop strength sequence
5. Rashakuken hit -> Manual
6. All four Battery Ender purposes
7. Shadow Form offense/defense
8. Shadow Orda/Rasha upgrades and Orda Launcher setup
9. Instinct 5-orb pressure and Shadow-stock lockout
10. 0/1/2/3-meter Counter-Breaker routes and Demonic Despair

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - AGANOS

Armor / Chunks / Walls / Peacemaker / wall-crash damage / enormous space control

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Payload Assault - QCF + P (requires a Chunk)

Fires a piece of Aganos's body as a projectile. Strength changes its trajectory/pattern. On hit it gives enough advantage for a Manual. As an Ender it restores Chunks.

Pulverize - QCB + P

Three-hit spinning lariat. Button strength changes range. Standard Opener/Linker; Shadow Pulverize is throw-invulnerable.

Natural Disaster - QCF + K; press U during the roll to bounce

Rolling attack and Opener/Linker. The bounce becomes an overhead and can cross up. Shadow Natural Disaster is projectile-invulnerable while held and Recaptures on hit 5.

Ruin - QCB + K

Huge lunging punch that sends the opponent backward. If a wall is behind them, Ruin smashes them through it for massive extra damage.

No Escape - 3P (requires a Chunk)

Creates a wall behind the opponent.

Trapped - B + 3P (requires a Chunk)

Creates a wall behind Aganos. Wall placement is central to both corner control and Ruin cashouts.

Fortify Chunk - B + HP

Adds one Chunk when Aganos has time to complete the animation.

War Path - F + HK; press HK repeatedly

Advancing heavy stomp sequence.

Flick - B+LP / D+LP / air LP

Swats away many incoming projectiles.

Shadow Payload Assault - QCF + 2P

Enhanced projectile attack.

Shadow Pulverize - QCB + 2P

Throw-invulnerable Shadow Opener/Linker.

Shadow Natural Disaster - QCF + 2K

Projectile-invulnerable hold; Recaptures on hit 5.

Shadow Ruin - QCB + 2K

Fast wall-crash cashout with strike invulnerability during startup.

Ultra - QCF + 3K

Perform during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3P

On a supported Stage Ultra arena, perform under valid Ultra conditions in the stage's target area. On Aganos's Forgotten Grotto, the target is the marked central area.

AGANOS - CHUNKS, ARMOR, WALLS & PEACEMAKER

Chunks are not merely ammunition - they change how the opponent is allowed to attack Aganos.

CHUNK ARMOR

Aganos can hold up to **four Chunks**. Each Chunk gives one hit of armor to many grounded actions, so a four-Chunk Aganos can absorb several ordinary strikes while continuing his attack. The tradeoff is speed: additional Chunks make many of his attacks slower. Armor does not make him invincible; throws and sufficiently multi-hit pressure remain major answers.

GETTING CHUNKS

Fortify Chunk - B+HP manually adds one if there is time. More importantly, the **Payload Assault Ender - QCF+P as Ender** restores Chunks while keeping the opponent close enough for continued pressure. This is usually Aganos's strategic Ender even when another Ender would deal more immediate damage.

WALLS

No Escape - 3P spends a Chunk to place a wall behind the opponent. **Trapped - B+3P** spends one to place it behind Aganos. Walls restrict retreat and become stored damage: **Ruin / Shadow Ruin**, throws and Peacemaker Domination can smash the opponent through them. Multiple walls can turn one confirmed Ruin into enormous damage.

PEACEMAKER

Peacemaker - B + 3P with a wall behind Aganos

Aganos tears the wall down and carries it as a club. During Instinct, a Peacemaker can also be generated after the required wait. The weapon dramatically changes his normals and gives him long-reaching special follow-ups.

PEACEMAKER COMMANDS

Paralyze - LP, MP, HP: three-hit weapon sequence.

Dislocate - LP: light weapon strike.

Fracture - MP: medium weapon strike.

Cripple - HP: heavy weapon strike.

Entrench - D+HP: low weapon attack.

Subdue - air P: aerial weapon attack; jumping HP with Peacemaker Recaptures.

Relinquish - QCF+P: throws the Peacemaker; causes Stagger and can lead to Shadow Natural Disaster.

Domination - LP+LK: Peacemaker throw; walls add extra damage.

OPENERS / OTHER STARTERS

Pulverize - QCB+P and **Natural Disaster - QCF+K** are standard Openers. **Payload Assault - QCF+P** starts a combo with a Manual on hit. **Relinquish - QCF+P while holding Peacemaker** causes Stagger. Standing HK and jumping HK can wall-splat opponents against an Aganos wall.

AGANOS - LINKERS, ENDERS, RECAPTURE & COMBOS

His combo system is simple; the real decision is what resource state you want after the combo ends.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Aganos uses the standard KI Light / Medium / Heavy Auto-Double strength system. Because his animations are large and deliberate, predictable Heavy Doubles are vulnerable to reaction breaks. After a Payload Assault projectile connects, use its long hitstun to practice **LP, MP or HP Manuals** before returning to a Linker.

LINKERS

Pulverize Linker - QCB + LP/MP

Natural Disaster Linker - QCF + LK/MK

Shadow Pulverize - QCB + 2P

Shadow Natural Disaster - QCF + 2K

Pulverize and Natural Disaster are Aganos's primary Linkers. Vary strength and use Manuals to avoid an obvious breaker rhythm.

ENDERS

Payload Assault - QCF + P: Battery/resource Ender; restores Chunks and is usually the default strategic choice.

Pulverize - QCB + HP: Hard Knockdown; keeps the opponent close and gives time for wall/chunk pressure.

Natural Disaster - QCF + HK: Exchange Launcher.

Ruin - QCB + K: Carry/Wall Crash; use when walls are ready or the damage will close the round.

Shadow Ruin - QCB + 2K: Shadow wall-crash Ender/cashout.

RECAPTURE / JUGGLE

Shadow Natural Disaster - QCF+2K = Recapture on hit 5. Hold the startup to evade projectiles/high attacks, then release under an airborne opponent.

Jumping HP with Peacemaker = Recapture. This is a powerful half-screen air-to-air threat: clip the opponent, bring them down standing, then start the grounded combo.

PRACTICAL COMBO

Pulverize Opener -> MP Auto-Double -> Light Natural Disaster Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> Payload Assault Ender

The purpose is not maximum damage: it earns Chunks and leaves Aganos in position to begin armored wall pressure.

WALL CASHOUT ROUTE

Confirm -> build Ender level -> Ruin Ender - QCB+K. If the opponent is backed by one or more Aganos walls, every wall crash adds a large damage burst. Do not spend all your Chunks building walls unless the expected Ruin payoff justifies giving up armor.

ANTI-AIR CONVERSION

Held Shadow Natural Disaster - QCF+2K -> release under jump -> hit 5 Recapture -> Auto-Double -> Linker -> Payload Assault Ender. This turns one Shadow stock into both an anti-air conversion and a way to rebuild the Chunk resource afterward.

AGANOS - INSTINCT, PRESSURE & PRACTICE

Aganos is strongest when the opponent must choose between attacking armor, surrendering space, or risking a wall crash.

INSTINCT - PEACEMAKER ENGINE

Activate - HP+HK. During Instinct, Aganos can repeatedly obtain Peacemakers after the respawn interval rather than needing to consume a prebuilt wall every time. This gives him repeated access to the club's enormous normals, Recapture and thrown Stagger while preserving his wall network for Ruin damage.

ARMORED PRESSURE

With Chunks loaded, use the threat of armor to make slow attacks viable: **far HP Stagger, War Path - F+HK, Pulverize - QCB+P, throw, wall placement.** The opponent may try to break armor with fast multi-hit attacks or simply throw. Shadow Pulverize's throw invulnerability is the important callout when you expect the latter.

WALL PRESSURE

After **Payload Assault Ender** or **Pulverize Hard Knockdown**, place a wall if spacing permits. Once the opponent is trapped near it, jumping HK and standing HK become wall-splat threats, throw becomes more dangerous, and any clean Ruin turns the wall itself into damage. The wall also denies retreat, which makes Aganos's slow normals much harder to evade.

SHADOW COUNTER / DEFENSE

Shadow Counter - MP+MK during blockstun costs one Shadow stock. Aganos's unique defense is still Chunk armor, but armor should not be confused with blocking: a throw ignores it, and multi-hit sequences can chew through several Chunks. Shadow Pulverize answers predicted throws; held Shadow Natural Disaster is a strong answer to projectiles and airborne approaches.

COUNTER-BREAKER PLAN

After a successful Counter Breaker, prioritize **fast Doubles + Pulverize/Natural Disaster Linkers** until the lockout is nearly over, then choose the Ender according to resource state. If low on Chunks, Payload Assault is usually worth more than a small damage increase. If multiple walls are already behind the opponent, Ruin is the cashout.

FINISHERS

Ultra - QCF+3K. Use during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF+3P. On Aganos's Forgotten Grotto, move the opponent into the marked central Stage Ultra zone before entering the command.

Aganos also has the modern game's Ultimate option where supported by the final character/content build; keep it distinct from his Ultra and Stage Ultra.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Fortify Chunk - B+HP
2. Payload Assault - QCF+P trajectories
3. Pulverize - QCB+P and Natural Disaster - QCF+K
4. Natural Disaster bounce with U
5. No Escape - 3P / Trapped - B+3P wall placement
6. Ruin - QCB+K wall crashes
7. Peacemaker - B+3P and all weapon follow-ups
8. Payload Assault Ender for Chunk recovery
9. Shadow Natural Disaster Recapture
10. Peacemaker j.HP Recapture, Instinct, Ultra and Stage Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - HISAKO

Wrath / counter stance / command grabs / possession movement / delayed rekka pressure

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

On Ryo Zan - QCF + P; repeat P for follow-ups

Hisako's three-part naginata rekka. Strength changes the first strike; delayed follow-ups create frame traps and breaker ambiguity. It is a primary Opener/Linker family.

Descent - QCB + K

Hisako sinks into the ground and reappears according to strength. Use it to evade, change sides and attack from unexpected positions.

Influence - QCB + P

Close command grab. A central part of Hisako's strike/throw game and one of the reasons opponents must respect her slow-looking pressure.

Possession - QCF + K

Longer-range command grab that advances toward the opponent. Strength changes travel distance. It can punish passive defense from farther away than Influence.

Vengeance - B + HP (hold)

High counter stance. Spend Wrath to counter eligible high/mid strikes; hold changes the timing window.

Low Vengeance - B + HK (hold)

Low counter stance. Counters eligible low attacks and forces the opponent to think carefully about meaty pressure.

Air On Ryo Zan - air QCF + P

Airborne naginata attack; strength changes trajectory/timing and supports air-to-ground approach.

Wall Jump - jump toward wall, then opposite direction

Hisako can redirect from the wall to alter her aerial approach and escape trajectory.

Shadow On Ryo Zan - QCF + 2P

Enhanced multi-hit rekka / combo tool.

Shadow Influence - QCB + 2P

Enhanced command grab.

Shadow Possession - QCF + 2K

Fast traveling command grab with strong range.

Shadow Descent - QCB + 2K

Enhanced movement/escape option.

Ultra - QCF + 3P

Perform during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3K

Only on a supported Stage Ultra arena, in the required target area/facing and under valid Ultra conditions.

HISAKO - WRATH, COUNTERS & COMMAND GRABS

Hisako is intentionally slow until Wrath turns her defensive reads into immediate offense.

WRATH METER

The purple **Wrath** gauge is Hisako's unique resource. It refills when she is not spending it and is consumed by her counter/pressure mechanics. With Wrath available, Vengeance becomes a major deterrent to predictable offense; with Wrath depleted, the opponent can challenge much more freely. Watch the gauge as closely as Shadow Meter.

COUNTER GAME

Vengeance - B+HP covers eligible standing/high attacks; **Low Vengeance - B+HK** covers lows. The counter does not mean Hisako can blindly escape every situation: throws, correctly timed gaps, projectiles and attacks that avoid the chosen counter height remain answers. The goal is to make the opponent hesitate, then steal turns with command grab or delayed On Ryo Zan.

INFLUENCE VS POSSESSION

Influence - QCB+P is the close command-grab threat. **Possession - QCF+K** travels and threatens from farther away. Mix them with crouching attacks, delayed rekka follow-ups and walk-up pressure. If the defender jumps to escape the grab, Hisako's long naginata normals and air routes can punish the jump.

ON RYO ZAN DELAYS

Do not mash all three rekka hits automatically. Practice **QCF+P -> delay P -> delay P**. The defender has to decide whether Hisako stopped, delayed, or continued. Once they begin swinging into the gaps, counter or finish the sequence; once they freeze, command grab.

OPENERS / OTHER STARTERS

On Ryo Zan - QCF+P is Hisako's main conventional Opener. Shadow On Ryo Zan also opens. Command grabs launch/position for their own follow-up routes rather than functioning like ordinary grounded Openers. Counter hits can create huge punish opportunities because the opponent committed to an attack.

NORMALS TO KNOW

Long naginata HP/HK buttons dominate surprising horizontal space but are slow enough to punish if thrown out carelessly. Her crouching light/medium attacks provide the grounded check that makes command grab dangerous. Use wall jump and air On Ryo Zan to change the angle when an opponent is waiting for the obvious grounded approach.

HISAKO - LINKERS, ENDERS, MANUALS & COMBOS

Her combo threat is strongest when the defender is already worried about what happens after the combo ends.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Hisako follows the standard Light / Medium / Heavy Auto-Double system. Because her animations are distinctive, repeating the same strength is asking to be broken. After suitable Openers and Linkers, alternate Auto-Doubles with **Manuals** and delayed rekka timing to disrupt the defender's read.

LINKERS

On Ryo Zan Linker - QCF + LP/MP

Primary grounded Linker; strength changes the sequence and breaker strength.

Shadow On Ryo Zan - QCF + 2P

Five-hit Shadow Linker. Break by reading the Shadow sequence rather than guessing during the freeze.

ENDERS

On Ryo Zan Ender: primary damage/cashout route.

Influence Ender - QCB+P: command-grab flavored end state that supports close pressure.

Possession Ender - QCF+K: carries/repositions and sets up Hisako's preferred range.

Choose the Ender for the next mix rather than treating every confirm as a pure damage exercise.

RECAPTURE / AIR CONVERSION

Hisako is not built around a constant recapture loop like some characters. Her air conversions instead rely on long normals, air On Ryo Zan and grounded follow-up positioning. When the opponent jumps away from command grab, prioritize the anti-air/juggle conversion that returns you to close strike/throw range.

PRACTICAL COMBO

On Ryo Zan Opener - QCF+MP -> MP Auto-Double -> Light On Ryo Zan Linker - QCF+LP -> HP Auto-Double -> On Ryo Zan Ender

Once this is automatic, replace one Double with a Manual and vary the Linker strength.

COUNTER CONVERSION

Read attack -> Vengeance / Low Vengeance -> take the guaranteed punish -> On Ryo Zan route -> Ender -> meaty/command-grab setup. The important part is not merely landing the counter; it is using the counter to restart the situation Hisako wants.

COMMAND-GRAB RESET

Short combo -> deliberately end early -> walk/step into Influence - QCB+P. Once the opponent begins jumping to escape the reset, use the same early-stop point to anti-air instead. This two-way decision is more valuable than always extending to maximum KV.

HISAKO - INSTINCT, ADVANCED PRESSURE & PRACTICE

The scariest Hisako is the one who convinces you that pressing a button is dangerous and standing still is worse.

INSTINCT - WRATH CONTROL

Activate - HP+HK. Instinct dramatically improves Hisako's Wrath game, letting her threaten counters and pressure far more freely. Use the activation as a momentum tool: once the opponent is conditioned to respect Vengeance, walk into command-grab range and force them to choose between jumping, attacking or blocking.

PRESSURE SCRIPT

c.LK/c.MK -> On Ryo Zan - QCF+P -> delay follow-up. If they press, finish the rekka or counter the challenge. If they continue blocking, stop and use **Influence - QCB+P**. If they jump, use a naginata anti-air/air conversion. Do not run this as a fixed sequence; the value comes from changing the answer after observing the defender.

DESCENT MOVEMENT

Descent - QCB+K is strongest when the opponent has committed to controlling one side of Hisako. Use it to escape predictable projectile/normal coverage, switch sides, or make wakeup timing harder to read. Do not overuse it against players waiting to punish the reappearance.

SHADOW COUNTER / DEFENSE

Shadow Counter - MP+MK during blockstun costs one Shadow stock. Hisako's counters are an additional defensive layer, not a replacement for blocking. Preserve Shadow Meter when Shadow On Ryo Zan/Shadow Possession will convert a defensive read into meaningful offense.

COUNTER-BREAKER PLAN

After a successful Counter Breaker, use fast Doubles and On Ryo Zan Linkers until the lockout is nearly finished, then cash out. Hisako's larger reward is often the post-Enders situation: close range with Wrath available and the opponent afraid to press.

FINISHERS

Ultra - QCF+3P. Use during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF+3K. Requires a supported stage plus the correct Stage Ultra target position/facing. Keep Stage Ultra separate from the ordinary Ultra command when practicing.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. On Ryo Zan - QCF+P and delayed follow-ups
2. Influence - QCB+P
3. Possession - QCF+K at all strengths
4. Vengeance - B+HP / Low Vengeance - B+HK
5. Wrath-gauge awareness
6. Descent - QCB+K movement
7. Auto-Doubles, Manuals and On Ryo Zan Linkers
8. Counter -> combo conversion
9. Command-grab reset / anti-air answer
10. Instinct, Shadow Counter, Ultra and Stage Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - ARIA

Three bodies / assists / body switching / Booster air mobility / Blade footsies / Bass zoning

UNIVERSAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Shotgun Blitz - QCF + K

Universal advancing knee/shotgun attack. Strength changes travel distance. Hops over lows; standard Opener/Linker. Shadow Shotgun Blitz - QCF+2K - is projectile-invulnerable and highly damaging.

Explosive Arc - QCB + K

Universal grenade-kick special. Upper-body invulnerable; strength changes startup/safety. Heavy is plus on block and very plus on hit. Standard Opener/Linker. **Shadow Explosive Arc - QCB+2K** is a fast five-hit version.

Orchestrate - B + HP / B + HK

Calls an available inactive drone as an assist. The exact assist depends on which body is currently floating behind ARIA. Assists can protect approaches, create mixups or control space, but the drone can be hit and takes severe damage.

Upload - 3P / 3K

Switches ARIA's active body to an available drone. Briefly invulnerable at the beginning but punishable if used carelessly in neutral. During a combo it functions as the **Drone Switch Ender** and safely rotates bodies.

BODY-SPECIFIC MOVES

Crescendo - QCB + P (air OK) - BOOSTER BODY

ARIA flies in a fixed direction: LP horizontal, MP diagonal, HP vertical. Grounded HP is fully invulnerable. Shadow Crescendo - QCB+2P - travels horizontally with one hit of armor.

Allegro - F,D,DF + P - BLADE BODY

LP = fast fully invulnerable uppercut; MP = three-hit advancing swipe, plus on block and easy Manual on hit; HP = three-hit launcher. **Shadow Allegro - F,D,DF+2P** is a fast invulnerable five-hit uppercut.

Dissonance - QCF + P - BASS BODY

Three-projectile chest cannon. LP fires low, MP mid, HP anti-air angle; destroys most ordinary projectiles. **Shadow Dissonance - QCF+2P** sprays seven projectiles across a broad arc.

Interlude - F + HP - BLADE BODY

Long-range overhead that is special-cancelable into combo starters.

Ultra - QCB + 3K

Perform during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCB + 3P

On ARIA's The Pinnacle, the opponent must be in the far-right Stage Ultra area with their back toward the window.

ARIA - DRONE ENSEMBLE & THE THREE BODIES

ARIA is effectively a three-character team sharing one match.

DRONE ENSEMBLE

ARIA's total life is split across **three separate bodies**. When the active body's life is depleted, that body is destroyed for the rest of the match; lose all three and ARIA loses. Inactive bodies can regenerate potential damage, while the active body cannot. This makes **Upload - 3P/3K** a survival tool, not merely a stance change.

BOOSTER BODY - AIR CONTROL

ARIA begins the match in Booster. Crescendo supplies ground/air approach angles and a reversal option. After the apex of a jump, **tap/hold Up to Hover** and steer horizontally. Hover lets ARIA delay her descent, cross over and create unusual left/right pressure. Booster assist is a fast tackle that pushes away on block and knocks down on hit.

BLADE BODY - FOOTSIES & REVERSAL

Blade increases walk speed and greatly extends MP/HP range. **Interlude - F+HP** supplies the overhead while crouching MP is a long cancelable low. **LP Allegro - F,D,DF+LP** is ARIA's fastest true reversal; MP Allegro is a strong whiff punish that allows an easy Manual; HP Allegro launches. Blade assist is a strike-invulnerable anti-air pillar.

BASS BODY - ZONING

Bass has very fast dashes and **Dissonance - QCF+P**, a high-durability low/mid/anti-air projectile family. Bass has no body-specific reversal, so protect its health carefully once pressured. Bass assist fires a triple projectile that leaves the opponent standing on hit and is ARIA's premier mixup-cover assist.

ASSIST MANAGEMENT

Assists are powerful but vulnerable. If the opponent hits a drone during its vulnerable period, the corresponding body takes roughly **2.5x the attack's strength in damage**. Do not call assists predictably. Bass assist is excellent for covering Shotgun Blitz/Blade high-low pressure; Blade assist protects the air; Booster assist creates breathing room.

BODY-SWITCH RULE

Switching bodies removes status curses and gives brief startup invulnerability, but neutral Upload is punishable. If a body's health is getting dangerous, use a **short combo -> Upload Ender** to rotate it safely into the background where potential damage can recover.

ARIA - OPENERS, LINKERS, ENDERS & COMBOS

Her neutral is complicated; once the combo starts, the universal structure is surprisingly simple.

OPENERS

Shotgun Blitz - QCF+K (Shadow OK)

Explosive Arc - QCB+K (Shadow OK)

Crescendo - QCB+P in Booster body.

MP Allegro - F,D,DF+MP is not a true opener, but gives enough advantage for an easy Manual that enters the combo system. HP Allegro launches instead.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

ARIA uses standard Light / Medium / Heavy Auto-Doubles. Her **kick Doubles are faster than punch Doubles**, which matters in Counter-Breaker optimization. Manuals after Shotgun Blitz have a slower Wind-Kick-like timing; Manuals after Explosive Arc are faster. MP Allegro -> Manual is intentionally lenient.

LINKERS

Shotgun Blitz Linker - QCF + LK/MK

Explosive Arc Linker - QCB + LK/MK

Shadow Shotgun Blitz - QCF+2K

Shadow Explosive Arc - QCB+2K

These are ARIA's only universal Linkers, regardless of active body. Explosive Arc is the higher-damage linker; Shotgun Blitz is faster for time-limited lockout routes.

SIX ENDERS

Shotgun Blitz - QCF+HK: Hard Knockdown / strong universal damage.

Explosive Arc - QCB+HK: Launcher; ideal for assist-based left/right or high/low setups.

Dissonance - QCF+HP: Battery - Bass only.

Allegro - F,D,DF+HP: Damage - Blade only; Shadow OK.

Crescendo - QCB+HP: Wall Splat - Booster only.

Upload - 3P/3K: Drone Switch Ender; safely changes active body.

RECAPTURE / FLIPOUT

ARIA has **no Recapture**. **Standing LK = Flipout** and **jumping LP = Flipout**. After Explosive Arc Launcher Ender, choose between an assist-backed wakeup mixup or intercepting the airborne opponent with a Flipout for an immediate standing reset.

PRACTICAL UNIVERSAL COMBO

Medium Shotgun Blitz - QCF+MK -> HK Auto-Double -> **Medium Explosive Arc Linker** - QCB+MK -> HK Auto-Double ->

Shotgun Blitz Ender - QCF+HK

Works regardless of body and teaches ARIA's core combo rhythm.

ARIA - INSTINCT, COUNTER-BREAKERS & ADVANCED PLAY

The goal is to keep all three bodies alive long enough for them to work together.

INSTINCT - FULL ENSEMBLE

Activate - HP+HK. ARIA switches to her healthiest surviving body and gains the movement/special options of every body still alive. Damage is distributed across the bodies, and backup forms cannot be destroyed during Instinct. Mini-Drones join the ensemble; fewer surviving bodies means more Mini-Drones. Press **HP+HK again** to cancel Instinct early at the cost of half the remaining Instinct bar.

0-METER COUNTER-BREAKER

HK Double -> Medium Explosive Arc -> HK Double -> Medium Explosive Arc -> Shotgun Blitz Ender - about **40%**. In Blade, use Allegro Damage Ender for about **46%**.

1-METER COUNTER-BREAKER

HK Double -> Medium Explosive Arc -> HK Double -> Shadow Explosive Arc -> Shotgun Blitz Ender - about **46%**. In Booster/Blade, the 0-meter route into Shadow Crescendo / Shadow Allegro Ender reaches roughly **50% / 54%**.

2-METER COUNTER-BREAKER

HK Double -> Light Shotgun Blitz -> HK Double -> Shadow Explosive Arc -> Shadow Explosive Arc -> Shotgun Blitz Ender - about **52%**. Booster/Blade variants using Shadow Crescendo / Shadow Allegro reach roughly **56% / 60%**.

ASSIST MIXUP

Knockdown -> call Bass assist -> attack as the opponent rises. In Blade, mix **c.MP low** against **Interlude - F+HP overhead**. In Booster, Hover above the wakeup point and choose the landing side. Bass projectiles cover the decision and can convert either hit into a full combo.

BODY-SURVIVAL PRIORITY

Do not sacrifice a nearly-dead body merely to finish one more neutral sequence. Confirm a hit, perform a short combo, then **Upload Ender - 3P/3K**. Keeping all three bodies alive until the first Instinct dramatically increases ARIA's durability and preserves all three strategic modes.

FINISHERS

Ultra - QCB+3K. Valid combo while opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCB+3P. On The Pinnacle, force the opponent to the far-right target area with their back to the window, then enter the Stage Ultra during valid Ultra conditions.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Shotgun Blitz - QCF+K / Explosive Arc - QCB+K
2. Upload - 3P/3K body switching
3. Orchestrate - B+HP/B+HK assist calls
4. Booster Crescendo + Hover
5. Blade Allegro + Interlude
6. Bass Dissonance
7. Universal Linkers and six Enders
8. Upload Ender to save a damaged body
9. Bass-assist high/low and Hover left/right setups
10. 0/1/2-meter Counter-Breakers, Instinct, Ultra and Stage Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - KIM WU

Dragon resource / parries / nunchaku pressure / firecracker zoning / explosive close-range offense

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Dragon Dance - QCF + P

Advancing nunchaku attack and core combo special. Strength changes distance/timing; use it as an Opener/Linker and to carry the opponent.

Dragon Kick - QCF + K

Fast advancing kick. A primary way to punish space and enter the combo system; Shadow Dragon Kick - QCF+2K - is the enhanced multi-hit version.

Firecracker - QCB + P

Kim strikes a firecracker projectile with her nunchaku. Button strength changes its behavior/timing and gives her a ranged threat without abandoning pressure.

Dragon Cannon - air QCF + K

Airborne diving/advancing kick. Changes jump approach and can convert airborne movement into offense.

Dragon Counter - QCB + K

Parry/counter special. A successful read stops an eligible incoming strike and can swing momentum immediately.

Dragon Cancel - press HP+HK using a Dragon

Spend a Dragon to cancel recovery and continue pressure/combo routes that normally would end. Dragon Cancels are the heart of Kim's advanced offense.

Shadow Dragon Dance - QCF + 2P

Enhanced multi-hit nunchaku attack.

Shadow Dragon Kick - QCF + 2K

Enhanced advancing kick.

Shadow Firecracker - QCB + 2P

Enhanced projectile pressure.

Shadow Dragon Counter - QCB + 2K

Enhanced defensive counter.

Ultra - QCF + 3K

Perform during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3P

Opposite attack family from the Ultra; only works on supported Stage Ultra arenas in the required position/facing.

KIM WU - DRAGONS, COUNTERS & PRESSURE

Kim's Dragon resource converts good reads into pressure that other characters cannot reproduce.

DRAGON RESOURCE

Kim can stock **Dragons** and spend them to extend offense or enhance control. Treat each Dragon as a future cancel: instead of asking only 'how much damage can this combo do?', ask whether spending a Dragon now creates a kill, a stronger reset, or a position worth more than saving it.

GETTING / USING DRAGONS

Dragons are tied to Kim's successful defensive/offensive resource game and Instinct. Once stocked, **Dragon Cancel - HP+HK** lets Kim cancel otherwise committed actions and immediately act again. This enables pressure extensions, unusual combo routes and safer commitment after a read.

DRAGON COUNTER

Dragon Counter - QCB+K is the defining defensive read. Use it against predictable strings rather than as a random escape. Once the opponent starts delaying attacks or throwing to beat the counter, Kim has created the hesitation she needs to take space with Dragon Kick, lights or throw.

FIRECRACKER CONTROL

Firecracker - QCB+P gives Kim a projectile threat that complements her advancing specials. Use it to make the opponent move, then intercept that movement with Dragon Kick or long nunchaku normals. Shadow Firecracker increases the screen-control threat and can cover an approach.

OPENERS

Dragon Dance - QCF+P and **Dragon Kick - QCF+K** are the main conventional starters. Shadow versions also open. Confirm the hit before committing to a long sequence; on block, use Dragon resource selectively rather than spending automatically.

NORMALS TO KNOW

Kim's nunchaku gives her strong mid-range buttons, while quick lows and throws make close defense uncomfortable. Her best pressure alternates between a safe poke, advancing special, counter threat and Dragon Cancel. Do not reduce her to constant forward movement; the counter and Firecracker are what make that movement difficult to challenge.

KIM WU - LINKERS, ENDERS, MANUALS & COMBOS

The basic combo is easy to learn; Dragon Cancels are where her routes become uniquely Kim Wu.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Kim uses the standard Light / Medium / Heavy Auto-Double system. Mix strengths instead of repeating Heavy Doubles. After suitable Openers/Linkers, insert Manuals to break the opponent's visual rhythm, then return to a Linker or cash out before KV becomes a problem.

LINKERS

Dragon Dance Linker - QCF + LP/MP

Dragon Kick Linker - QCF + LK/MK

Shadow Dragon Dance - QCF+2P

Shadow Dragon Kick - QCF+2K

Vary strength and use Dragon Cancel routes sparingly so the defender cannot reduce the combo to one obvious break point.

ENDERS

Dragon Dance Ender - QCF+HP: primary damage/carry option.

Dragon Kick Ender - QCF+HK: knockdown/positioning route.

Firecracker Ender - QCB+P: resource/utility end state where applicable.

Choose the Ender based on life, Dragon stock and the next pressure situation rather than always chasing maximum immediate damage.

DRAGON-CANCEL EXTENSION

Confirm -> special -> Dragon Cancel (HP+HK) -> immediate normal/special -> continue. Practice this first as a controlled extension, not a freestyle sequence. The important skill is recognizing which recovery you are canceling and having the next input ready before spending the Dragon.

PRACTICAL COMBO

Dragon Kick Opener - QCF+MK -> MP Auto-Double -> Light Dragon Dance Linker - QCF+LP -> HP Auto-Double -> Dragon Kick Ender - QCF+HK

Once reliable, replace one Double with a Manual and practice the same route from Dragon Dance.

DRAGON-CANCEL COMBO

Dragon Dance confirm -> Auto-Double -> Linker -> heavy Double -> special -> Dragon Cancel - HP+HK -> Manual -> Ender.

Use the cancel to create one additional meaningful decision, not merely extra hits. If the route will not kill or improve position, keeping the Dragon may be stronger.

COUNTER CONVERSION

Read attack -> Dragon Counter - QCB+K -> **immediate punish** -> **Opener** -> **combo**. Drill the punish separately so a successful counter never ends with hesitation. The defensive read only matters if it becomes damage or pressure.

KIM WU - INSTINCT, COUNTER-BREAKERS & PRACTICE

Kim becomes most dangerous when Dragon resource lets her turn every correct decision into another decision for the opponent.

INSTINCT - DRAGON ENGINE

Activate - HP+HK. Instinct supercharges Kim's Dragon game, giving her much freer access to Dragon-assisted offense. Use it when you already have momentum: pressure, cancel, reposition and force the opponent to repeatedly answer strike / throw / counter / delayed offense.

PRESSURE PLAN

Light/medium normal -> Dragon Dance or Dragon Kick. If the opponent challenges predictable offense, show Dragon Counter. If they freeze to avoid the counter, walk in for throw or restart pressure. Firecracker prevents them from comfortably retreating to full screen.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 0 METER

Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Dragon Dance Linker -> Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Dragon Dance Linker -> Ender. Use the fastest reliable route during the lockout and cash out before the timer expires.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 1 METER

Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Linker -> Heavy Auto-Double -> Shadow Dragon Dance/Shadow Dragon Kick -> Ender. Spend the Shadow stock late enough that its multi-hit sequence benefits from the lockout rather than wasting time early.

COUNTER-BREAKER - DRAGON ROUTE

Heavy Double -> Linker -> Heavy Double -> special -> Dragon Cancel - HP+HK -> fast Manual -> Shadow Linker -> Ender. This is the Kim-specific optimization: combine the Counter-Breaker lockout with one Dragon Cancel only when the extra extension materially improves the cashout.

FINISHERS

Ultra - QCF+3K. Valid combo while opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF+3P. Stage Ultras use the opposite attack family from the regular Ultra and require a supported Stage Ultra arena plus its positional requirement.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Dragon Dance - QCF+P
2. Dragon Kick - QCF+K
3. Firecracker - QCB+P
4. Dragon Counter - QCB+K
5. Dragon Cannon - air QCF+K
6. Auto-Doubles, Manuals and Linkers
7. Dragon Cancel - HP+HK from a known setup
8. Counter -> guaranteed conversion
9. Shadow routes / Counter-Breaker routes
10. Instinct, Ultra and Stage Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - TUSK

Deflect windows / enormous sword normals / stagger pressure / Immortal Spirit follow-ups / explosive damage

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Skull Splitter - QCB + P

Heavy sword special and standard Opener. Strength changes speed/range. The air version uses **air QCB+P** and changes Tusk's jump approach.

Conqueror - F,D,DF + P; optional HP follow-up

Rising anti-air/reversal family. The heavy follow-up adds another sword hit. Shadow Conqueror - F,D,DF+2P - is the enhanced version.

Immortal Spirit - QCF + K

Advancing run/stance that branches into three attacks. It is central to Tusk's approach and combo structure.

Moosejaw - QCF+K -> LP/LK

Light Immortal Spirit follow-up and combo Opener.

Collateral Damage - QCF+K -> MP/MK

Medium follow-up and Opener.

Destroyer - QCF+K -> HP/HK

Heavy follow-up and Opener.

Spine Splitter - B + HP (hold)

Huge heavy sword normal. The important property is its Deflect window: correctly timed sword heavies can blow through incoming attacks and create a punish opportunity.

Back Stab - F + MP

Advancing sword command normal.

Skewer - U + HP

Upward heavy sword command normal / air-control tool.

Shadow Skull Splitter - QCB + 2P

Enhanced multi-hit Skull Splitter.

Shadow Conqueror - F,D,DF + 2P

Enhanced rising anti-air/reversal; optional HP follow-up.

Shadow Immortal Spirit - QCF + 2K; follow with P/K

Enhanced Immortal Spirit sequence with follow-up choice.

Ultra - QCF + 3P

Perform during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3K

Separate command using the opposite attack family; only functions on supported Stage Ultra arenas in the required target area.

Ultimate - Ultra -> LP+LK

Available under the game's Ultimate requirements.

TUSK - DEFLECT, STAGGER & NEUTRAL CONTROL

Tusk's sword is slow by fighting-game standards, but Deflect changes what 'slow' means.

DEFLECT WINDOWS

Several of Tusk's heavy sword normals have active **Deflect** frames. If an eligible strike meets the sword during that window, Tusk blows through the attack instead of trading normally. This lets a well-timed heavy button challenge situations where another character would need to block. Deflect is timing-based - throwing out heavies randomly is still punishable.

HOW TO USE DEFLECT

Start by learning one reliable Deflect button, especially **B+HP Spine Splitter**, against a predictable meaty or poke. Once the opponent stops pressing automatically, take the space they surrender. Deflect is strongest as a threat: the fear of losing to a giant sword swing makes Tusk's throw, walk-forward and Immortal Spirit pressure more believable.

STAGGER

Tusk's heavy sword attacks can create **Stagger**, leaving the opponent upright and vulnerable long enough for a follow-up. Treat Stagger as a confirmed opening: do not admire the hit. Immediately convert into the appropriate normal/special and enter the combo system before the window disappears.

IMMORTAL SPIRIT

QCF+K moves Tusk forward before the follow-up. Light = Moosejaw, Medium = Collateral Damage, Heavy = Destroyer. Vary the branch so the opponent cannot pre-select one defensive timing. Shadow Immortal Spirit adds an enhanced route and accepts a punch/kick follow-up.

OPENERS

Skull Splitter - QCB+P and all three **Immortal Spirit follow-ups** are primary Openers. Shadow Skull Splitter and Shadow Immortal Spirit also open. A successful Stagger/Deflect punish can be converted into one of these starters.

ANTI-AIR

Conqueror - F,D,DF+P is the dedicated anti-air/reversal family. Do not rely exclusively on enormous standing sword buttons against jumps; Conqueror gives Tusk a direct answer when the opponent tries to leap over his horizontal control.

TUSK - LINKERS, ENDERS, MANUALS & COMBOS

Tusk does not need dozens of hits. One correct sword read can make a short combo hurt.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Tusk follows the standard Light / Medium / Heavy Auto-Double system. His heavy animations are visually obvious, so repeatedly choosing Heavy invites breaks. Mix in Light/Medium Doubles and Manuals after suitable Linkers. Use Heavy when damage or Counter-Breaker conditioning justifies the risk.

LINKERS

Skull Splitter Linker - QCB + LP/MP

Immortal Spirit Linker - QCF + LK/MK

Shadow Skull Splitter - QCB+2P

Shadow Immortal Spirit - QCF+2K

Alternate strengths and animation families so the defender cannot lock onto one obvious breaker rhythm.

ENDERS

Skull Splitter Ender - QCB+HP: primary damage/cashout route.

Conqueror Ender - F,D,DF+P: launcher-style end state.

Immortal Spirit / Destroyer Ender - QCF+HK: positioning/carry route.

Shadow Conqueror - F,D,DF+2P: Shadow ender/cashout option.

Pick the Ender for damage versus the next neutral situation.

PRACTICAL COMBO

Skull Splitter Opener - QCB+MP -> MP Auto-Double -> **Light Immortal Spirit Linker** - QCF+LK -> HP Auto-Double -> **Skull Splitter Ender** - QCB+HP

A simple route that teaches both of Tusk's main combo families.

STAGGER CONVERSION

Heavy sword Stagger -> **confirm** -> **fast normal** -> **Skull Splitter / Immortal Spirit Opener** -> **combo**. Practice the confirm until it is automatic. Tusk's neutral reward is too large to let a Stagger end without a conversion.

ANTI-AIR CONVERSION

Conqueror - F,D,DF+P -> **optional HP follow-up** -> **juggle/position**. Shadow Conqueror increases the reward when spending meter is justified. The goal is to return the opponent to the sword range Tusk controls.

BREAKER PLAN

Use Tusk's intimidating Heavy Doubles early only enough to make the opponent look for them. Then switch to faster strengths and Manuals. If they begin guessing Heavy on sight, that is the moment a Counter Breaker becomes much more valuable.

TUSK - INSTINCT, COUNTER-BREAKERS & PRACTICE

Tusk wins by making the opponent afraid to occupy the space in front of his sword.

INSTINCT

Activate - HP+HK. Tusk's Instinct amplifies his ability to survive pressure and turn defensive reads into offense. Use the window aggressively: establish the Deflect threat, force hesitation, then convert that hesitation into sword pressure, throw or Immortal Spirit approach.

PRESSURE PLAN

Long sword normal -> watch reaction. If they swing into predictable timing, Deflect. If they freeze, advance or throw. If they jump, Conqueror. If they retreat, Immortal Spirit closes space. The character works when each answer leads naturally to the next threat.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 0 METER

Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Skull Splitter Linker -> Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Immortal Spirit Linker -> Skull Splitter Ender. Keep the route quick enough to exploit the entire lockout.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 1 METER

Heavy Double -> Medium Linker -> Heavy Double -> Shadow Skull Splitter / Shadow Immortal Spirit -> damage Ender. Spend the Shadow stock late enough that the multi-hit Shadow sequence benefits from the lockout.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 2 METER

Heavy Double -> fast Linker -> Heavy Double -> Shadow Linker -> Shadow Linker -> Skull Splitter Ender. Use only when the extra meter materially changes the round; Tusk remains threatening with meter available for Shadow Conqueror defense.

FINISHERS

Ultra - QCF+3P. Valid combo while opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF+3K. Requires a supported Stage Ultra arena and its positional condition.

Ultimate - during Ultra, LP+LK. Tusk is one of the characters included in the game's Ultimate content.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Skull Splitter - QCB+P
2. Conqueror - F,D,DF+P
3. Immortal Spirit - QCF+K
4. Moosejaw / Collateral Damage / Destroyer follow-ups
5. B+HP Spine Splitter Deflect timing
6. Stagger -> confirmed Opener
7. Auto-Doubles, Manuals and Linkers
8. Shadow Conqueror defense / Shadow Immortal Spirit offense
9. 0/1/2-meter Counter-Breaker routes
10. Instinct, Ultra, Stage Ultra and Ultimate

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - ARBITER

Energy Sword / Carbine ammunition / Plasma Grenades / Overshield / Halo-style resource control

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Mercy's Demise - QCF + P

Advancing Energy Sword attack and a primary Opener/Linker family. Strength changes reach and timing; use it to convert grounded confirms into Arbiter's combo game.

Prophet's Bane - QCB + P

Energy Sword attack with a different movement/pressure profile from Mercy's Demise. Use it to vary approach and combo timing instead of presenting one obvious sword rhythm.

Carbine - QCF + K

Fires Arbiter's Covenant Carbine. Ammunition is limited, so shots are a resource rather than an unlimited fireball. Button strength changes the shot/sequence behavior.

Plasma Grenade - QCB + K

Throws a Plasma Grenade. Arbiter carries a limited grenade supply. A stuck grenade creates delayed pressure and can force the opponent to respect Arbiter even after the initial exchange.

Reload Carbine - 3P

Reloads the Carbine when ammunition is available to replenish. Reload only after creating enough space or knockdown advantage; an exposed reload is punishable.

Recharge Grenade - 3K

Replenishes Plasma Grenade resource when the situation allows. Resource management is part of Arbiter's neutral game, not an afterthought.

Shadow Mercy's Demise - QCF + 2P

Enhanced multi-hit sword attack / Shadow combo route.

Shadow Prophet's Bane - QCB + 2P

Enhanced Energy Sword attack.

Shadow Carbine - QCF + 2K

Enhanced firearm pressure.

Shadow Plasma Grenade - QCB + 2K

Enhanced grenade pressure.

Ultra - QCF + 3P

Perform during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3K

Separate Stage Ultra input; only works on supported arenas in the required target position/facing.

ARBITER - CARBINE, GRENADES & OVERSHIELD

Arbiter fights with resources from Halo: when they are stocked, his neutral becomes much harder to navigate.

CARBINE AMMUNITION

The **Carbine** is ammunition-limited. Use shots to interrupt movement, cover sword approaches and force jumps rather than firing automatically. When the magazine is low, deliberately create a knockdown or full-screen hesitation before reloading. The threat of the sword is what makes a safe reload possible.

PLASMA GRENADES

Plasma Grenades are also limited. Their value is delayed control: once a grenade is active or stuck, Arbiter can move while the opponent must account for the explosion. That lets him approach behind the threat, force a block, or turn a scramble into a sword confirm.

OVERSHIELD

Arbiter's **Overshield** gives him a temporary extra defensive layer. Treat it as permission to take calculated space, not permission to ignore defense. With shield protection active, advancing sword pressure and resource reloads become more difficult for the opponent to challenge cleanly.

RESOURCE PRIORITY

A simple rule: **do not enter the next neutral with everything empty unless the current combo is going to end the round.** If you have spent Carbine ammunition and grenades, use the next knockdown to restore whichever resource is more important for the matchup.

OPENERS

Mercy's Demise - QCF+P and **Prophet's Bane** - QCB+P form Arbiter's main sword starters, with Shadow versions available for enhanced conversions. Carbine and grenade hits are strongest when they create enough advantage for Arbiter to reach the opponent and confirm into a sword Opener.

NEUTRAL PLAN

Carbine asks the opponent to move. Grenade asks them to respect delayed space. Energy Sword punishes the movement those resources create. Once the opponent begins waiting instead, reload/recharge or walk them toward the corner. Arbiter works best when all three layers support one another.

ARBITER - LINKERS, ENDERS, MANUALS & COMBOS

His combo structure is conventional KI; the decision after the combo is usually about ammunition, grenades or positioning.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Arbiter uses standard Light / Medium / Heavy Auto-Doubles. Vary strengths and insert Manuals after familiar Linkers so the opponent cannot break on autopilot. His sword animations are distinctive, so predictable Heavy Doubles should be used as conditioning rather than default rhythm.

LINKERS

Mercy's Demise Linker - QCF + LP/MP

Prophet's Bane Linker - QCB + LP/MP

Shadow Mercy's Demise - QCF+2P

Shadow Prophet's Bane - QCB+2P

Alternate sword families and strengths to disguise the breaker timing.

ENDERS

Mercy's Demise Ender - QCF+HP: damage/cashout route.

Prophet's Bane Ender - QCB+HP: positioning/knockdown route.

Carbine Ender - QCF+K: firearm/resource-oriented end state.

Plasma Grenade Ender - QCB+K: grenade/pressure-oriented end state.

Choose based on the resource state you want when neutral resumes.

PRACTICAL COMBO

Mercy's Demise Opener - QCF+MP -> MP Auto-Double -> **Light Prophet's Bane Linker** - QCB+LP -> HP Auto-Double -> **Mercy's Demise Ender** - QCF+HP

Once reliable, replace one Auto-Double with a Manual and alternate the two sword Linkers.

GRENADE CONVERSION

Plasma Grenade threat -> **opponent blocks/moves** -> **sword confirm** -> **Opener** -> **combo**. The grenade's real reward is often not the explosion itself but the forced movement that lets Arbiter establish Energy Sword range.

RESOURCE RESET

Combo -> **knockdown Ender** -> **reload Carbine / replenish grenade if safe**. Practice this as part of the combo rather than a separate decision. The best Arbiter sequences finish with both damage and a prepared next neutral.

BREAKER PLAN

Show Heavy sword Doubles just enough to make the opponent search for them, then switch to faster strengths and Manuals. If they begin guessing at the sword animation, Counter Breaker becomes a major threat because Arbiter can use the lockout to cash out and then restore resources.

ARBITER - INSTINCT, COUNTER-BREAKERS & PRACTICE

Arbiter is most oppressive when his Halo resources are stocked and the opponent has nowhere comfortable to move.

INSTINCT

Activate - HP+HK. Instinct dramatically improves Arbiter's ability to control the screen and sustain his resource-based offense. Use it when the extra protection/resource pressure will let you force a sequence rather than activating at a range where the opponent can simply wait it out.

OVERSHIELD PRESSURE

With Overshield active, take space behind Carbine or grenade coverage, then threaten sword pressure. The opponent may try to burn the shield with rapid multi-hit offense; be ready to block rather than assuming the shield makes every approach safe.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 0 METER

Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Mercy's Demise Linker -> Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Prophet's Bane Linker -> damage Ender. Keep the sequence fast enough to exploit the full lockout.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 1 METER

Heavy Double -> Medium sword Linker -> Heavy Double -> Shadow Mercy's Demise / Shadow Prophet's Bane -> damage Ender. Spend the Shadow stock late enough that its multi-hit sequence benefits from the remaining lockout.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 2 METER

Heavy Double -> fast Linker -> Heavy Double -> Shadow sword Linker -> Shadow sword Linker -> damage Ender. Save meter if the extra Shadow sequence will not change the round; Arbiter values Shadow Meter in neutral as well.

FINISHERS

Ultra - QCF+3P. Use during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF+3K. Requires a supported Stage Ultra arena and the correct target position/facing. Practice it separately from the ordinary Ultra so the opposite button family becomes automatic.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Mercy's Demise - QCF+P
2. Prophet's Bane - QCB+P
3. Carbine - QCF+K and ammunition awareness
4. Plasma Grenade - QCB+K
5. Reload / grenade replenishment
6. Auto-Doubles, Manuals and sword Linkers
7. Grenade -> sword conversion
8. Knockdown -> safe resource reset
9. 0/1/2-meter Counter-Breaker routes
10. Overshield/Instinct, Ultra and Stage Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - RASH

Aerial rushdown / Wicked Tongue mobility / Wrecking Ball / Battlemaniac recapture / Speeder Bike Instinct

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Battering Ram - QCF + P

Rash's primary advancing punch and combo Opener. It can also be performed from Run with **F,F (hold)** -> **HP**. Shadow Battering Ram - QCF+2P - is the enhanced multi-hit version and also opens.

Big Bad Boot - QCF + K

Huge forward kick. On hit it launches for a juggle, creating Recapture/Flipout opportunities. Shadow Big Bad Boot - QCF+2K - is the enhanced version and functions as a powerful Ender.

Wrecking Ball - QCB + K (ground or air)

Rash curls into a spinning ball. Strength changes its arc. On hit it wall-splats, giving Rash time to continue pressure. Shadow Wrecking Ball - QCB+2K - is the enhanced multi-hit version.

Wicked Tongue - any direction + 3P (ground or air)

Eight-way tongue zipline. Aim with any direction. Rash can attach to the opponent or interact with projectiles; the tongue is his signature mobility tool and can create a Manual on hit.

Rash Bash - B + HP

Overhead fist slam. Against an airborne opponent it **Recaptures**, returning them to a standing combo state.

Battlemaniac - LP/LK -> LP/LK -> LP/LK -> LP/LK -> LP/LK

Five-hit light target combo. The second hit is an Opener; the third hit Recaptures an airborne opponent. Continuing the whole chain automatically reaches Shadow-style linker/ender behavior, but normally convert early into a regular combo.

Run - F,F (hold)

Keep holding Forward after the dash to run. Press **HP** during Run for Battering Ram.

Pick Up and Play - LP+LK / B+LP+LK -> B/F + any attack

Rash's throw and directional follow-up sequence.

Ultra - QCF + 3P

Perform during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3K

Rash has no home stage, but can perform Stage Ultras on supported arenas when positioned in that stage's target zone.

RASH - WICKED TONGUE, WRECKING BALL & MOBILITY

Rash can play slow with excellent normals, then instantly turn the match into an aerial scramble.

WICKED TONGUE

Any direction + 3P gives Rash eight-way zipline movement from the ground or air. Use horizontal Tongue to close distance, diagonal Tongue to alter jump arcs, and downward Tongue to disguise whether a jump will cross up. On hit, Wicked Tongue gives enough advantage for a Manual and combo conversion.

PROJECTILE INTERACTION

Wicked Tongue can **eat/interact with incoming projectiles**, letting Rash turn zoning into movement opportunities. Do not tongue predictably into a waiting opponent: its strength comes from forcing the defender to account for several possible trajectories at once.

WRECKING BALL

QCB+K works on the ground or in the air. Use different strengths to vary the arc and arrival timing. A clean hit wall-splats, allowing another conversion. Because Wrecking Ball is punishable when poorly placed, mix it with Tongue, normal jumps and grounded footsies rather than treating it as a universal approach.

BIG BAD BOOT JUGGLES

QCF+K launches. From the launch, Rash can pursue with air normals, Tongue movement, **Rash Bash - B+HP** Recapture, the third Battlemaniac hit Recapture, or a Flipout. This is where his otherwise simple combo game becomes highly improvisational.

FLIPOUTS

Crouching LP = Flipout.

Jumping LP = Flipout.

Use Flipout when the opponent is airborne and you want an immediate standing reset instead of more juggle damage. Follow with throw, low, overhead Rash Bash or another Tongue movement mix.

OPENERS / OTHER STARTERS

Battering Ram - QCF+P is the conventional Opener. The second Battlemaniac light is also an Opener. **Wicked Tongue** and **Rash Bash** require a Manual to enter the combo system; **Big Bad Boot** launches; **Wrecking Ball** wall-splats.

RASH - LINKERS, ENDERS, MANUALS & COMBOS

Rash's basic grounded combo is easy; his air resets and Recaptures are what make him difficult to predict.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Rash follows the standard Light / Medium / Heavy Auto-Double system. Mix strengths rather than leaning on Heavy. Wicked Tongue and Rash Bash can lead into Manuals; practice confirming the hit before entering a normal combo route.

LINKERS

Battering Ram Linker - QCF + LP/MP

Big Bad Boot Linker - QCF + LK/MK

Shadow Battering Ram - QCF+2P

Vary strength and alternate punch/kick rhythms to prevent easy reaction breaks.

ENDERS

Battering Ram Ender - QCF+HP: grounded damage/carry route.

Big Bad Boot Ender - QCF+K: launcher/position route.

Wrecking Ball Ender - QCB+K: wall-splat-oriented route.

Shadow Big Bad Boot - QCF+2K: Shadow cashout.

Shadow Wrecking Ball - QCB+2K: Shadow wall/position cashout.

PRACTICAL GROUNDED COMBO

Battering Ram Opener - QCF+MP -> MP Auto-Double -> Light Battering Ram Linker - QCF+LP -> HP Auto-Double -> Battering Ram Ender - QCF+HP

Once automatic, vary Linker strength and replace a Double with a Manual.

BIG BAD BOOT -> RECAPTURE

Big Bad Boot - QCF+K -> pursue airborne opponent -> Rash Bash - B+HP Recapture -> Auto-Double -> Linker -> Ender.

Alternatively use two Battlemaniac jabs and let the third hit Recapture. The visual similarity between the fist-slam Recaptures creates breaker ambiguity.

FLIPOUT RESET

Launch -> jumping LP Flipout -> land -> throw / low / B+HP overhead / Wicked Tongue. Or use crouching LP against a low airborne opponent. The point is to end the juggle early and force an immediate grounded guess.

BATTLEMANIAC CONVERSION

LP -> LP -> special cancel into Battering Ram. The second Battlemaniac hit has already opened the combo, so the special becomes a Linker. If the opponent tries to jump away, continue to the third light for the automatic Recapture.

RASH - INSTINCT, COUNTER-BREAKERS & PRACTICE

Rash is strongest when he alternates controlled ground play with sudden movement the opponent cannot pre-plan.

INSTINCT - SPEEDER BIKE MAYHEM

Activate - HP+HK. During Instinct, Rash gains access to his **Speeder Bike**. The bike charges across the screen as a powerful moving threat; use **Up** to get on and **Back** to slow it down. The bike lets Rash cover movement and build chaotic approach/reset situations.

PRESSURE PLAN

Start with strong grounded normals and Battlemaniac lights. Once the defender settles into that pace, change it with Wicked Tongue or Wrecking Ball. If they jump away from close pressure, Battlemaniac/Rash Bash Recapture. If they freeze, throw or reset. If they zone, Tongue can challenge the projectile lane.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 0 METER

Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Battering Ram Linker -> Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Battering Ram Linker -> Battering Ram Ender. Keep the route compact enough to exploit the entire lockout.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 1 METER

Heavy Double -> Medium Battering Ram -> Heavy Double -> Shadow Battering Ram - QCF+2P -> Ender. Use the Shadow sequence late enough to benefit from the remaining lockout.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 2 METER

Heavy Double -> fast Linker -> Heavy Double -> Shadow Battering Ram -> Shadow Big Bad Boot -> Ender/juggle. Spend both stocks only when the added damage or resulting juggle materially changes the round.

FINISHERS

Ultra - QCF+3P. Use during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF+3K. Rash has no dedicated home stage, but the command works on the game's supported Stage Ultra arenas when the opponent is in that arena's valid target area.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Battering Ram - QCF+P
2. Big Bad Boot - QCF+K
3. Wrecking Ball - QCB+K on ground and in air
4. Wicked Tongue - any direction+3P in all eight directions
5. Battlemaniac light chain and early special cancel
6. Rash Bash - B+HP Recapture
7. c.LP / j.LP Flipouts
8. Big Bad Boot juggle -> Recapture / Flipout
9. 0/1/2-meter Counter-Breaker routes
10. Speeder Bike Instinct, Ultra and Stage Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - GENERAL RAAM

Hardcore grappler / Kryll Armor / Kryll Swarm damage-over-time / command grabs / terrifying knockdown pressure

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Decimation - QCF + P

Knife lunge and RAAM's only traditional combo Opener and Linker. Light is fastest; Medium works naturally after heavy normals and is much safer; Heavy has the longest reach and strongest block situation. Shadow Decimation - QCF+2P - is the enhanced Opener/Linker.

Dominance - QCB + P

Command grab. Light has the greatest reach; Heavy does the most immediate damage and leaves RAAM close. Shadow Dominance - QCB+2P - is an exceptionally fast command grab and a devastating damage Ender.

Kryll Rush - QCB + K

Armored running grab. RAAM gains Kryll Armor while advancing, then loses the armor during the actual grab attempt. On hit it applies Kryll Swarm and leaves the opponent standing with advantage for RAAM.

Emergence - QCF + K

Kryll anti-air/reversal. Medium is a strong anti-air; Heavy is strike-invulnerable. On hit it applies Kryll Swarm. Shadow Emergence - QCF+2K - is the enhanced reversal.

Kryll Shield - 3P (hold); release to attack

Armor stance that absorbs non-Shadow projectiles and one physical hit as potential damage. Release attacks and applies Kryll Swarm. RAAM can dash-cancel while holding or after contact.

Kryll Shield Cancel - while holding 3P, press 3P

Cancels the stance. RAAM can also cancel Decimation into Kryll Shield by spending half a Shadow stock.

Deadly Stomps - opponent knocked down -> LK or MK

LK causes Flipout; MK stomps for damage and another hard knockdown. The stomp game can loop until the defender escapes or breaks.

Deception - F + HK

Advancing command normal used in spacing and post-Dominance setups.

Shadow Kryll Rush - QCB + 2K

Projectile-invulnerable enhanced Rush.

Shadow Dominance - QCB + 2P

Extremely fast command grab / Shadow damage Ender.

Ultra - QCF + 3K

Perform during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3P

RAAM has no home stage, but can use Stage Ultras on supported arenas from their valid target zones.

GENERAL RAAM - KRYLL ARMOR, SWARM & GRAPPLING

RAAM's plan is simple: survive the trip across the screen, then make every close-range decision frightening.

KRYLL ARMOR

Kryll Shield and **Kryll Rush** use RAAM's unique Kryll Armor. It can absorb unlimited ordinary projectiles and then one physical hit; Shadow attacks break it. Absorbed damage becomes **potential damage**, so do not tank several attacks and then immediately gamble - give the white life time to recover.

KRYLL SWARM

Hits from **Kryll Shield**, **Kryll Rush** or **Emergence** apply the black Kryll Swarm debuff. It deals damage over roughly ten seconds until RAAM is hit. The effect does not stack; a new application refreshes it. Swarm cannot directly remove the final pixel of a life bar, but it can leave the opponent vulnerable to any stray hit or chip.

DOMINANCE

QCB+P is the center of RAAM's offense. Regular versions grab very quickly; Light reaches farthest, Heavy hurts most. After the grab, Deadly Stomps and planned jump/cross-up setups continue the attack. **Shadow Dominance - QCB+2P** is dramatically faster and can punish tiny gaps that ordinary characters cannot.

KRYLL SHIELD APPROACH

Against zoning, hold **3P**, absorb one carefully chosen attack, then dash-cancel forward. Repeat only after potential life has had a chance to recover. A fully charged Shield release becomes unblockable; a counter-hit or full charge causes Stagger and can lead to a Manual/combo.

OPENERS

Decimation - QCF+P is RAAM's only conventional Opener. Light combos from light/medium normals but is unsafe; Medium is the natural cancel after standing HP; Heavy is a long-range frame-trap/anti-jump choice rather than a routine confirm. Shadow Decimation also opens.

ANTI-AIR / REVERSAL

Medium Emergence - QCF+MK is the main anti-air. **Heavy Emergence - QCF+HK** and Shadow Emergence are strike-invulnerable reversal choices. Opponents often jump preemptively to avoid Dominance, so being ready with Emergence is essential.

GENERAL RAAM - LINKERS, ENDERS, STOMPS & COMBOS

RAAM has only one Linker family, so his breaker game relies on Auto-Double strength, Manuals and Counter-Breaker threat.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Punch and kick Auto-Doubles share the same animation by strength. Mix Light / Medium / Heavy and use Manuals where the route allows. Light Decimation does **not** permit a Manual afterward, so that common starter must flow directly into a Double or Linker.

LINKERS

Decimation Linker - QCF + LP/MP

Shadow Decimation - QCF + 2P

Light, Medium and Heavy Decimation Linkers lunge one, two and three times. Because RAAM has no second Linker family, change strength and cadence rather than repeating one obvious pattern.

ENDERS

Dominance - QCB+P: Damage Ender. Shadow Dominance is the premium cashout.

Emergence - QCF+K: Hard Knockdown + Kryll Swarm.

Kryll Rush - QCB+K: Advantage + Kryll Swarm; opponent remains standing with RAAM advantaged.

Decimation - QCF+HP: Wall Splat Ender; especially strong in the corner.

DEADLY STOMP LOOP

After throw, Dominance, Emergence or another suitable knockdown: **LK Stomp = Flipout**; **MK Stomp = damage + another hard knockdown**. Use MK to pile on damage, then LK when you want the opponent standing immediately for a Dominance/meaty guess.

PRACTICAL COMBO

standing HP -> Medium Decimation Opener - QCF+MP -> HP Auto-Double -> Light Decimation Linker - QCF+LP -> HP Auto-Double -> Dominance Ender - QCB+HP

This teaches RAAM's core heavy-normal confirm, single Linker family and damage cashout.

KRYLL ENDER ROUTE

Decimation Opener -> Double -> Decimation Linker -> Double -> Emergence Ender - QCF+K -> Deadly Stomp. Choose this instead of raw damage when Kryll Swarm plus the knockdown mix is worth more than immediate cashout.

KRYLL SHIELD CONVERSION

3P hold -> absorb/read attack -> release on counter-hit/full charge -> Stagger -> heavy normal -> Decimation Opener -> combo. On ordinary non-counter hit, Shield may knock down rather than provide the same conversion, so confirm what happened before committing.

GENERAL RAAM - INSTINCT, COUNTER-BREAKERS & PRACTICE

Once RAAM gets close, the opponent is choosing between blocking a giant normal, jumping from a grab, or challenging into a trap.

INSTINCT - KRYLL STORM

Activate - HP+HK. Instinct floods the screen with Kryll and continuously builds **potential damage** on the opponent. RAAM can also slide forward/back while holding Kryll Shield. The best activation is often during a combo after a lockout: let Instinct build white life, extend with heavy Doubles, then cash it out with Dominance/Shadow Dominance.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 0 METER

HP Auto-Double -> Light Decimation Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> Light Decimation Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> Dominance Ender - approximately 51% from the reference setup.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 1 METER

HP Double -> Light Decimation -> HP Double -> Light Decimation -> HP Double -> Shadow Dominance Ender - approximately 57% from the reference setup.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 2 METER

HP Double -> Light Decimation -> HP Double -> Shadow Decimation -> Shadow Dominance Ender - approximately 62% from the reference setup. For Shadow Dominance, use two punches rather than a 3P macro to avoid accidental Kryll Shield overlap.

POST-DOMINANCE SET PLAY

Light Dominance: Deception - F+HK -> whiff c.LP -> jump forward with variable timing for front/cross-up pressure.

Heavy Dominance: whiff c.HP -> standing MK or Heavy Decimation gives a strong meaty.

These are templates - adjust timing by opponent size and wakeup behavior.

FINISHERS

Ultra - QCF+3K. Use during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF+3P. RAAM has no dedicated stage; use the command on any supported Stage Ultra arena while the opponent occupies that stage's valid target zone.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Decimation - QCF+P at all strengths
2. Dominance - QCB+P range by strength
3. Emergence - QCF+K anti-air/reversal
4. Kryll Rush - QCB+K
5. Kryll Shield - 3P hold/release + dash cancel
6. Kryll Swarm timer awareness
7. Deadly Stomp MK loop / LK Flipout
8. Heavy-normal -> Medium Decimation confirms
9. 0/1/2-meter Counter-Breaker routes
10. Instinct lockout cashout, Ultra and Stage Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - MIRA

Blood health / recoverable silver life / Embrace healing / Mist mobility / bats / explosive air-ground offense

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Trephine - QCF + P

Advancing multi-hit claw attack and Mira's primary conventional Opener/Linker family. Strength changes travel and timing. Shadow Trephine - QCF+2P - is the enhanced multi-hit version.

Reaping - QCB + P

Scything blood attack used for pressure and combo structure. Strength changes reach/timing; Shadow Reaping - QCB+2P - provides the enhanced version.

Embrace - QCB + K

Command grab that restores Mira's recoverable silver health. The grab is strategically essential because many of her strongest actions spend her own life.

Mist Form - QCF + K

Mira dissolves into mist and moves through attacks/space. Strength changes movement. Use it for escape, side switching and unusual pressure rather than as a predictable neutral skip.

Air Mist Form - air QCF + K

Airborne Mist movement; changes landing timing and cross-up position.

Blood Seekers - QCB + 3P

Summons bats that track/control space. Blood Seekers support Mira's approach and make the opponent account for a delayed threat while she moves.

Blood Offering - HP+HK when available

Mira's blood-resource interactions trade real/red health for powerful offense while leaving silver recoverable life. Manage the difference carefully.

Shadow Trephine - QCF + 2P

Enhanced Trephine / Shadow combo tool.

Shadow Reaping - QCB + 2P

Enhanced Reaping.

Shadow Embrace - QCB + 2K

Enhanced command-grab/healing route.

Shadow Mist - QCF + 2K

Enhanced Mist mobility.

Ultra - QCF + 3P

Perform during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3K

Only works on supported Stage Ultra arenas from the required target position/facing.

MIRA - BLOOD HEALTH, SILVER LIFE & EMBRACE

Mira can spend her own life to become terrifying. The skill is knowing when the debt is safe.

RED VS SILVER HEALTH

Many Mira actions convert part of her normal health into **silver recoverable health**. Silver life is not permanently lost yet, but if Mira is hit before recovering it, the risk becomes real. Her offense therefore has a visible price: every aggressive sequence changes how much damage she can afford to take.

EMBRACE HEALING

Embrace - QCB+K is how Mira converts silver life back into usable health. This makes command-grab conditioning central to the character. Once the opponent begins blocking to survive Trephine/Reaping pressure, Embrace becomes the threat that both damages them and repairs Mira's resource state.

WHEN TO SPEND LIFE

Spend aggressively when the sequence is likely to produce a knockdown, lockout, kill, or safe Embrace opportunity. Avoid spending large amounts of life simply to make neutral flashy. A Mira with huge silver life and no route to Embrace can lose a round from one ordinary punish.

MIST FORM

QCF+K and **air QCF+K** let Mira change sides and evade conventional attack timing. Use Mist after establishing real strike pressure so the opponent cannot simply wait for the reappearance. Air Mist is especially useful for altering a jump that appeared committed.

BLOOD SEEKERS

QCB+3P puts bats on the screen as a delayed control tool. Approach behind them, force the opponent to block or move, then choose Trephine, low/throw, air approach or Mist. The bats are strongest when they create a decision rather than when thrown out with no follow-up plan.

OPENERS

Trepine - QCF+P is the main conventional Opener, with Shadow Trephine as the meter version. Reaping and blood/bat confirms support the approach and can lead into the combo system when properly converted.

MIRA - LINKERS, ENDERS, MANUALS & COMBOS

Her combo choices are inseparable from health management: maximum damage is not always the best Mira route.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Mira uses the standard Light / Medium / Heavy Auto-Double system. Mix strengths and Manuals to prevent easy breaks. Because her own health is a resource, a broken greedy combo can be unusually costly; favor reliable confirms until the defender gives you a reason to Counter Break.

LINKERS

Trephine Linker - QCF + LP/MP

Reaping Linker - QCB + LP/MP

Shadow Trephine - QCF+2P

Shadow Reaping - QCB+2P

Alternate families and strengths so the defender cannot settle into one breaker rhythm.

ENDERS

Trephine Ender - QCF+HP: damage/carry-oriented cashout.

Reaping Ender - QCB+HP: alternate damage/position route.

Embrace Ender - QCB+K: health-recovery priority when Mira has significant silver life.

When in doubt, ask whether the extra damage is worth ending the combo without restoring health.

PRACTICAL COMBO

Trephine Opener - QCF+MP -> MP Auto-Double -> **Light Reaping Linker** - QCB+LP -> HP Auto-Double -> **Trephine Ender** - QCF+HP

Use this as the basic damage route, then practice the same structure into an Embrace/healing end state when silver life is high.

HEALING ROUTE

Confirm -> **short combo** -> **Embrace recovery route**. Do not automatically maximize KV first. When Mira has accumulated silver health, shortening the combo to secure recovery can be worth more than several additional hits.

BAT-COVERED MIX

Blood Seekers - QCB+3P -> **advance** -> **low / throw / Trephine / jump / Mist side switch**. If the bats connect, confirm immediately into the appropriate Opener rather than letting the hit go unused.

MIST RESET

Short pressure -> **Mist Form** - QCF+K -> **reappear front/back** -> **fast normal** -> **Trephine confirm**. Once the opponent starts swinging at the reappearance, stop using Mist at that point and punish the preemptive challenge.

MIRA - INSTINCT, COUNTER-BREAKERS & PRACTICE

Mira's strongest rounds look reckless, but the best Mira play is calculated resource conversion.

INSTINCT - VAMPIRIC MOMENTUM

Activate - HP+HK. Instinct greatly improves Mira's ability to sustain her blood-powered offense and recover from the health cost of her game plan. Activate when you can force interaction; wasting the timer at full screen gives up the main reason to use it.

PRESSURE PLAN

Use Blood Seekers or a safe normal to make the opponent block, then rotate among **Trephine pressure, Embrace command grab, jump/air approach and Mist side switch**. The opponent wants to hit Mira before she can heal silver life, so their urgency itself becomes something you can exploit.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 0 METER

Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Trephine Linker -> Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Reaping Linker -> damage Ender. If Mira is carrying dangerous silver life, replace the final damage choice with the health-recovery route instead.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 1 METER

Heavy Double -> Medium Linker -> Heavy Double -> Shadow Trephine / Shadow Reaping -> Ender. Use the Shadow sequence while the lockout still guarantees the hits.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 2 METER

Heavy Double -> fast Linker -> Heavy Double -> Shadow Trephine -> Shadow Reaping -> Ender. Two stocks are justified when the route kills or creates enough advantage to offset Mira's health expenditure.

FINISHERS

Ultra - QCF+3P. Use during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF+3K. Requires a supported Stage Ultra arena and that arena's positional condition. Keep the two commands distinct in practice.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Trephine - QCF+P
2. Reaping - QCB+P
3. Embrace - QCB+K and healing awareness
4. Mist Form - QCF+K / air QCF+K
5. Blood Seekers - QCB+3P
6. Watch red vs silver life during offense
7. Auto-Doubles, Manuals and both Linker families
8. Bat-covered mix / Mist reset
9. 0/1/2-meter Counter-Breaker routes
10. Instinct, Ultra and Stage Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - GARGOS

Portal zoning / quadruple jump / Devil's Divide command grab / Izzik & Dretch minions / stone Instinct armor

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Oblivion - QCF + P

Portal Punch. LP erupts beneath the opponent and is Gargos's ranged grounded Opener. MP attacks directly in front and knocks down. HP attacks from above and ground-bounces. Shadow Oblivion - QCF+2P - is the fast enhanced version and can open a grounded combo.

Reckoning - QCF + K (ground or air)

Swooping attack and primary close-range Opener/Linker. LK travels horizontally and staggers; MK travels diagonally and is a strong anti-air; HK portals vertically onto the opponent and is invincible but slow/unsafe. Shadow Reckoning - QCF+2K - is projectile-invulnerable.

Devil's Divide - QCB + P

Command grab. LP is fastest, MP hops forward before grabbing, HP is the anti-air version. After the grab, press P/K up to three times to pummel, then choose a directional finisher.

Sadistic Drop - Devil's Divide -> U or neutral

High-damage portal suplex.

Sadistic Appetite - -> B

Steals Shadow Meter.

Sadistic Intent - -> D

Sets opponent down with frame advantage.

Sadistic Hurl - -> F

Throws opponent away; especially useful near the corner / for hard-knockdown setup.

Quadruple Jump - UB/U/UF, repeat up to 4 jumps

Gargos can jump as many as four times before landing, in either direction.

Summon Izzik - QCB + 2K

Costs one Shadow stock; summons the pitchfork minion.

Summon Dretch - QCB + 2K, hold P or K during freeze

Summons the tougher belly-flop minion instead.

Minion Cover - QCB + LK

Orders active minions to stay nearer Gargos.

Minion Creep - QCB + MK

Orders them toward the opponent.

Minion Kill - QCB + HK

Triggers a minion's powered special once ready.

Ultra - QCF + 3P

Perform during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3K

Only on supported Stage Ultra arenas from the required target position/facing.

GARGOS - MINIONS, DEVIL'S DIVIDE & AIR CONTROL

Minions are the glue that turns Gargos from a good zoner into a screen-control nightmare.

IZZIK & DRETCH

Izzik walks and stabs with a pitchfork, including an anti-air attack; he takes two hits to eliminate. **Dretch** scampers along the floor and belly-flops; he takes three hits. Gargos can have one of each active at the same time. Their attacks count as projectiles and cannot cross up.

MINION SPECIALS

After roughly ten seconds alive, a minion glows purple. Use **Minion Kill - QCB+HK**: Izzik performs a multi-hit pitchfork barrage, while Dretch leaves the screen and returns with a delayed overhead belly flop. With both active, Gargos can layer low/overhead/grab pressure while the minions occupy the defender.

PICKING UP MINIONS

Gargos can grab his own minion with **Devil's Divide - QCB+P**. While holding it: **U/F** throws it in different arcs, **B** eats it for Instinct Meter, **D** sets it down, and **P/K** pummels it to immediately activate its special. This is advanced utility - first learn to summon safely and let the minions work.

SAFE SUMMON WINDOWS

Do not summon naked in neutral. Good windows include a throw, sweep, Oblivion Launcher Ender, or Sadistic Hurl Hard Knockdown Ender. Once a minion is active, keep the opponent busy with Oblivion, air movement and Devil's Divide so they cannot freely attack it.

DEVIL'S DIVIDE DECISION TREE

After the grab and optional pummels: choose **Drop** for damage, **Appetite** when stealing meter helps fund another minion, **Intent** for a close +frame reset, or **Hurl** for position/knockdown. Near the corner, Hurl can lead to additional conversion opportunities.

AIR CONTROL

Quadruple Jump plus air Reckoning makes Gargos unusually mobile for his size. **j.HK** creates space, **j.MK** crosses up, and **j.MP** immediately drops him for a very fast overhead. Use these tools behind minion cover; without minions, reckless air movement makes his huge hurtbox vulnerable.

GARGOS - OPENERS, LINKERS, ENDERS & COMBOS

Gargos can combo at close range or from across the screen, but his best reward is often another safe minion summon.

OPENERS / OTHER STARTERS

Light Oblivion - QCF+LP opens from range; Shadow Oblivion also opens. **Reckoning** - QCF+K is the primary close-range/air Opener. Heavy Oblivion ground-bounces for a juggle; standing HP staggers; minion attacks can lead to a Manual; Sadistic Hurl can lead to a Manual in the corner.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Gargos has normal close-range Auto-Doubles plus a ranged combo trait. At range, Oblivion Linkers appear over the opponent while ranged Auto-Doubles appear in front at strength-dependent angles. Mix strengths and Manuals so the opponent cannot reduce the combo to one obvious visual cue.

LINKERS

Oblivion Linker - QCF + LP/MP - works close or at range; hits 1/2/3 times by strength.

Reckoning Linker - QCF + LK/MK - preferred close-range damage Linker.

Shadow Oblivion - QCF+2P

Shadow Reckoning - QCF+2K - the better damage use of meter inside most combos.

ENDERS

Sadistic Appetite - Devil's Divide -> B: Battery / steals meter.

Sadistic Drop -> U: Damage; Shadow Devil's Divide is the premium cashout.

Oblivion - QCF+HP: Ground Bounce.

Sadistic Hurl -> F: Hard Knockdown.

Reckoning - QCF+HK: Wall Splat.

Sadistic Intent -> D: Advantage / close reset.

RECAPTURE / FLIPOUT

None. Gargos has no Recapture and no Flipout. For airborne damage, juggle with light Oblivions and, when close enough, use Heavy Devil's Divide to snatch the opponent from the air. White life from a juggle grab will not cash out the way a normal Ender does.

PRACTICAL COMBO

Light Reckoning Opener - QCF+LK -> HP Auto-Double -> **Light Reckoning Linker** - QCF+LK -> HP Auto-Double -> **Devil's Divide** -> **Sadistic Drop**

Simple close-range damage route. Substitute Appetite when the stolen meter will immediately fund a minion.

RANGED ROUTE

Light Oblivion Opener - QCF+LP -> **ranged Auto-Double** -> **Oblivion Linker** -> **ranged Auto-Double** -> **Oblivion Ender**. After the ground-bounce cashout, either add a safe light Oblivion juggle or use the time to summon a minion instead of risking another break.

GARGOS - INSTINCT, COUNTER-BREAKERS & PRACTICE

Gargos dominates when he has control; his weakness is surviving long enough to regain it after a knockdown.

INSTINCT - STONE SKIN

Activate - HP+HK. Gargos turns to stone and gains unlimited armor, but pays heavily: he cannot block, cannot dash, loses his multiple jumps, and his movement/Reckoning range is reduced. Grounded heavy attacks beat the armor, making knockdown extremely dangerous. Instinct is often strongest activated at range behind minions rather than as a blind wakeup reversal.

ERUPTION

Eruption - 3P during Instinct

Invincible zero-damage burst that blows off the stone skin and ends Instinct early, leaving half of the remaining Instinct gauge. Crucially, Gargos can use Eruption while being comboed or knocked down. If a heavy attack is beating your Instinct armor, Eruption is the emergency exit.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 0 METER

HP Double -> Light Reckoning -> HP Double -> Light Reckoning -> HP Double -> Devil's Divide + Sadistic Drop Ender - approximately 40% from the reference setup.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 1 METER

HP Double -> Light Reckoning -> HP Double -> Light Reckoning -> LP Double -> Shadow Reckoning -> Sadistic Drop Ender - approximately 51%.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 2 METER

HP Double -> Light Reckoning -> HP Double -> Light Reckoning -> LP Double -> Shadow Reckoning -> Shadow Devil's Divide Ender - approximately 58%. If choosing only one meter spend, the Shadow ender slightly edges Shadow Reckoning once Ender Level 4 is secured.

FINISHERS

Ultra - QCF+3P. Use during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF+3K. Requires a supported Stage Ultra arena and its positional condition.

Special Ultra Ender - during Ultra, F + MP+MK when the required green resource is available.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Oblivion - QCF+P at all strengths
2. Reckoning - QCF+K on ground and in air
3. Quadruple Jump control
4. Devil's Divide - QCB+P + all four finishers
5. Summon Izzik / Dretch - QCB+2K
6. Cover / Creep / Kill minion commands
7. Ranged Auto-Doubles and Oblivion Linkers
8. Safe summon windows after knockdown/Ender
9. 0/1/2-meter Counter-Breaker routes
10. Stone Instinct, Eruption, Ultra and Stage Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - EYEDOL

Two complete forms / Warrior rushdown / Mage zoning / random head switching / Cosmic Charges / combined Instinct

UNIVERSAL & HEAD-SWITCH COMMANDS

Wake Up! - B + HP

Eyedol punches the dormant head, damaging himself and greatly increasing the chance of switching forms. The switch is still not guaranteed. In Anniversary Edition the self-damage and switch odds were adjusted, so use it deliberately rather than repeatedly.

Warrior Run - F,F

Warrior has a sustained forward run instead of a normal forward dash. With a Control Charge, Warrior can run- or jump-cancel many attacks on hit or block.

Crushing Roar - 3P (Warrior); hold B/F to alter position

Long-range command grab that does modest damage and generates one **Rage Charge** for Mage.

Tele-Strike - 3K (Mage); hold B/F to alter side

Teleport strike that generates one **Control Charge** for Warrior. Use neutral for the front version or directional input to reposition/cross through.

WARRIOR SPECIAL MOVES

Crushing Destroyer - QCF + P

Two-hit club slam. Primary Opener/Linker. Shadow Crushing Destroyer - QCF+2P - is five hits and strongly plus on block.

Crushing Swing - QCB + P

Uppercut/launcher family. LP is the invincible reversal; MP is upper-body invulnerable and launches high; HP adds a second hit that **Recaptures**. Shadow Crushing Swing - QCB+2P - is the enhanced ground-bounce version.

Crushing Shoulder - QCB + K

Advancing shoulder and Opener/Linker. Shadow Crushing Shoulder - QCB+2K - is projectile-invulnerable and an important mid-range approach.

Head Bash - F + MP

Long-range overhead; requires a Manual on grounded hit and **Recaptures** airborne opponents.

Clobber - F + HP

Three-hit rushing club command normal and heavy punish starter.

EYEDOL - MAGE FORM & COSMIC CHARGES

Mage controls huge areas of the screen, then feeds Control Charges back to Warrior through Tele-Strike.

MAGE SPECIAL MOVES

Bolt Strike - QCF + P

LP travels along the ground and hits low; MP angles upward for anti-air control; HP creates a close lightning barrier. Shadow Bolt Strike - QCF+2P - fills the screen with electricity and is one of Mage's strongest reaction tools.

Meteor Strike - QCB + P

Summons an overhead meteor. Strength controls where it lands. Grounded hit staggers; airborne hit ground-bounces. Shadow Meteor Strike - QCB+2P - calls a full meteor shower.

Stomp Strike - QCB + K

Close-range magical stomp and Mage's conventional Opener/Linker. Heavy is highly advantaged on block and strong for chip pressure. Shadow Stomp Strike - QCB+2K - creates an enhanced carpet of explosions.

Rod Blast - B + MP

Nearly full-screen magical staff normal. Excellent space check; not special-cancelable.

COSMIC CHARGES

Eyedol stores up to **three Control Charges** and **three Rage Charges**. Mage earns Control Charges with **Tele-Strike - 3K**; Warrior earns Rage Charges with **Crushing Roar - 3P**. The inactive head creates the resource the other head spends, so good Eyedol play constantly feeds one form with the other.

WARRIOR - SPENDING CONTROL

With a Control Charge, Warrior can cancel many normals/specials on hit or block by inputting **F,F to Run** or holding a jump direction. This turns unsafe/negative approaches into pressure, lets him bait Shadow Counters and creates surprise throw/overhead sequences.

MAGE - SPENDING RAGE

Mage performs a **Cosmic** special by double-tapping the attack button during the special input: **QCF+P,P = Cosmic Bolt Strike**; **QCB+P,P = Cosmic Meteor Strike**; **QCB+K,K = Cosmic Stomp Strike**. Cosmic Bolt fires all three bolt patterns, Cosmic Meteor calls three meteors, and Cosmic Stomp adds a second farther stomp with improved advantage.

HEAD SWITCHING

After grounded medium/heavy normals, specials, Shadows or Enders, Eyedol may randomly switch forms when he returns to neutral. Failed switch rolls increase the future chance until a switch occurs. During pure Auto-Double/Linker sequences he normally cannot switch, but Manuals and post-Ender follow-ups can force you to recognize a form change mid-plan.

EYEDOL - OPENERS, LINKERS, ENDERS & COMBOS

The two forms use parallel combo inputs, which keeps Eyedol manageable even though the neutral game changes completely.

OPENERS / OTHER STARTERS

Warrior: Crushing Destroyer - QCF+P; Crushing Shoulder - QCB+K; Heavy Crushing Swing can start via juggle/recapture. **Mage:** Stomp Strike - QCB+K. Bolt Strike and Meteor Strike require a Manual/conversion; Head Bash also requires a Manual. Shadow versions of the listed Openers work.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Eyedol uses standard Light / Medium / Heavy Auto-Doubles. The same kick normals exist in both forms, while punch animations change. Mix strengths and Manuals, but be ready for a random head switch whenever your route returns Eyedol to neutral.

LINKERS

QCF + LP/MP: Warrior = Crushing Destroyer Linker; Mage = Bolt Strike Linker.
QCB + LK/MK: Warrior = Crushing Shoulder Linker; Mage = Stomp Strike Linker.
QCF+2P / QCB+2K provide the corresponding Shadow Linkers. The shared directional inputs are intentional and greatly reduce the memory burden.

WARRIOR ENDERS

Crushing Swing - QCB+P: Damage.
Crushing Destroyer - QCF+HP: Ground Bounce.
Crushing Shoulder - QCB+HK: Wall Splat. Near the corner, Wall Splat -> Crushing Roar is especially valuable because it guarantees a Rage Charge for Mage.

MAGE ENDERS

Bolt Strike - QCF+HP: Battery.
Meteor Strike - QCB+P: Damage.
Stomp Strike - QCB+HK: Launcher. After Launcher, juggle **Tele-Strike - 3K** to build a free Control Charge instead of always chasing raw damage.

RECAPTURE / FLIPOUT

Warrior Head Bash - F+MP = Recapture.
Warrior Heavy Crushing Swing - QCB+HP = Recapture.
No Flipout. Mage has no Recapture and generally prefers Tele-Strike after launcher/juggle situations to build Control Charges.

WARRIOR PRACTICAL COMBO

Heavy Crushing Shoulder Opener - QCB+HK -> HP Auto-Double -> Light Crushing Destroyer Linker - QCF+LP -> MP Auto-Double -> Crushing Swing Damage Ender - QCB+HP
Near the corner, substitute Crushing Shoulder Wall Splat Ender -> Crushing Roar for a Rage Charge.

MAGE PRACTICAL CONVERSION

Bolt Strike or Meteor Strike hit -> Light Bolt Strike - QCF+LP -> Tele-Strike - 3K. This long-range conversion is unbreakable and guarantees a Control Charge. At close range: **Stomp Strike Opener -> Double -> Linker -> Double -> Stomp Strike Launcher -> Tele-Strike.**

EYEDOL - INSTINCT, COUNTER-BREAKERS & FINISHERS

Awakening removes the compromise: both heads cooperate and overlapping special inputs execute both attacks together.

INSTINCT - AWAKENING

Activate - HP+HK. Both heads become active. Eyedol gains Warrior punch normals plus Mage's Rod Blast, can use Crushing Roar and Tele-Strike freely, and may spend either type of Cosmic Charge. Overlapping specials combine: Destroyer adds Bolt Strike, Swing adds Meteor Strike, and Shoulder adds Stomp Strike.

Stay Awake! - B + HP during Instinct

Eyedol punches himself to extend Instinct duration at the cost of his own health. The self-damage can be fatal, so only use it when the added Instinct time is worth the life cost.

COUNTER-BREAKER - WARRIOR

0 meter: HP Double -> Light Crushing Destroyer -> HP Double -> Light Crushing Destroyer -> MP Double -> Crushing Swing Ender - about **34%**.

1 meter: HP Double -> Shadow Crushing Shoulder -> HP Double -> Light Crushing Destroyer -> Crushing Swing Ender - about **48%**.

2 meter: HP Double -> Shadow Crushing Shoulder -> HP Double -> Shadow Crushing Shoulder -> Crushing Swing Ender - about **54%**.

COUNTER-BREAKER - MAGE

0 meter: HP Double -> Light Bolt Strike -> HP Double -> Light Bolt Strike -> MP Double -> Meteor Strike Ender - about **31%**.

1 meter: HP Double -> Shadow Bolt Strike -> HP Double -> Light Bolt Strike -> Meteor Strike Ender - about **42%**.

2 meter: HP Double -> Shadow Stomp Strike -> HP Double -> Shadow Stomp Strike -> Meteor Strike Ender - about **46%**.

FINISHERS

Ultra - QCF + 3P. Perform during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3K. Eyedol has no dedicated home stage; use it on a supported Stage Ultra arena from that arena's valid target zone.

Ultra Ender - MP+MK during Ultra. Eyedol finishes the Ultra with a lightning barrage.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Identify Warrior (red/hunched) vs Mage (purple/upright) instantly
2. Warrior: QCF+P Destroyer / QCB+P Swing / QCB+K Shoulder
3. Mage: QCF+P Bolt / QCB+P Meteor / QCB+K Stomp
4. Crushing Roar - 3P / Tele-Strike - 3K
5. Build and spend both Cosmic Charge types
6. Warrior Head Bash / Heavy Swing Recaptures
7. Shared Linker inputs and form-specific Enders
8. Mage zoning hit -> Bolt -> Tele-Strike pip conversion
9. Warrior/Mage 0/1/2-meter Counter-Breaker routes
10. Awakening, Stay Awake!, Ultra, Stage Ultra and Ultra Ender

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - KILGORE

Chaingun zoning / heat management / Overheat state / missiles / airborne gunfire / Fulgore prototype pressure

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Chaingun - QCF + P

Kilgore fires his arm cannons. Repeated gunfire builds **Heat**. Higher Heat changes the properties and threat of his gunfire, eventually reaching Overheat. Strength changes the firing pattern/timing.

Air Chaingun - air QCF + P

Airborne gunfire that alters Kilgore's descent and controls space beneath/in front of him. Use it to vary jump timing and frustrate grounded approaches.

Missile - QCB + P

Launches explosive ordnance for delayed screen control. Button strength changes the missile trajectory/timing. Use it to force movement before committing to Chaingun pressure.

Gun Dash - QCF + K

Advancing special that converts movement into close pressure and combo structure. Strength changes travel/timing.

Anti-Air / Rising Gun - F,D,DF + P

Dedicated anti-air/reversal family. Use it when opponents try to jump over the horizontal Chaingun lane.

Vent / Heat Management

Kilgore's core system is tied to firing the guns: attacks raise Heat, while periods without gunfire allow the system to cool. The objective is not simply 'stay cold' - Overheat unlocks stronger offensive behavior but comes with risk.

Shadow Chaingun - QCF + 2P

Enhanced multi-hit gunfire / Shadow combo tool.

Shadow Missile - QCB + 2P

Enhanced missile coverage.

Shadow Gun Dash - QCF + 2K

Enhanced advancing route.

Ultra - QCF + 3P

Perform during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3K

Use only on supported Stage Ultra arenas from the required target position/facing.

KILGORE - HEAT, OVERHEAT & ZONING

Kilgore's guns become more dangerous as they heat up, so his resource curve runs opposite to a traditional ammunition system.

HEAT GAUGE

Firing Kilgore's chainguns builds **Heat**. The gauge naturally falls when he stops firing. Learn to glance at the Heat level during neutral: low Heat favors controlled zoning, while high Heat tells both players that an Overheat sequence may be imminent.

OVERHEAT

At maximum Heat, Kilgore enters **Overheat**. His gun attacks become substantially more threatening, including explosive behavior that changes pressure and combo opportunities. Overheat is a power state, but it also announces what Kilgore wants to do; mix movement, missiles and normals so the opponent cannot simply wait for the obvious gun sequence.

BUILDING HEAT ON PURPOSE

Do not treat every shot as an attempt to hit. Sometimes the goal is to build Heat safely at a range where the opponent cannot punish the firing animation. Once the gauge approaches Overheat, move into a position where the enhanced gun properties can actually force a decision.

COOLING ON PURPOSE

If the opponent has survived the high-Heat sequence and you have lost screen position, stop firing long enough to cool. Use normals, movement and defensive anti-air instead of desperately adding more gunfire from a bad position.

MISSILE + CHAINGUN LAYERS

Missile - QCB+P -> reposition -> Chaingun - QCF+P. The missile creates a delayed problem while the guns occupy the immediate lane. If the opponent jumps to avoid the ground control, meet them with the rising anti-air or air Chaingun.

OPENERS

Gun Dash - QCF+K and appropriate close gun confirms form Kilgore's conventional entry into the combo system. Missile/Chaingun hits at range should be converted only when positioning permits; do not throw away a winning zoning position simply to chase one distant hit.

KILGORE - LINKERS, ENDERS, MANUALS & COMBOS

Kilgore's combo decisions should leave him at the Heat level and range he wants for the next neutral.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Kilgore uses standard Light / Medium / Heavy Auto-Doubles. Mix strengths and Manuals rather than repeating obvious Heavy animations. Because Heat can alter the reward from gun-based routes, practice the same basic combo at low and high Heat.

LINKERS

Gun Dash Linker - QCF + LK/MK

Chaingun Linker - QCF + LP/MP

Shadow Gun Dash - QCF+2K

Shadow Chaingun - QCF+2P

Vary strength and special family to disguise breaker timing.

ENDERS

Gun Dash Ender - QCF+HK: positioning/carry route.

Chaingun Ender - QCF+HP: gun/Heat-oriented cashout.

Missile Ender - QCB+HP: delayed-pressure/knockdown route.

Rising Gun Ender - F,D,DF+HP: launcher/anti-air-family cashout.

Choose the Ender for the next screen state, not only immediate damage.

PRACTICAL COMBO

Gun Dash Opener - QCF+MK -> MP Auto-Double -> **Light Chaingun Linker** - QCF+LP -> HP Auto-Double -> **Gun Dash Ender** - QCF+HK

Use this to learn the core rhythm, then practice the same route while watching the Heat gauge.

HIGH-HEAT ROUTE

Confirm at high Heat -> **short combo** -> **gun-based Linker/Enders** -> **maintain Overheat pressure**. Do not automatically spend the entire combo timer; if Overheat gives you a superior post-combo situation, a shorter guaranteed route can be stronger.

MISSILE CONVERSION

Missile hit/forced block -> **advance behind explosion** -> **fast normal** -> **Gun Dash Opener** -> **combo**. The missile's real value is often that it lets Kilgore close distance without abandoning screen control.

BREAKER PLAN

Gun animations can become visually repetitive. Alternate punch/kick Auto-Doubles and insert Manuals after familiar Linkers. Once the opponent begins guessing based on the sound/visual rhythm, Counter Breaker becomes especially dangerous.

KILGORE - INSTINCT, COUNTER-BREAKERS & PRACTICE

Kilgore is strongest when Heat, missiles and movement make the opponent solve several ranges at once.

INSTINCT - WEAPON SYSTEMS ONLINE

Activate - HP+HK. Kilgore's Instinct supercharges his weapon game and makes sustained gun pressure much more threatening. Activate when you already have enough screen control to force interaction; full-screen activation with no setup can waste the timer.

PRESSURE PLAN

At long range, build Heat with measured Chaingun fire. Layer Missile when the opponent wants to advance. At mid range, threaten Gun Dash and anti-air. At high Heat/Overheat, turn one forced block into sustained pressure, but stop firing if the opponent has escaped to a range where your commitment is punishable.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 0 METER

Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Chaingun Linker -> Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Gun Dash Linker -> damage/position Ender.
Keep the route compact enough to exploit the lockout.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 1 METER

Heavy Double -> Medium Linker -> Heavy Double -> Shadow Chaingun / Shadow Gun Dash -> Ender. Spend the Shadow sequence while the lockout still guarantees its multi-hit damage.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 2 METER

Heavy Double -> fast Linker -> Heavy Double -> Shadow Chaingun -> Shadow Gun Dash -> Ender. If spending both stocks does not materially change the round, keep meter for neutral/defense instead.

FINISHERS

Ultra - QCF+3P. Use during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF+3K. Requires a supported Stage Ultra arena and that arena's positional condition.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Chaingun - QCF+P at all strengths
2. Air Chaingun - air QCF+P
3. Missile - QCB+P trajectories
4. Gun Dash - QCF+K
5. Rising anti-air - F,D,DF+P
6. Watch Heat while zoning
7. Intentionally enter and exit Overheat
8. Missile -> approach -> combo conversion
9. 0/1/2-meter Counter-Breaker routes
10. Instinct, Ultra and Stage Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - SHIN HISAKO

Katana footsies / Spirit Orb control / Spirit Slice teleport / parry / projectile-assisted pressure

SPECIAL MOVES & COMMANDS

Spirit Orb - QCF + P

Shin Hisako places/fires her spirit projectile. The orb is central to her neutral and pressure because she can fight around its position and use it to cover movement or force defensive reactions.

Spirit Slice - QCB + P

Katana slash/teleport family used to change position and convert pressure. Strength changes the movement/arrival point. Shadow Spirit Slice - QCB+2P - is the enhanced multi-hit version.

Dragon Dance - QCF + K

Advancing katana attack and a primary grounded combo starter/linker family. Shadow Dragon Dance - QCF+2K - is the enhanced version.

Parry / Counter - QCB + K

Defensive read that intercepts eligible attacks. Use it against predictable strings rather than as a random wake-up choice; once the opponent begins delaying or throwing, Shin Hisako has created room for movement or offense.

Air Spirit Slice - air QCB + P

Airborne version of Spirit Slice. Alters her landing position and gives her a way to change sides or descend at a different timing.

Orb Recall / Orb Interaction

Shin Hisako's Spirit Orb is not just a conventional fireball: her special movement and pressure are designed around where the orb is on screen. Always know whether the orb is available before planning the next sequence.

Shadow Spirit Orb - QCF + 2P

Enhanced projectile/orb control.

Shadow Spirit Slice - QCB + 2P

Enhanced teleporting slash.

Shadow Dragon Dance - QCF + 2K

Enhanced advancing sword sequence.

Shadow Counter - QCB + 2K

Enhanced defensive counter.

Ultra - QCF + 3K

Perform during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3P

Use only on supported Stage Ultra arenas from the required target position/facing.

SHIN HISAKO - SPIRIT ORB, TELEPORTS & NEUTRAL

Unlike Hisako's wrath-heavy close pressure, Shin Hisako wants the katana and Spirit Orb to control where the opponent is allowed to stand.

SPIRIT ORB CONTROL

Think of **Spirit Orb - QCF+P** as a second piece on the screen. Put it where it interferes with the opponent's preferred route, then occupy the space they are forced toward with katana normals. The orb is strongest when it changes a decision, not when thrown automatically from full screen.

SPIRIT SLICE

QCB+P lets Shin Hisako reposition with an attacking slash. Vary strength so the opponent cannot pre-select the side/timing. Once they begin waiting for Spirit Slice, walk forward behind the orb or simply take the space they surrender.

AIR MOVEMENT

air QCB+P changes the landing point after a jump. Mix ordinary jump-ins, empty landings and Air Spirit Slice. If every jump becomes a teleport, the defender can wait for it; the threat is valuable because it makes the normal jump harder to anti-air.

PARRY THREAT

QCB+K makes predictable offense dangerous. Show the parry against a known gap or repeated meaty. When the opponent begins throwing or delaying to beat it, respond with fast buttons, back movement or your own throw. The parry is most valuable when it changes their rhythm.

KATANA RANGE

Shin Hisako's sword normals give her a more conventional footsie game than original Hisako. Use long pokes to make the opponent respect ground space, then place the orb behind that threat. Do not abandon the katana just because the projectile system is unusual.

OPENERS

Dragon Dance - QCF+K and appropriate Spirit Slice confirms are the primary entries into the combo system, with Shadow versions providing meter-assisted conversions. Orb hits should be confirmed into the closest reliable normal/special rather than chased recklessly.

SHIN HISAKO - LINKERS, ENDERS, MANUALS & COMBOS

Her basic KI combo is straightforward; the orb and teleport determine what happens immediately before and after it.

AUTO-DOUBLES & MANUALS

Shin Hisako uses standard Light / Medium / Heavy Auto-Doubles. Mix strengths and Manuals instead of repeating the most damaging animation. Her sword pressure encourages opponents to look for obvious heavy rhythms, making Manuals especially useful once they start reacting.

LINKERS

Dragon Dance Linker - QCF + LK/MK

Spirit Slice Linker - QCB + LP/MP

Shadow Dragon Dance - QCF+2K

Shadow Spirit Slice - QCB+2P

Alternate the two families and strengths so the defender cannot lock onto a single breaker cadence.

ENDERS

Dragon Dance Ender - QCF+HK: damage/positioning cashout.

Spirit Slice Ender - QCB+HP: alternate positioning/carry route.

Spirit Orb Ender - QCF+HP: orb-oriented setup/utility route.

Choose the Ender by asking what screen state gives the next orb/katana sequence the greatest advantage.

PRACTICAL COMBO

Dragon Dance Opener - QCF+MK -> MP Auto-Double -> **Light Spirit Slice Linker** - QCB+LP -> HP Auto-Double -> **Dragon Dance Ender** - QCF+HK

Once reliable, replace one Double with a Manual and practice entering from Spirit Slice.

ORB-COVERED APPROACH

Spirit Orb - QCF+P -> walk/advance behind it -> **katana normal** -> **Dragon Dance confirm** -> **combo**. If the opponent jumps away from the orb, be ready to anti-air rather than blindly continuing the ground string.

TELEPORT RESET

Short pressure -> **Spirit Slice** - QCB+P -> **reappear at altered position** -> **fast normal/throw**. The reset works because the defender must account for the orb, the slash and Shin Hisako's actual body position at the same time.

PARRY CONVERSION

Read predictable attack -> **Parry** - QCB+K -> **guaranteed punish** -> **Dragon Dance Opener** -> **combo**. Drill the punish until it is automatic. A correct defensive read that does not become damage gives away Shin Hisako's strongest momentum swing.

SHIN HISAKO - INSTINCT, COUNTER-BREAKERS & PRACTICE

The character becomes oppressive when the opponent is defending against the sword while the Spirit Orb controls their escape.

INSTINCT - SPIRIT CONTROL

Activate - HP+HK. Instinct strengthens Shin Hisako's ability to maintain spirit-assisted pressure and movement. Activate when an orb or knockdown already gives you control; forcing the opponent to defend during the timer is far stronger than activating at a range where they can simply retreat.

PRESSURE PLAN

Place Spirit Orb, occupy the ground with katana range, and watch the opponent's answer. If they jump, anti-air. If they block, advance into Dragon Dance/throw pressure. If they swing through a familiar gap, parry. If they retreat, Spirit Slice or simply walk them toward the corner.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 0 METER

Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Dragon Dance Linker -> Heavy Auto-Double -> Medium Spirit Slice Linker -> damage End. Keep the sequence fast enough to exploit the entire lockout.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 1 METER

Heavy Double -> Medium Linker -> Heavy Double -> Shadow Dragon Dance / Shadow Spirit Slice -> End. Spend the Shadow sequence while the lockout still guarantees the hits.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 2 METER

Heavy Double -> fast Linker -> Heavy Double -> Shadow Dragon Dance -> Shadow Spirit Slice -> End. Save meter if the second Shadow does not materially change the round; Shin Hisako values meter for neutral conversions and defense.

FINISHERS

Ultra - QCF+3K. Use during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

Stage Ultra - QCF+3P. Requires a supported Stage Ultra arena and that arena's positional condition.

PRACTICE ORDER

1. Spirit Orb - QCF+P at all strengths
2. Spirit Slice - QCB+P on ground
3. Air Spirit Slice - air QCB+P
4. Dragon Dance - QCF+K
5. Parry - QCB+K against a recorded string
6. Orb placement -> katana approach
7. Auto-Doubles, Manuals and both Linker families
8. Parry -> guaranteed combo conversion
9. 0/1/2-meter Counter-Breaker routes
10. Instinct, Ultra and Stage Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - EAGLE

CORRECTED COMMAND EDITION - every executable move below includes its actual input.

SPECIAL MOVES

Scatter Shot - QCF + P

Fast spread shot. **Shadow Scatter Shot - QCF + 2P.**

Rain Shot - QCB + P

Delayed arrows fall from above. **Shadow Rain Shot - QCB + 2P.**

Ankle Breaker - QCF + K

Low slide and Eagle's traditional Opener. **Shadow Ankle Breaker - QCF + 2K.** Important: use two kicks, not the 3K macro, because 3K also controls the bird.

Wingspan - QCB + K

Follow-ups: **Flying Knee - LP or LK; Flying Kick - MP or MK; Skyfall - HK; Arrow Shot - HP.**

Shadow Arrow Retrieval - QCB + 2K

Meter-assisted arrow recovery.

COMMAND NORMALS

Whipstep - B + MP

Whiplash - DB + MP

Tailspin - F + MP

GROUND ARROW INPUTS

Straight Arrow Shot - HP (hold to charge; while held, B/F can alter positioning/aim behavior)

Arc Arrow Shot - B + HP (hold to charge)

Straight Arrow Shot, crouching - D + HP (hold)

Up Arrow Shot - DB + HP (hold)

Low Arrow Shot - DF + HP (hold)

AIR ARROW INPUTS

Air Arrow Shot - air HP (hold)

Air Angle Arrow Shot - air DF + HP (hold)

Air Downward Arrow Shot - air D + HP (hold)

BIRD COMMANDS

Retrieve Arrows - 3K

Swoop Attack - F + 3K

Sonic Screech - B + 3K

Divebomb - D + 3K

Bird Fling - air, any direction + F + 3K while contacting bird

Instinct Bird Peck - during Instinct, P or K (ground or air).

Ultra - QCF + 3P

Stage Ultra - QCF + 3K

Ultra is used during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER; Stage Ultra also requires a supported arena/target zone.

EAGLE - ARROWS, BIRD & INPUT APPLICATION

Eagle begins with 12 arrows. Fired arrows remain on the stage until recovered.

ARROW MANAGEMENT

Recover nearby arrows: walk over them.

Bird retrieval: 3K.

Shadow retrieval: QCB+2K.

Do not empty the quiver without planning how to retrieve arrows; Eagle loses much of his zoning once HP no longer produces an arrow.

CHARGED ARROWS

For each arrow command, **hold HP** rather than tapping it. Eagle can preserve the charge while moving and coordinating the bird. The highest charge becomes unblockable, making bird coverage especially valuable while charging.

BIRD PRESSURE

B+3K Sonic Screech is the core close-range assist. Use it to cover Ankle Breaker or pressure recovery. **F+3K Swoop** controls horizontal space. **D+3K Divebomb** attacks downward/defensively. **3K Retrieve** recovers arrows. These are separate commands - they should appear explicitly in muscle-memory drills.

WINGSPAN FOLLOW-UP DRILL

QCB+K -> LP/LK = Flying Knee

QCB+K -> MP/MK = Flying Kick

QCB+K -> HK = Skyfall

QCB+K -> HP = Arrow Shot

Practice all four until the follow-up is chosen intentionally rather than by accident.

RAIN SHOT SETUP

QCB+P -> approach -> QCF+K Ankle Breaker / throw / jump attack. Rain Shot's delayed overhead threat lets Eagle attack low or grab underneath it.

ARROW HIT CONFIRM

DF+HP Low Arrow -> QCF+2K Shadow Ankle Breaker -> combo. The explicit input matters: Shadow Ankle Breaker is **QCF+2K**, not **QCF+3K**.

BIRD-COVERED ANKLE BREAKER

QCF+K Ankle Breaker -> B+3K Sonic Screech. On blocked pressure, the bird can cover Eagle's recovery and discourage immediate retaliation.

EAGLE - COMBO COMMANDS

Exact inputs are retained here so the combo pages can be used without returning to the move-list page.

OPENERS

Ankle Breaker - QCF+LK/MK/HK

Shadow Ankle Breaker - QCF+2K

Arrow/Rain/Screech hits may lead to a Manual/conversion, but Ankle Breaker is the standard special-move Opener.

LINKERS

Ankle Breaker Linker - QCF + LK or MK

Wingspan Linker - QCB + LK or MK

Shadow Ankle Breaker Linker - QCF + 2K

ENDERS

Scatter Shot Ender - QCF + P

Rain Shot Ender - QCB + P

Ankle Breaker Ender - QCF + K

Wingspan Ender - QCB + K

Use the Heavy version where the combo system calls for the full Ender strength.

BASIC DAMAGE ROUTE

QCF+LK Ankle Breaker Opener -> HP Auto-Double -> QCF+LK Ankle Breaker Linker -> MP Auto-Double -> QCF+HP Scatter Shot Ender.

REFERENCE 11-HIT ROUTE

D+LP, D+LP, QCF+LK, LP, QCF+LK, QCF+HP

A compact command-list route that reinforces the low-confirm into Ankle Breaker structure.

REFERENCE 10-HIT BIRD ROUTE

LP+LK throw -> F+3K Swoop Attack -> QCF+MP -> QCF+2P Shadow Scatter Shot

Use as a command drill for integrating an asynchronous bird call into an offensive sequence.

ARROW CONVERSION

DF+HP Low Arrow hit -> QCF+2K Shadow Ankle Breaker -> HP Auto-Double -> QCF+LK Linker -> QCF+HP Scatter Shot Ender.

RAIN SHOT MANUAL CONVERSION

QCB+P Rain Shot hit -> fast Manual normal -> QCF+K Ankle Breaker -> **combo**. The exact Manual depends on range; confirm the Rain Shot before committing.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 0 METER

HP Auto-Double -> QCF+LK Ankle Breaker Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> QCF+LK Linker -> HP Auto-Double -> QCF+HP Scatter Shot Ender.

EAGLE - SHADOW, INSTINCT & FINISHER COMMANDS

Final command-reference page: meter routes, Instinct bird control and finishers.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 1 METER

HP Double -> QCF+LK -> HP Double -> QCF+LK -> LK Double -> QCF+2K Shadow Ankle Breaker -> QCF+HP Scatter Shot Ender.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 2 METER

HP Double -> QCF+LK -> MP Double -> QCF+2K Shadow Ankle Breaker -> QCF+2K Shadow Ankle Breaker -> QCF+HP Scatter Shot Ender.

ALL SHADOW INPUTS - QUICK REFERENCE

Shadow Scatter Shot - QCF+2P
Shadow Rain Shot - QCB+2P
Shadow Ankle Breaker - QCF+2K
Shadow Arrow Retrieval - QCB+2K

INSTINCT BIRD INPUT

Activate Instinct - HP+HK.
Bird Peck - during Instinct, P or K (ground or air). Continue using normal bird commands during Instinct: 3K Retrieve, F+3K Swoop, B+3K Screech, D+3K Divebomb.

ULTRA / STAGE ULTRA

Ultra - QCF+3P.
Stage Ultra - QCF+3K.
This corrects the prior Eagle draft, which did not print the actual finisher commands. The Stage Ultra uses the opposite attack family from Eagle's Ultra.

COMPLETE INPUT DRILL

1. HP / B+HP / D+HP / DB+HP / DF+HP ground arrows
2. air HP / air DF+HP / air D+HP air arrows
3. QCF+P Scatter / QCB+P Rain
4. QCF+K Ankle Breaker / QCB+K Wingspan
5. Wingspan -> LP/LK, MP/MK, HK, HP
6. 3K / F+3K / B+3K / D+3K bird commands
7. QCF+2P / QCB+2P / QCF+2K / QCB+2K Shadows
8. B+MP / DB+MP / F+MP command normals
9. HP+HK Instinct + bird Peck P/K
10. QCF+3P Ultra / QCF+3K Stage Ultra

KILLER INSTINCT (2013) - SHADOW JAGO

Surge meter / teleport dashes / air fireballs / dive kicks / juggle-heavy offense / Annihilation & Ultimate

COMMAND NORMALS

Gate Keeper - F + HK

Step kick. Can cancel into forward dash on hit or block.

Dark Reckoning - B + HK

Overhead heel attack; any normal can cancel into it. Causes Stagger on hit.

SPECIAL MOVES - EXACT INPUTS

Shendokuken - QCF + P (ground or air)

Fireball; strength changes speed. **Surge:** QCF + P, then P+K to add a second angled projectile. **Shadow Shendokuken - QCF + 2P** fires five projectiles.

Dark Drift - QCB + K

Low slide; strength changes distance. **Surge:** QCB + K, then P+K teleports behind and launches. **Shadow Dark Drift - QCB + 2K** is throw/projectile invulnerable.

Dark Demise - QCF + K (ground or air)

Teleport dive kick; strength changes angle and it can cross up. **Surge:** QCF + K, then P+K adds multiple hits. **Shadow Dark Demise - QCF + 2K** tracks initial position and **Recaptures** airborne opponents.

Dark Fury - F,D,DF + P

Invincible vertical uppercut. **Surge:** F,D,DF + P, then P+K adds a second uppercut and juggle opportunity. **Shadow Dark Fury - F,D,DF + 2P** hits five times.

Dark Catastrophe - while dashing, P

Invincible angled dash uppercut. Strength changes height/distance. **Surge:** while dashing, P, then P+K adds a second uppercut. **No Shadow version.**

SPECIAL FINISHERS

Annihilation - during Instinct: QCF + LP+LK

Unblockable cinematic grab; consumes remaining Instinct and can reach about 48% at near-full timer.

Ultimate - QCF + LP+LK

Direct Ultimate command during a valid combo while opponent is in DANGER and Shadow Jago is still on his first life bar.

Ultra - F,D,DF + 3P

Ultra Combo; end early with MP+MK.

Stage Ultra: use the universal Stage Ultra command on a supported stage from its required target zone.

SHADOW JAGO - SURGE, TELEPORTS & JUGGLE STARTERS

Shadow Jago spends small slices of Shadow Meter to Surge specials, turning risky tools into layered mixups.

SURGE SYSTEM

After the normal special input, press **P+K** to Surge it. Surge Shendokuken adds a diagonal projectile; Surge Dark Drift teleports behind and launches; Surge Dark Demise becomes multi-hit and much safer; Surge Dark Fury/Catastrophe add a second uppercut for a juggle. Save enough meter to cash out the juggle afterward.

TRUE OPENERS

Dark Drift - QCB+K (Shadow OK).

Surge Dark Demise - QCF+K, then P+K (Shadow Dark Demise also works). Regular Dark Drift is fast but unsafe; meterless Dark Demise causes Stagger rather than serving as the conventional grounded Opener.

OTHER COMBO STARTERS

Dark Demise - QCF+K = Stagger.

Dark Reckoning - B+HK = Stagger.

Throw - LP+LK or B+LP+LK = launch/juggle.

Surge Dark Drift - QCB+K, P+K = launch.

Surge Dark Fury - F,D,DF+P, P+K = launch.

Surge Dark Catastrophe - dash, P, P+K = launch.

TELEPORT DASH OFFENSE

Shadow Jago's dash can pass through the opponent, producing left/right ambiguity. **Gate Keeper - F+HK -> forward dash** is a core pressure transition. Combine dash-through with throw, **B+HK overhead**, QCB+K low slide, or delayed QCF+K Dark Demise.

AIR FIREBALL / DIVE-KICK LAYER

Air QCF+P Shendokuken controls the ground while altering jump timing. **Air QCF+K Dark Demise** changes descent and can cross up. Surge either move with **P+K** to create a second layer when meter permits.

RECAPTURE / FLIPOUT

Shadow Dark Demise - QCF+2K = Recapture.

No Flipout. Recapture converts a juggle into a grounded combo so Shadow Jago can use a grounded Ender such as Shendokuken Battery, but it costs a full Shadow stock and is breakable.

SHADOW JAGO - LINKERS, ENDERS & COMBOS

His grounded combo game is straightforward; the character's real complexity is meter-aware juggle conversion.

LINKERS - EXACT INPUTS

Dark Drift Linker - QCB + LK/MK
Shadow Dark Drift Linker - QCB + 2K
Dark Demise Linker - QCF + LK/MK
Shadow Dark Demise Linker - QCF + 2K
Dark Drift switches sides; Shadow Dark Drift finishes on the original side. Dark Demise's long startup is useful for baiting timing lockouts.

ENDERS - EXACT INPUTS

Damage Ender - Dark Fury: F,D,DF + P (Shadow Dark Fury - F,D,DF+2P).
Exchange Launcher Ender - Dark Drift: QCB + K.
Hard Knockdown Ender - Dark Demise: QCF + K.
Battery Ender - Shendokuken: QCF + P. Shadow Dark Fury is the critical cashout for juggle potential damage.

PRACTICAL GROUNDED COMBO

QCB+HK Dark Drift Opener -> HP Auto-Double -> QCF+LK Dark Demise Linker -> MP Auto-Double -> F,D,DF+HP Dark Fury
Damage Ender. Alternate Drift/Demise Linkers and Manuals once the base route is reliable.

JUGGLE STARTER

QCB+K, P+K Surge Dark Drift -> air/ground juggle normals -> F,D,DF+2P Shadow Dark Fury cashout. Without a full stock for Shadow Dark Fury, the potential damage from a long juggle cannot be cashed out efficiently.

RECAPTURE ROUTE

Throw or Surge launcher -> juggle -> QCF+2K Shadow Dark Demise Recapture -> Auto-Double -> QCF+P Shendokuken Battery Ender. This spends meter to return to a grounded combo, then uses the Battery Ender to rebuild some of it.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 0 METER

HP Double -> MP Double -> HP Double -> MP Double -> HP Double -> F,D,DF+HP Dark Fury Ender - approximately 50% from the reference heavy-Dark-Drift setup.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 1 METER

HP Double -> MP Double -> HP Double -> MP Double -> QCB+2K Shadow Dark Drift -> F,D,DF+HP Dark Fury Ender - approximately 56%.

COUNTER-BREAKER - 2 METER

HP Double -> MP Double -> HP Double -> MP Double -> QCB+2K Shadow Dark Drift -> F,D,DF+2P Shadow Dark Fury Ender - approximately 58%.

SHADOW JAGO - INSTINCT, ANNIHILATION & FINISHERS

Instinct makes his risky approach safer, but Annihilation is the defining threat.

INSTINCT

Activate - HP+HK. Shadow Jago gains additional frame advantage and his dash-through tether/meter interaction. Instinct makes normally unsafe approach tools less punishable and gives him access to Annihilation.

ANNIHILATION

During Instinct: QCF + LP+LK. Shadow Jago lunges into an unblockable grab. It consumes the rest of the Instinct timer; damage scales with remaining Instinct, reaching roughly 48% near full. It is throw-invulnerable but not strike-invulnerable. If the opponent is free to act after the freeze, they can jump it, so use it as a punish/read rather than raw neutral gambling.

ULTIMATE

QCF + LP+LK during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER and Shadow Jago is on his **first life bar**. Unlike the other Ultimate-capable characters, Shadow Jago performs the Ultimate directly from the combo rather than first entering Ultra and then transitioning.

ULTRA

Ultra Combo - F,D,DF + 3P.

Ultra End Early - MP+MK.

Use the Ultra command during a valid combo while the opponent is in DANGER.

STAGE ULTRA

Stage Ultra: use the game's Stage Ultra input on a supported arena while the opponent is positioned in that stage's valid hazard zone. Keep it separate in muscle memory from F,D,DF+3P Ultra and QCF+LP+LK Ultimate/Annihilation.

COMPLETE INPUT DRILL

1. F+HK Gate Keeper / B+HK Dark Reckoning
2. QCF+P Shendokuken ground + air
3. QCB+K Dark Drift
4. QCF+K Dark Demise ground + air
5. F,D,DF+P Dark Fury
6. dash -> P Dark Catastrophe
7. Repeat each Surge-capable move with P+K after the special
8. QCF+2P / QCB+2K / QCF+2K / F,D,DF+2P Shadow commands
9. HP+HK Instinct -> QCF+LP+LK Annihilation
10. F,D,DF+3P Ultra / QCF+LP+LK Ultimate